SETTING-NEUTRAL ROLEPLAYING RULES



The 2d12 System

Version 2

CORE RULEBOOK

One roll, many outputs. Roll 2d12 + Skill + Modifiers vs. Difficulty.

SKROXIOUSDM

The 2d12 System

Version 2 · Core Rulebook

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Version 2 · Core compilation dated 2026-11-11

The 2d12 System is a setting-neutral tabletop roleplaying engine. Settings are published as separate books.

Acknowledgements & Inspirations

Testament of Dust owes a heartfelt thank-you to the creators of Blades in the Dark, :Otherworld, Cypher System, Fate, Torchbearer, Gumshoe, 2d20, Reign, and Imperium Maledictum.

In different ways, these games helped shape the questions behind this one: What makes a risk worth taking? What should success cost? How do a character's beliefs and obligations become part of play? And what keeps people moving when the world is larger, stranger, and less forgiving than they are?

Thank you for the examples, the challenges, and the moments that made me stop and reconsider a rule—or an entire approach. Sometimes the inspiration was a particular idea. Sometimes it was the feeling a game could create at the table. Sometimes it was simply the encouragement to believe that another way of doing things was possible.

2D12 system is my own answer to some of those questions, but I did not arrive at them alone. This acknowledgement is a small expression of gratitude for the work that helped me get here.

Playtest draft — not yet playtested. Set in EB Garamond and Source Sans 3.

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CHAPTER I

Introduction

The 2d12 System is a setting-neutral engine for tabletop roleplaying. This chapter explains what this book contains, how its rules are named and how settings build on it.

Roll 2d12 + Skill + Modifiers vs. Difficulty.

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About This Book

This core rulebook holds the complete, setting-neutral rules of the 2d12 System: the engine, six optional modules, and generic Descriptors, Playbooks and Focuses that work in any genre.

Ch.	Chapter	Contents
I	Introduction	Terminology, renamed stats, notation, settings
II	Core Rules	The 2d12 roll, character creation, Tychē Points, Effects, Resistance and recovery, clocks, Truths, Momentum and Woe, the conflict system, playbooks, advancement
III	Optional Modules	Module A Cyphers & Artifacts · Module B The Grind & Travel · Module C Truth-Driven Sandbox · Module D Downtime · Module E Factions · Module F Inquiry & Revelation
IV	Adversaries	GM rules for adversaries and opposition
V	Generic Descriptors	Descriptor rules and 24 setting-neutral Descriptors, six per pool
VI	Generic Playbooks	Playbook and equipment rules; Bellator, Furcifer, Savant, Interlocutor, Explorator, Adept
VII	Generic Focuses	Focus rules and 24 setting-neutral Focuses
App.	Quick Reference	The roll, Difficulty, outcomes, bonus dice, recovery and the four currencies at a glance

When a rule here mentions another chapter, it uses that chapter's name and section number. For example, Core Rules §4.1 means Chapter II, section 4.1. A bare reference such as §6 points to a section in the same chapter. Setting books use the same chapter names when they refer back to this book.

Notation

- ★ Major. An ability that costs 1 Refresh when you take it, at creation or through advancement. Taken as a creation extra, it costs 2 Refresh total, including the extra ability's 1-Refresh price (Generic Playbooks §1.1–1.2).
- ◆ Capstone. Unlocked after 12 Advances if you have at least 4 abilities from that playbook. It costs no Refresh, and each character can have one.
- ◈ Weird. A Focus that assumes the supernatural, strange technology or other weird elements. Each setting decides which ◈ Focuses it allows and how its world reacts to them.
- Tags are written in *italics*, such as *scarred knuckles*. Statuses add a tier, such as *wounded-2*.
- Difficulty is written by name and target, such as Standard 15 or Hard 18.

SETTINGS

The 2d12 System has no setting of its own. A setting book adds Campaign Truths, a skill list, its own Descriptors, Playbooks and Focuses, and special rules for its creatures and dangers. Where a setting rule and a general rule conflict, the setting rule wins.

Terminology

House name	What it is
Woe	The GM's pool: complications and escalation
Momentum	The party's shared pool of surplus Power
Tychē / Tychē Points	Each PC's narrative currency: invoke tags, accept compels; set by Refresh
Sōma	Pool: strength, endurance, toughness, vitality. Resists wounds, poison, exhaustion, cold
Mētis	Pool: alacrity, speed, precision, stealth, reflexes. Resists traps, falls, being caught
Psychē	Pool: mind, intellect, perception, memory, cunning. Resists confusion, illusion, deception
Pneuma	Pool: spirit, will, presence, faith, the supernatural. Resists fear, despair, possession, corruption

House name	Generic core playbook
Bellator	Front-line muscle; anchor Fight or Brawl
Furcifer	Infiltrator, scout, thief; anchor Stealth
Savant	Scholar, detective, scientist; anchor Lore or Investigate
Interlocutor	Diplomat, con artist, leader; anchor Persuade
Explorator	Ranger, pilot, explorer; anchor Survival
Adept	Mage, psychic, hacker; anchor Arcana or Tech

- Pool shorthand. Playbook stat blocks list base pools as Sōm / Mēt / Psy / Pne (Sōma / Mētis / Psychē / Pneuma).
- Scars take the name of the pool most tied to the condition that caused them: a Pneuma Scar, a Psychē Scar (Core Rules §6.3).

CHAPTER II

Core Rules

One roll, many outputs. A pair of twelve-sided dice decides whether you succeed, how much Power you earn and whether fate twists. Around that roll: pools that double as stress, tags and Truths, Momentum and Woe, and scripted conflicts.

Roll 2d12 + Skill + Modifiers vs. Difficulty.

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1. Design Pillars

1. Every currency has one job. Four resources, each answering a different question:

Resource	Owner	Job	Borrowed from
Pools (Sōma / Mētis / Psychē / Pneuma)	Each PC	Physical, mental and spiritual cost — Effort and Resistance	Cypher + Blades stress
Tychē Points	Each PC	Narrative authority — invoke tags, accept compels	Fate
Momentum	The party (shared)	Tactical surplus from strong rolls	2d20
Woe	The GM	Mirror of Momentum — complications and escalation	2d20

2. One roll, many outputs. A single 2d12 roll tells you whether you succeed, how well (Power), and whether something twists (doubles).
3. Fiction is mechanical. Tags, statuses and Truths give recorded fictional circumstances mechanical weight. Apply skills and explicit ability or procedure modifiers as their rules state; do not invent hidden situational math. Truths normally shift Difficulty, while tags and relevant statuses modify the roll (§2, §5, §8).
4. Characters are driven, not just capable. Beliefs, Goals, and Instincts are the primary engine for earning Tychē Points and XP.

2. Core Resolution

2.1 The Roll

Roll 2d12 + Skill + Modifiers vs. Difficulty.

- Skill: +0 to +4 (from the skill pyramid; untrained = +0).
- Tags: +1 per relevant power tag, maximum +2 per roll. −1 per relevant weakness tag (no cap). Apply an explicit tag-cap exception only within its stated scope; the usual +1 exception permits at most +3 from tags.
- Statuses: ± the tier of the highest relevant harmful status and the highest relevant helpful status.
- Truths: shift Difficulty by steps (§8), not the roll: one step per rank, ±3 steps at most.

Why 2d12 summed: it produces a bell curve (2–24, average 13) — predictable for skilled characters, swingy at the extremes, and big enough that +1 modifiers matter without dominating.

2.2 Difficulty Ladder

Difficulty	Target	Example
Trivial	—	No roll; it happens
Routine	9	Climb a rough wall with plenty of handholds
Easy	12	Climb a knotted rope
Standard	15	Pick a decent lock
Hard	18	Track someone over bare rock
Formidable	21	Talk down a warlord in front of his troops
Heroic	24	Hold a collapsing gate long enough for a village to escape
Epic	27	Things legends are made of
Divine	30	Miraculous

Each step of Difficulty is 3 points. Apply increases and reductions without a minimum target. A reduced target below Routine 9 remains a numerical target; it does not automatically become Trivial. Trivial means the action requires no roll. Roll only when uncertainty or the consequences make resolving the action worthwhile.

2.3 Odds Reference

Chance to hit the number needed on the dice (after subtracting your bonuses):

Need on dice	2d12	3d12 keep 2	4d12 keep 2
7+	90%	98%	99%
9+	81%	94%	98%
11+	69%	88%	95%
13+	54%	78%	89%
15+	38%	65%	80%
17+	25%	48%	66%
19+	15%	32%	48%
21+	7%	17%	28%

Example: Skill +3 and one tag (+1) vs. Standard 15 → need 11+ → 69%, or 88% with one bonus die.

2.4 Bonus Dice and Effort

You can add d12s to the roll and keep the best two. Maximum +2 bonus dice (4d12 keep 2) from any combination of:

Source	Cost
Effort (Cypher)	3 points from the relevant pool, minus that pool's Edge (min 0)
Momentum (2d20)	1 for the first die, 2 for the second
Woe (2d20)	Give the GM 1 Woe per die
Ordinary Help	An ally spends 1 point from a pool and risks sharing the consequences

Effort (revised). Each use of Effort costs 3 − Edge from the relevant pool, minimum 0. You may use Effort a number of times

per roll equal to your Effort Level (1 at start; 2 and 3 are unlocked by advancement). Each use buys one of:

- +1 bonus die — declared before rolling.
- +1 Power — declared after a Success or Success at a Cost (Cypher's "effort on damage"). It cannot turn a failure into a success.

Example: Effort Level 2 lets you buy one bonus die before the roll, then spend again for +1 Power if you succeed.

Pay each cost. Effort and ordinary Help are voluntary costs and must be paid in full; they cannot overrun an insufficient pool unless an explicit rule allows it (§6.1). Spending the exact last points still runs the pool dry. Pay each separately listed cost when its rule says; do not combine or split payments to change running-dry consequences. A final cost of 0 never runs the pool dry. If paying a cost takes you out, finish the action whose cost caused it, but do not buy more Effort or activate more abilities for that action. Complete independently resolving actions before checking victory.

Free benefits and setup Help. Free bonus dice still count toward the +2 bonus-dice cap. Ordinary free Help waives its pool-point cost, not relevance or participation risks.

Conflict setup Help costs no pool points. Before the leader rolls, each eligible helper explains a meaningful contribution and commits to the side's stakes. Each adds +1 starting Disposition, without an ordinary Help bonus die (§10.2). A free-Help ability adds no further setup benefit unless expressly stated.

A character unable to contribute cannot help. Later unavailability does not subtract their contribution or recalculate starting Disposition. Free benefits grant no additional scripted turn (§10.5).

2.5 Outcomes

For tests against a Difficulty, use the following outcomes. Versus tests use opposing totals under §10.5 instead.

Result	Outcome
Beat the target by 3+ per step	Success with extra Power
Meet the target	Success — 1 Power
Miss by 1–3	Success at a Cost — 1 Power, but the GM adds a consequence or gains 1 Woe (player's choice of which)
Miss by 4+	Failure — the GM makes a move; GM gains 1 Woe

Power = 1 for meeting the target, +1 for every full 3 points over it. Power is spent on Effects (§5). Any Power you don't spend becomes Momentum (party pool, max 6).

Scripted conflict exception. Use the interaction procedure in §10.5 and consequence restrictions in §10.7. An ordinary failed independent conflict test generates its usual 1 Woe, but does not also authorise an unrelated GM move, automatic injury or extra Disposition loss.

Losing or tying a versus test generates no ordinary-failure Woe. A trumped action makes no roll, produces no effect and generates no ordinary-failure Woe. Apply this symmetrically to player and GM actors. Costs already paid remain spent; separately triggered complications and explicit Woe rules still apply.

Independent Success at a Cost grants 1 Power with the restricted cost options in §10.7. Losing a versus test by 1–3 does not qualify.

Automatic success. An explicitly granted automatic success replaces the roll for an otherwise permitted action, not an additional turn or a bypass of the interaction. Apply the listed Power and the opposed-automatic-success procedure in §10.5. With no roll, there is no dice-based critical or complication.

2.6 Doubles (Twists)

If your two kept dice show the same number:

- On a success: Critical — +1 Power and add a narrative flourish.
- On a failure or cost: Complication — the GM introduces a complication right away.
- Double 12s on an independent test: always succeed and add +2 Power instead of the ordinary +1 doubles critical.
- Double 1s: always cause their normal complication, but do not automatically lose. Successful double 1s also receive the ordinary +1 critical Power.
- Buying it off. When the dice give you a complication (a twist, or a Risky roll, §2.7), you may cancel it by giving the GM 2 Woe: a problem now, or a problem later. If you keep it and the GM can't think of a fitting complication, the GM gains the 2 Woe instead.

- NPCs. When the dice give an NPC a complication, the GM may spend 2 Woe to cancel it. Otherwise the GM describes the complication, or invites the players to.

Base chance of doubles on 2d12 is about 8% (1 in 12).

Versus tests. Compare opposing totals normally. Double 12s do not override a higher opposing total or break an exact tie. Winning ordinary doubles add +1 Power to the margin-based award; winning double 12s add +2 instead. Losing or tied doubles grant no Power or normal action effect. Double 1s still cause their normal complication even on a loss or tie; they do not automatically lose.

Apply these procedures equally to rolled doubles and doubles created by an explicit ability, including Perfect Strike.

In conflicts. Doubles complications remain within the established stakes and action's scale; they do not cancel independently resolving actions or retroactively change scripts (§10.7).

2.7 Risky Rolls (Optional)

Some rolls aren't harder, just more dangerous. Before a roll, the GM may call it Risky 1, 2 or 3.

- Risk die. Roll one extra d12 of a different colour with the others. It's never kept, doesn't add to the total and doesn't count toward the bonus dice maximum.
- Complication. If the Risk die shows the rating or lower, a complication occurs after the roll is resolved, whatever the result and on top of any twist. You can buy it off for 2 Woe (§2.6).
- Raising the stakes. The GM may spend 1 Woe to make a roll Risky 1, or to raise its rating by 1 (maximum 3). Settings may make some hazards Risky by default.

Rating	Risk die shows	Chance of a complication
Risky 1	1	about 8%
Risky 2	1–2	about 17%
Risky 3	1–3	25%

3. Character Creation

Character Creation at a Glance

Before creating characters, agree on the campaign premise: the situation that brings you together, the immediate problem, the kinds of characters that fit, and why you will cooperate. For example: isolated settlements must reopen a trade route before winter while rival leaders compete to control it.

These steps describe the order of creation; the subsections below group rules by subject for reference. Revisit earlier choices as your character takes shape.

1. Establish the campaign premise together.
2. Sketch your character concept: a role, an important experience, and something you want to explore.
3. Write your World Belief (§3.5).
4. Write your Self Belief (§3.5).
5. Choose Descriptor, Playbook, and Focus (§3.1); complete pools, Edge, skills, tags, abilities, and starting resources (§§3.2–3.4, §3.6, §4.1).
6. Introduce the characters and agree on connections, including the link supplied by your Focus.
7. Write your Other Belief with the other player's agreement (§3.5).
8. Choose a concrete starting Goal (§3.5).
9. Write your Instinct (§3.5).
10. Review the character with the group.

3.1 The Sentence

> *"I am a [Descriptor] [Playbook] who [Focus]."*
>
> *"I am a Reckless Furcifer who Never Leaves Anyone Behind."*

Part	Grammar	What it gives you
Descriptor	Adjective	+2 pool points to one pool, 1 power tag, 1 weakness tag, 1 suggested Instinct
Playbook	Noun	Starting pools and Edge, special abilities, XP trigger, load-out, an anchor skill
Focus	Verb phrase	A tag theme (2 power tags + 1 weakness), a Tier 1 Focus ability, and a link to another PC

3.2 Pools and Edge

Four pools, each roughly 6–14:

- Starting values: the playbook sets the base (totals 36), plus 4 points to distribute and +2 from the Descriptor (42 total).
- Edge: the playbook gives 3 points of Edge, maximum 2 in any one pool at creation. Edge reduces the cost of Effort from that pool and adds dice when you Resist with it (§6).
- Pools are spent on Effort (§2.4) and Resistance (§6). They are your stress tracks.

Pool	Covers	Resists
Sōma	Strength, endurance, toughness	Wounds, poison, exhaustion, cold
Mētis	Speed, precision, stealth, reflexes	Traps, falls, being caught or grabbed
Psychē	Intellect, perception, memory, cunning	Confusion, illusion, deception, madness from knowledge
Pneuma	Will, presence, faith, emotional core, the supernatural	Fear, despair, possession, corruption, social pressure

3.3 Skill Pyramid

Ten rated skills from a list of 20:

Rating	Count
+4 Great	1
+3 Good	2
+2 Fair	3
+1 Average	4

The playbook's anchor skill must sit at +3 or +4. The pyramid rule (each tier must have at least as many skills as the tier above it) still applies when you advance.

Generic skill list by default pool:

Sōma	Mētis	Psychē	Pneuma
Athletics	Shoot	Notice	Will
Brawl	Stealth	Investigate	Persuade
Fight	Drive/Pilot	Lore	Intimidate
Endure	Craft	Tech	Empathy
Survival		Medicine	Arcana*
		Deceive	

*Arcana is renamed per setting: Mysticism, Faith, Psionics, Weirdness, or removed entirely in mundane games.

The default pool pays for Effort and Resistance. The GM can allow another pool when the fiction supports it (Intimidate with Sōma = looming; with Pneuma = cold menace).

3.4 Tags

Characters carry 6–8 character tags from Descriptor, Focus, and Playbook:

- Power tags (e.g. *ex-navy marksman*, *silver tongue*, *grandfather's revolver*): +1 each when relevant, max +2 per roll.
- Weakness tags (e.g. *owes the wrong people*, *bad knee*): −1 when relevant, or compel for a Tychē Point (§4).
- Any tag can be compelled. A power tag can also cause trouble when its meaning creates a concrete complication. It keeps its normal benefits (§4).
- Burning a tag: mark a power tag as burned to gain an automatic +1 Power on a success. It stays unusable until you recover it (a downtime action or a milestone). Burning ignores the +2 cap.

With a +2 cap, a third relevant tag is best used for burning or as Tychē Point invoke material.

3.5 Beliefs, Goals, and Instincts

Three Different Jobs

- Beliefs state convictions and commitments: why you act. Write one World, one Other, and one Self Belief.
- Goal states a concrete objective for this session or mission: what you want to accomplish next.
- Instinct states an if/then reflex: how you habitually respond. Acting on an Instinct lets you take that action without spending time, subject to normal resolution and the conflict timing limits below.

Goals are rewritten each session; Beliefs and Instincts can change at milestones (§12.3). Beliefs can justify compels (§4) and meaningful decisions can earn XP (§12.1). They do not create an additional resource.

Writing Your Beliefs

Each Belief combines a conviction with a commitment to act: "I believe this; therefore, I will do this." Write what you intend to do, not an outcome you are guaranteed to achieve. Avoid a virtue without an action: "I value loyalty" gives less direction than "Those who stand beside me deserve my loyalty; I will not abandon a companion to save myself."

World Belief

Connect yourself to an important problem, faction, institution, or conflict in the campaign premise. Explain why you cannot simply walk away.

- What must change, or be protected?
- Why does it matter to you personally?
- What will you do about it?

> *I believe [something about the campaign situation]. Because [why it matters to me], I will [an action or ongoing commitment].*

Example: "The settlements will starve if their leaders keep the roads divided. Because I have seen what isolation costs, I will bring them into a common defence agreement."

Agree with the group that this commitment engages with the campaign you intend to play. Characters need not share an ideology, but should have reasons to participate together.

Self Belief

State a principle about who you are, who you intend to become, or what you consider right. Show how it affects your choices.

- What principle is more than a convenience?
- What kind of person are you determined to become, or never become?
- What will you do when this conviction becomes difficult to uphold?

> *I believe [a personal principle]. I will live by this conviction by [a commitment], even when [a meaningful pressure or cost].*

Example: "People are not expendable tools. I will not knowingly sacrifice those in my care merely to secure an advantage."

Your Self Belief need not contradict the others, but their demands may sometimes pull in different directions. Do not resolve those possible dilemmas during creation.

Other Belief

Once the characters have concepts and roles, introduce their World and Self Beliefs. Agree on connections and shared history, then choose another PC whose outlook or choices interest you. Your Focus's existing link may supply this connection; writing a Belief does not grant an additional Focus benefit.

- Whom do you trust, admire, distrust, or feel you owe?
- What do you hope to preserve or change in the relationship?
- How will you act because of that conviction?

> *I believe [another PC] is / deserves / needs [my conviction about them]. Because [our connection or why it matters], I will [how I intend to act toward them].*

Example: "Mara kept our caravan alive when I lost my nerve. I will support her leadership, but I will speak against her when she treats lives as acceptable losses."

Agree on the relationship premise with the other player. Your Belief expresses your perspective, not authority over their character's motives or decisions. An agreed misunderstanding is possible; it does not establish your interpretation as fact.

Connecting Beliefs to Your Character

Use Beliefs as prompts, not prerequisites, when completing your mechanical choices:

- Descriptor: how does your temperament shape your approach?
- Playbook: what role and methods do you bring?
- Focus: what distinctive pursuit supports or complicates your commitments?
- Skills and abilities: what can you already do, and where does ambition exceed competence?
- Tags: which strengths help you act, and which vulnerabilities make that difficult?
- Load-out: which gear options and load may support your commitments? Follow §3.6; do not choose every item in advance.

Beliefs grant no additional skills, tags, abilities, equipment, pool points, or starting Tychē. A conviction is not automatically a power tag or a modifier. Wanting to protect others does not require being good at it.

Choose Your Starting Goal

Choose a concrete opening objective that advances at least one Belief. It should have a recognisable completion point.

> *My current Goal is to [achieve a specific result]. I will know it is accomplished when [observable outcome].*

Example: "Secure the mill town's agreement to send a delegate to the road council."

Completing this Goal does not complete the World Belief about uniting the settlements. A Belief can motivate several successive Goals. Your Goal can instead arise from an Other or Self Belief; it need not serve all three.

Write Your Instinct

Write a recognisable trigger and habitual response. Your Descriptor's suggested Instinct can be a starting point.

> *When [trigger], I [habitual response].*

Example: "When we enter an unfamiliar place, I identify an escape route before settling in."

Acting on an Instinct lets you take that action without spending time. It does not guarantee success or remove a roll when the normal resolution rules require one. During a scripted conflict, it grants no extra action, interrupt, free script change, actor reassignment or rotation bypass. Resolve a consequential response through an otherwise permitted action or explicit ability; an Instinct cannot rescue a trumped action, allow action while Taken Out or retroactively cancel a resolved effect (§10.5).

Review Before Play

Read your three Beliefs, Goal, and Instinct aloud. Check that:

- Each Belief contains a conviction and intended action.
- The World Belief connects to the agreed premise.

- The Other Belief concerns a PC and has their player's agreement.
- The Self Belief can influence a difficult choice.
- The Goal gives you something concrete to pursue immediately.
- The Instinct has a recognisable trigger.
- You have reasons to cooperate even when convictions differ.

USING BELIEFS TO PREPARE PLAY

For each character, note an opportunity and a possible dilemma suggested by their Beliefs. These are invitations, not predetermined outcomes. Challenge commitments without prescribing the correct response. Use Other Beliefs to invite interaction, not override another player's agency. A character's conviction does not automatically establish facts about the world. Do not demand a roll merely to prove that the character sincerely holds it.

Example: A Character Ready for Play

Premise: isolated settlements must reopen their trade route before winter.

Concept: a former caravan guard seeking to prevent another disastrous winter expedition. The player completes the normal mechanical choices for protection, travel, or negotiation; these Beliefs do not dictate a single build.

- World: "The settlements will starve if their leaders keep the roads divided. Because I have seen what isolation costs, I will bring them into a common defence agreement."
- Other: "Mara kept our caravan alive when I lost my nerve. I will support her leadership, but I will speak against her when she treats lives as acceptable losses."
- Self: "People are not expendable tools. I will not knowingly sacrifice those in my care merely to secure an advantage."
- Goal: "Secure the mill town's agreement to send a delegate to the road council."
- Instinct: "When we enter an unfamiliar place, I identify an escape route before settling in."

The GM might offer a delegation in exchange for escorting a vulnerable supply caravan through a dangerous pass. The Goal provides direction, capabilities determine options, and the Beliefs make decisions matter. The GM does not predetermine the character's answer.

Compact Templates

- World: I believe [conviction about the campaign situation]; therefore, I will [commitment].
- Other: I believe [conviction about another PC]; therefore, I will [how I act toward them].
- Self: I believe [personal principle]; I will live by it by [commitment], even when [pressure or cost].

3.6 Starting Resources

- Tychē Points: at the start of a session, reset to your Refresh (base 3), keeping any higher balance up to the Refresh + 3 cap (§4.1). Beliefs and connections grant no extra starting points.
- Load-out: choose light, normal or heavy load before the mission, then declare playbook-kit items during play as needed and mark their load; do not buy a complete item list in advance. Signature items are chosen at creation and count against load when carried; always-carried items and items marked (0) follow their listed rules (Generic Playbooks §2.1). During conflicts, declare active equipment before scripting each exchange; declaring or switching gear does not itself change the assigned script (§10.10).

4. Tychē Points

Spend 1 Tychē Point to:

- Invoke — reroll all dice, or add +2 after rolling. This works with any tag or Truth you can justify, even one belonging to the scene or an enemy. Invokes are not limited by the tag cap.
- Declare — establish a minor fact about the scene. The GM may require it to tie to one of your tags.
- Resist harder — reduce one Resistance cost to 0 (§6).

Conflict timing. Invoke during resolution of an eligible roll, not after its outcome is fully resolved. An invoke modifies that roll under the normal procedure; it grants no extra turn, script change, actor reassignment or rescue of a trumped action that makes no roll. Automatic success without a roll has no dice to reroll. Exceptional doubles against opposed totals remain an open ruling (§10.5); this section does not settle them.

Declarations have limits. A minor fact can make an approach possible or establish a relevant asset, but it does not itself resolve a scripted action, cancel independently resolving actions, widen the stakes or reverse an accepted concession. A declaration is not an unrestricted purchase of status tiers, Disposition or larger-scale Truth changes. Apply the normal scope and permission rules (§8, §10.5–10.10).

Zero Resistance cost. Resist harder changes the final pool-point cost of that Resistance to 0, so that payment does not run the pool dry, even if it is already empty (§6.1). It does not restore spent pool points, clear an earlier running-dry status or permit Resistance against ordinary Disposition loss or a protected payment. Resolve the original Resistance normally.

Earn Tychē Points by:

- Compels — the GM or another player offers a meaningful complication based on any character tag (power, weakness, or Scar), any of your World, Other, or Self Beliefs (§3.5), or your Instinct. Accept → +1 Tychē Point. Refuse → pay 1 Tychē Point.
- Compel yourself — propose a compel on one of your own tags, one of your Beliefs, or your Instinct. If the GM agrees it meets the rules below, take the complication and gain +1 Tychē Point. Facing it can also earn XP (§12.1).

Compels

- Meaningful. The complication must change the situation: an obstacle, obligation, exposure, hard choice, or lost opportunity. Flavour or a minor inconvenience doesn't count.
- Clear offer. Before you accept, know which tag, Belief, or Instinct justifies it, what will happen, and what it commits your character to. You otherwise control how your character responds.
- Limits. A compel must follow from the established meaning of the relevant tag, Belief, or Instinct. It adds no numerical penalty, can't cancel a success already resolved, and an existing penalty doesn't earn Tychē just because a tag, Belief, or Instinct explains it.
- *Feared duellist:* a rival challenges you before an audience whose support you need. *Devoted healer:* you stay to treat a dying enemy and lose the chance to pursue their commander.

In a scripted conflict, agree any compel's consequence before acceptance and respect the existing stakes and action timing. A compel is not a free script-change mechanism or permission to cancel an independent action retroactively. If its agreed terms settle the conflict, use the concession procedure rather than adding another roll or an unstated compromise (§10.12). Generic prevention or incidental clearing cannot erase a cost accepted as payment (§10.7).

Beliefs and Compels

All three Belief categories use the same compel procedure. Merely mentioning a Belief or acting in accordance with it does not earn Tychē; the complication must meet the standard above. Several Beliefs supporting one complication still produce only one compel payment. Beliefs do not grant free modifiers and are not additional power tags.

Belief example: your Self Belief rejects sacrificing people for advantage. You propose staying to escort stranded civilians instead of pursuing the fleeing saboteur. Before acceptance, agree that the delay will let the saboteur escape the immediate pursuit. Accepting that meaningful complication earns 1 Tychē Point; it does not dictate every action you take afterward.

Declining a compel uses the normal refusal rule above; simply acting against a Belief is not itself a compel refusal or an automatic penalty (§12.3). An Other Belief never grants control over another PC.

4.1 Refresh

- Base Refresh is 3. At the start of each session, your Tychē Points reset to your Refresh (if you have more, keep them, up to the cap).
- Tychē cap. You can hold at most Refresh + 3 Tychē Points. Any you would gain above the cap are lost.
- At creation you get 1 playbook ability and your Tier 1 Focus ability for free.
- You may take up to 2 additional playbook abilities at creation, at 1 Refresh each.
- Abilities marked ★ (Major) cost 1 Refresh whenever you take them, including through advancement. This is additional to a creation extra's 1-Refresh price: a ★ creation extra costs 2 Refresh total, not 3. The free playbook selection waives the normal selection price, not an applicable ★ cost. Veteran acquisition costs remain additional (Playbook Rules §1.2).
- An attuned artifact (Module A) costs 1 Refresh while attuned, not merely while carried.

- Minimum Refresh is 1. You cannot reduce your Refresh below 1 through these purchases. This is not a minimum current Tychē balance: spending Tychē Points can leave you with 0.
- The advancement option "+1 Refresh" (§12) lets you buy Refresh back.

A new scene, exchange, Inquiry phase or downtime stay does not itself trigger session Refresh. Refresh restores Tychē Points under the rule above; it does not refill pools, heal injuries, refresh an injury trade or restore Disposition. Those use their own procedures.

Design intent: power comes at the cost of narrative flexibility. A low-Refresh character is mechanically strong but has to accept compels to stay fuelled.

5. Effects

Effect	Cost	What it does
Attack	1 Power per tier	Inflict a Status (e.g. *wounded-2*, *rattled-1*, *on fire-3*). In a conflict, an ordinary Attack instead requires at least 1 Power committed to Disposition loss and removes the committed Power + 1 Disposition (§10.6). Apply the +1 base loss once per action; no commitment means no loss. It inflicts no status unless an explicit rule permits one
Weaken	1	Reduce one of the target's statuses by 1 tier, or Burn one of its tags for the scene. During scripted conflicts, requires an explicit ability; ordinary asset denial uses Maneuver's Disarm (§10.6)
Create	2 Power per rank	Create a Truth that lasts for the scene (*smoke cover*, *crowd on our side*). It may end sooner if its removal condition is met. One extra Power makes it last until its removal condition is met. State its scope, rank (1 costs 2 Power; 2 costs 4 Power before discounts) and removal condition (§8)
Enhance	1 per tier	Give an ally a helpful status (*inspired-2*)
Restore	1 per tier	Reduce a harmful status on yourself or an ally. Lasting injuries have limits (§6.6)
Discover	1	Ask the GM one question; you get a true, useful answer
Advance	1 per segment	Tick a progress clock (§7)
Disrupt	3	Cancel or delay an enemy's prepared action, or take 1 point off the GM's Woe. During scripted conflicts, use only as permitted by §10.6; this grants no generic interference with committed scripts
Extra Feat	1	Achieve a second, related goal with the same action. During scripted conflicts, at most once per action unless explicitly overridden; no extra turn or roll, prohibited purchase or duplicate Disposition effect (§10.6)

Each point of Power buys an Effect. Players choose Effects that fit what their character did in the fiction.

Conflict boundaries. The general Effect list gives prices and functions, not permission to purchase every Effect with every scripted action. During conflicts, use the action-specific permissions and purchase limits in §10.6. Fictional relevance is necessary but does not unlock a prohibited purchase.

A successful action may spend all earned Power on permitted supplementary Effects; no primary-effect purchase is mandatory. All purchases share one Power budget. Winning a versus test prevents the opposing action's normal effect even when no Power is spent on Disposition loss or recovery. Independent opposing actions still resolve. A trumped action produces no effect.

Specific exceptions grant only their stated purchase, trigger, cost, frequency and scope. No general Effect grants another scripted action, expands declared stakes or reopens a settled outcome. Do not use Disrupt, Extra Feat or a supporting Truth to retroactively cancel resolved actions.

Separate bonuses. Additional Power, additional Disposition loss and additional status tiers are distinct. Apply a bonus only to its stated component; do not apply one offensive bonus to both loss and a status. Ordinary conflict Attacks and Feints do not drain pools or create injuries through narration alone (§10.6).

Free and healing Effects. Free waives the stated resource cost, not timing, permissions or participation limits (§10.5). Restore treats an existing status; it does not prevent an accepted payment from being recorded, restore Disposition, refresh injury trades or erase Scars. Prevention, redirection, Resistance and incidental clearing benefits cannot cancel protected payments (§10.7).

Create costs and discounts. The baseline is 2 Power per Truth rank, equally inside and outside conflicts. Each explicit Create discount from an ability or item reduces the cost by 1 Power, to a minimum of 1. A relevant tag or Truth does not grant a Create

discount merely by being relevant. Discounts must be stated in the ability or item entry. Larger-scale Truth changes still require their normal clocks or major arcs (Module C.6).

Any unspent Power → Momentum.

5.1 Statuses

- Statuses have tiers 1–6.
- Recording a status. When you create a status, record its name and tier, its scope (who or what it affects, and in which circumstances), and its removal condition (the event, recovery, treatment, or change that ends it). The scope must follow from the fiction. Normal recovery and removal rules still apply. *Mapped patrol routes-2* — evading the patrols you watched; ends when the routes change.
- Stacking: a new status of the same kind raises the existing tier by the new tier minus 1 (minimum +1), so small hits accumulate slowly.
- Tier 6: the target is Taken Out of whatever that status represents (dead, unconscious, captured, convinced, routed), within the status's scope. A harmful status reaching tier 6 also gives one Scar (§6.3), subject to explicit creature-specific breaking-point replacements (§10.14). Death needs a lethal cause and established stakes. Sun-Sick and Thirst use their listed setting outcomes rather than an additional generic Scar; Bled retains the core Scar procedure.
- Statuses modify rolls by ± their tier (use only the highest relevant harmful status and the highest relevant helpful status).
- Same kind. Harm is the same kind when it worsens the same injury, affliction or condition. Renaming it doesn't stop it stacking: another cut worsens *wounded*, renewed menace worsens *terrified*, but a fresh burn needn't stack with a concussion. The GM says whether new harm stacks before you decide to Resist or accept an injury (§10.11).
- Order. Resistance and armour reduce imposed incoming harm before it stacks. They cannot reduce an accepted injury-trade payment or another protected payment (§10.7, §10.11). Harm reduced to tier 0 isn't recorded and doesn't stack. A status can't go above tier 6; extra tiers have no effect unless a rule says so.
- What it hinders. A status modifies only rolls within its recorded scope: *slashed thigh-3* hinders running and climbing, not reading a ledger. A status can also decide what is possible: no roll lets you use a hand you no longer have. If circumstances change, review its scope; don't broaden it just because its name allows another reading.
- Impede is not a status. Impede is the temporary −3 conflict effect in §10.6. It does not stack with another pending Impede and is not removed by Restore merely because Restore removes statuses. An ongoing hindrance needs its own name, tier, scope and removal condition.
- Life-threatening harm. A physical status that reaches tier 6 can make you Dying when lethal stakes are in play (§6.7).

5.2 Example Statuses

Statuses can describe physical, mental, emotional, or social circumstances. The following names are examples, not a closed list. When recording one, give it a tier, a specific scope, and a removal condition (§5.1). Use a more precise name whenever it makes the effect clearer. These examples grant no new permission to purchase or inflict statuses; normal Effect costs and conflict permissions still apply.

Helpful status	Typical scope
Inspired	Acting on renewed hope, encouragement, or conviction.
Focused	Concentrating, analysing information, or resisting distraction.
Composed	Maintaining restraint and clarity under emotional or social pressure.
Prepared	Acting on specific plans, reconnaissance, or rehearsed procedures.
Supported	Drawing on established backing from allies, a crowd, or an institution.
Trusted	Persuading or reassuring a particular person or group that believes in you.

Harmful status	Typical scope
Wounded	Physical actions affected by a particular injury.
Exhausted	Sustained effort using the depleted physical or mental capacity.
Unsteady	Balance, coordination, reflexes, or precise movement.
Rattled	Concentration and clear thinking after shock, confusion, or intimidation.
Terrified	Facing, approaching, or acting against a particular source of fear.
Discredited	Claims and appeals made to an audience whose trust has been damaged.

Make the scope specific. Prepared and Supported need an established basis: name the plan, information, allies, or backing involved. One circumstance does not automatically grant a status and a separate tag or Truth benefit; establish and apply each component by its own rules. Trusted and Discredited apply to a named audience and subject, not everyone or every interaction. They are not universal reputation scores and do not automatically decide what another character believes. Exhausted should identify the depleted capacity rather than penalise everything.

Recording examples.

- *Mapped patrol routes-2*: helps evade the observed patrols; ends when their routes change.
- *Trusted by the village council-2*: helps persuade the council about local threats within your established credibility; ends when that trust is withdrawn or betrayed.
- *Mentally exhausted-3*: hinders sustained mental work; ends through appropriate recovery (§6.5).
- *Discredited before the merchant guild-2*: hinders claims about the disputed shipment made to the guild; ends when the accusation is disproved or credibility is restored.

Special conditions stay separate. These examples use the normal tiered-status rules. Grind conditions — Hungry & Thirsty, Weary, Exposed, Shaken, Sick, and Broken — use their listed effects and recovery requirements (Module B.3), not generic tiers inferred from their order. Running-dry statuses also follow their pool-specific procedure (§6.2). Impede is a temporary conflict effect, not a status (§10.6).

6. Resistance, Harm and Recovery

When an imposed consequence lands on you (a status, lost gear, a bad position), you may Resist, subject to the exclusions below:

1. Choose the pool that fits (see §3.2: Sōma for harm, Mētis to dodge, Psychē against deception and confusion, Pneuma against fear and the supernatural).
2. Roll a number of d12s equal to 2 + that pool's Edge and read only the highest die. If penalties take the pool's Edge below 0, see Negative Edge below.
3. Pay the listed cost in pool points. Don't subtract Edge from it; Edge has already helped by adding dice. If two or more dice show 12, pay 0 and clear one tier-1 status:

Roll	Cost	2d	3d	4d	5d
Two 12s	0 + clear a tier-1	1%	2%	4%	6%
9–12	1	55%	68%	77%	81%
5–8	2	33%	26%	19%	13%
1–4	3	11%	4%	1%	<1%

4. Effect: reduce the incoming status by 2 tiers (to 0 if that brings it below 1), or turn a severe consequence into a lesser one.

The chance columns show Edge 0 to 3 (2d to 5d). A single 12 is simply a highest die in the 9–12 band. When an ability says your Edge counts as 1 higher for a Resist, or gives Edge +1 to it, roll one more die; a penalty to Edge (such as *Exposed* or *Shaken*) rolls one fewer.

Negative Edge. Penalties can take Edge below 0 for a Resist:

- Edge −1: roll 1d12.
- Edge −2 or lower: roll a number of d12s equal to the Edge without its minus sign (2d12 at −2, 3d12 at −3, and so on), and read only the lowest die.

Pay the listed cost for the die you read. A single die can't give the double-12 result. When you keep the lowest, the double-12 result needs every die to show 12. The chance columns show Edge −1 (1d), −2 (2d, lowest) and −3 (3d, lowest).

Roll	Cost	−1	−2	−3
All 12s	0 + clear a tier-1	—	1%	<1%
9–12	1	33%	10%	4%
5–8	2	33%	33%	26%
1–4	3	33%	56%	70%

Resistance result and ability thresholds. The Resistance result is the die read by the normal procedure: highest at Edge 0 or higher, the single die at Edge −1, and lowest at Edge −2 or lower. When an ability changes a Resistance cost or effect on a stated die threshold, check that threshold against this result. For these abilities, wording such as "on a highest die of 5+" means "when the Resistance result is 5+"; do not inspect a different die to qualify. An ability that intentionally uses a different die must expressly say that it overrides the normal Resistance result.

Meeting a threshold grants only the stated benefit. It does not change which die is read, add dice, alter Edge or permit Resistance against an excluded consequence. A threshold-based cost benefit and a separately listed effect are distinct. If an ability says the cost is 0 on a result of 5+ and reduces a status by 3 tiers, the threshold governs the zero cost only; the listed reduction applies whenever you legally use that ability to Resist unless its text expressly makes the reduction conditional too.

Apply the existing special double-12 procedure normally, including the all-dice-12 requirement when reading the lowest. An ability that makes the cost 0 does not itself grant that procedure's tier-1 status-clearing benefit. A zero final cost does not run the pool dry (§6.1), and protected-payment restrictions still apply.

Example: at Edge −2, dice of 3 and 10 give a Resistance result of 3. An ability's 5+ zero-cost threshold is not met; use the normal cost for 3, while retaining any independently listed effect improvement. Dice of 5, 9 and 12 at Edge −3 give a result of 5 and meet the threshold.

Imposed harm, in order. When an effect imposes a harmful status:

1. The GM names the status, its source and its incoming tier, and says whether it stacks with a status you already have (§5.1).
2. If you Resist, add any armour that applies (Playbook Rules §2.3) and pay the cost. A cost you can't fully pay makes you run dry (§6.1).
3. Record what is left with normal stacking. A status reduced to tier 0 isn't recorded.

Once per application. Resist each application of harm once. You can't make a second attempt against the same harm.

What Resistance can't touch. Resistance changes an imposed consequence. It doesn't reverse the action's success, restore lost Disposition or revoke an agreed outcome. You can't Resist:

- ordinary Disposition loss in a conflict (§10.6);
- an injury you accepted to cancel Disposition loss (§10.11);
- a cost you accepted in a concession (§10.12), or any other cost you accepted as payment for a benefit;
- a running-dry status (§6.2).

An exception must expressly identify the protected payment or Disposition effect it changes. Generic permission to cancel harm or a consequence is not enough (§10.7). Imposed compromise statuses remain Resistable under §10.13; Resistance does not revoke the loser's concession, and removing an injury does not create a replacement cost.

Protected payments. Prevention, redirection, immunity, Resistance and effects that clear a status as an incidental benefit (such as the double-12 result above) can't prevent or remove an accepted payment, whichever action or Resistance produced the clearing benefit. This includes injury trades, running-dry

statuses, agreed concession costs and other accepted payments. Treatment, healing time and effects that explicitly heal an existing injury affect it normally (§6.6); later healing doesn't refund the benefit, restore Disposition, refresh the trade or erase a Scar.

6.1 Running Dry

Trigger. You run dry when a positive cost brings a pool to 0 or is more than the points left in it. Finish the action or Resistance that caused the cost, then take a harmful running-dry status for that pool (§6.2). Running dry does not, on its own, take you out, give you a Scar or refill the pool.

Overrun. Work out the final cost after Edge (for Effort), Tychē and every other permitted reduction, then compare it with the points left in the pool:

- Overrun = final cost − points left (minimum 0).
- Incoming status tier = 1 + overrun (recorded at tier 6 at most).

Spend the points you have. A pool can't go below 0, and the unpaid excess does not move to another pool.

Points left	Final cost	Overrun	Incoming status
3	2	0	None (1 point left)
3	3	0	Tier 1
1	2	1	Tier 2
1	3	2	Tier 3
0	3	3	Tier 4
0	5	5	Tier 6

Overrun beyond tier 6 has no extra effect unless a rule or an established stake says so.

Which costs can overrun. Only Resistance and costs imposed on you. Effort, Help and ability activation costs must be paid in full unless the ability says it can overrun. You may spend your exact last points on purpose: the pool runs dry and you take a tier-1 status. A cost you accept as payment for a benefit is not an imposed cost.

Pay as you go. Pay each cost at the point its rule says, and resolve any running dry straight away. If that status takes you out, finish only the action or Resistance whose cost caused it: you can't add more Effort, buy more Power or activate more abilities for that action. The action still resolves. If it is one of two independent actions in a volley, both resolve before victory is checked (§10.12).

Separate costs stay separate. Each cost listed separately is its own payment. You can't split one cost into smaller payments, or combine separate costs, to change overrun or stacking. When one effect takes several points from the same pool at once, total them as one imposed cost unless the effect says otherwise. Costs from different pools are resolved separately.

Resisting on empty. You can Resist with a low or empty pool unless your condition prevents it (§6.4), and the Resistance still takes effect. Resolve protection, the Resistance and the original consequence first, then apply the running-dry status. The new status doesn't penalise that Resistance roll or undo its result.

Zero costs. A final cost of 0 never makes you run dry, even if the pool is already empty. Being at 0 isn't an event in itself: you don't take a new status because time passes, a new turn begins, or you take an action that costs nothing. A later positive Resistance cost or imposed cost can make you run dry again.

Empty pools. An empty pool has no penalty of its own. It doesn't remove Disposition or take you out; its running-dry status does that work. You can keep acting with other resources or with actions that cost nothing. The pool stays at 0 until rest restores it (§6.5). There is no automatic refill.

NPCs. Ordinary NPCs don't have pools and never run dry. Spending Woe on an NPC creates no status, and Woe can't be overrun: if the GM can't pay an ability's Woe cost, the NPC can't use that ability. An NPC built with full PC pools runs dry normally.

RUNNING DRY IN ORDER

1. Pay each cost when its rule says.
2. If the cost empties or overruns the pool, work out the overrun.
3. Impose that pool's running-dry status at tier 1 + overrun.
4. Stack it with the same status if you already have it (§5.1).
5. At tier 6, apply the status's scope, then record one Scar (§6.3).
6. Recover the pool and the status separately (§6.5).

6.2 Running-Dry Statuses

The status must fit both the pool and the action that drained it:

Pool	Example running-dry statuses
Sōma	*physically exhausted*, *muscular strain*
Mētis	*unsteady*, *reflexes overloaded*
Psychē	*mentally exhausted*, *cognitive overload*
Pneuma	*resolve fractured*, *spiritually drained*

Set it up once. When you first record the status, set its name, its scope and its recovery category (§6.5). The name decides which rolls it hinders.

One status per pool. The first time a pool runs dry, that status becomes the pool's depletion status for the rest of the continuous ordeal. Write the pool beside it. Running dry in that pool again worsens the same status, unless a genuinely different cause calls for a different consequence. A new name or description is not a different cause. Each running-dry event worsens only one status.

Example. You have *mentally exhausted-2* and overrun Psychē by 2. The incoming status is tier 3, which stacks for +2, so you now have *mentally exhausted-4*.

It is a cost. Armour, Resistance and effects that cancel incoming consequences can't prevent or reduce a running-dry status. Once recorded, it can be treated, Restored or healed like any existing status, within the limits of the effect used. A clearing benefit from the same Resistance or action can't clear the status that paid for it.

6.3 Tier 6 and Scars

When a harmful status reaches tier 6, whether in one hit or through stacking, apply this general procedure unless a specific rule expressly replaces its breaking-point outcome:

1. Resolve its tier-6 outcome (§5.1).
2. Apply removal within the status's scope (below).
3. Record one Scar, subject to the limits below.

Specific replacements. Named creature tracks and conditions use an explicit breaking-point replacement only where stated (§10.14). Sun-Sick uses its listed collapse and prolonged-exposure consequences; Thirst uses Blood Crisis and its listed Scar consequences; neither adds an unstated generic tier-6 Scar. Bled retains this core Scar procedure. Apply limits against duplicate Scars from one event.

Scope. If the status leaves you unable to pursue your side's intent in the current conflict, you are Taken Out. Your side's shared Disposition doesn't change (§10.9). If none of a side's participants can continue pursuing its objective, that side loses; complete independently resolving actions before checking victory (§10.12). If the status only stops one activity (*bound* stops you moving, not talking), apply that restriction and stay in the conflict. Set the scope of a non-damage status when it is inflicted, and don't widen it at tier 6. Under the general procedure, either result still gives its Scar.

Not lethal by default. A running-dry status at tier 6 is not deadly on its own. Death needs a lethal cause and established stakes. Tier 6 doesn't, by itself, cost you a limb, lower a maximum pool or impose any other permanent loss; those need an established consequence, a specific effect or an agreement.

The Scar. The status records your current condition; the Scar records the lasting mark of reaching the breaking point. The player and GM agree on a Scar that fits what happened. A Scar can't introduce an unrelated injury, dictate an unrelated belief, or extend the opposition's victory beyond the stakes. Label it with the pool most tied to the condition (a *Pneuma Scar*):

Tier-6 status	Possible Scar
physically exhausted	*my old injury gives out under strain*
reflexes overloaded	*hesitates when everything moves at once*
cognitive overload	*gaps in the memory of that night*
terrified	*can't forget what was behind the door*
resolve fractured	*doubts the oath that once sustained me*
bound or *captured*	*can't bear being restrained*

Scar limits.

- One per episode. A status gives a Scar the first time it reaches tier 6 under this general procedure. More harm while it stays at tier 6, or lowering it and raising it again in the same episode, gives no further Scar.
- One per event. A single action or hazard can give a character at most one Scar, even if it takes several statuses to tier 6. Only an ability that says so can give more than one.
- Scar Recorded. Mark every status that reached tier 6 in a Scar-giving event as *Scar Recorded* for the rest of the continuous ordeal, even if the status is later cleared. Remove the mark only when the status is fully cleared and the scene or ordeal is over. The mark is bookkeeping only, not a status or a penalty.
- Don't split one condition into several differently named statuses to gain or avoid Scars.

Scar effects. A Scar is a lasting weakness tag, not a status. Apply it when it's relevant, and it can be compelled for Tychē Points. Rest, treatment, Restore and pool recovery don't remove a Scar; changing one takes an Advance, a milestone or an explicit ability. If a Scar and a harmful status describe the same impairment on the same roll, apply only the larger penalty. Your fourth Scar retires the character from ordinary adventuring. Finish the immediate scene, then decide with the player how the character leaves. Retirement doesn't mean death.

6.4 Being Taken Out

Ways out. You are Taken Out of a conflict when a harmful status reaches tier 6 within its scope (§6.3), when an effect says so, when you voluntarily withdraw, or when an established circumstance prevents you from pursuing your side's objective (§10.9). Ordinary Disposition loss never takes an individual out. Once you are out, you can't start another action, spend Effort or activate an ability unless its rules let you act while Taken Out.

Disposition stays with the side. Being Taken Out doesn't directly change your side's shared Disposition. Your side loses your skills, abilities and help, and if none of its participants can continue pursuing its objective, it loses after independent actions finish (§10.9, §10.12).

Out isn't down. Being Taken Out doesn't, on its own, make you unconscious, injured or dying. Describe it to fit the fiction: pinned down, disarmed, driven back, cut off, or too frightened to go on. Injury needs a status, death needs established lethal stakes (§6.7), and permanent harm needs an established consequence (§6.8).

Resisting while out. Being Taken Out doesn't automatically stop you Resisting, but the Resistance must be something you can still do. You can brace against pain while pinned down, but you can't dodge while fully *bound*, or use an act of will while unconscious. When a status first takes you out, finish any Resistance already under way. Resistance can't reverse a defeat, undo an accepted concession, or prevent a cost you accepted as payment. Once a conflict is settled, you can only Resist the consequences that were left open to it; you can't use Resistance to reopen the intent or delay settlement.

Getting back in. To rejoin a conflict that is still going, and that your side hasn't lost, you need both of these:

1. the condition that stopped you must be removed; and
2. an ability or rule must explicitly let a Taken Out character return.

Returning doesn't restore any of your side's Disposition unless the ability says so.

An ordinary Defend can't bring back a Taken Out ally unless its rules say it can. If you recover after the conflict is over, you act normally in the scenes that follow, subject to your remaining statuses.

6.5 Rest and Recovery

Recovery follows four successive rest stages:

Rest	Time required	Recovery
First	A few seconds; one action during an encounter	Roll 1d12, halve the result and round up
Second	10 minutes	Roll 1d12, halve the result and round up, then add 1
Third	1 hour	Roll 1d12, halve the result and round up, then add 2
Fourth	10 hours, usually overnight	Restore all four pools to full

- Divide the recovered points among Sōma, Mētis, Psychē and Pneuma however you wish, without exceeding a pool's maximum. They don't have to go to whichever pool was drained most recently.
- Edge does not apply to recovery. Edge only reduces Effort cost and adds Resistance dice (§2.4, §6); recovery stays flat so it can't stack with Edge's other benefits.
- After the 4th rest, the cycle resets — your next rest that day (or the start of a new day) is a First rest again.
- Each PC rests and rolls independently. If two of five party members stop for 10 minutes to recover, the other three don't have to stop or roll.
- Running dry has no automatic refill. A pool at 0 comes back through these rests in the normal way. Its running-dry status recovers separately, as described below.

Recovering running-dry statuses. Restoring a pool doesn't clear its running-dry status, and clearing the status doesn't refill the pool. When you first record the status, choose its category:

- Depletion (exhaustion, strain, temporary overload): the default, unless the source makes it an injury or affliction. It recovers through rest, as described below.
- Injury (real physical damage): recovers through treatment, Restore and healing time, like any wound.
- Affliction (supernatural or ongoing cause): recovers only as its source allows.

Resting off depletion *(playtest value)*. When you take one of the 1st–3rd rests, you can put the recovery roll toward the pool, toward its depletion status, or split it between them. Every 2 points removes 1 tier of the depletion status. Each point counts once. The 4th rest (full restore) also clears any depletion status whose cause has ended. It doesn't clear Scars, injuries or afflictions. Reassurance or first aid can make recovery possible, but can't keep stripping depletion tiers with Restore. Abilities that explicitly restore exhaustion or harmful statuses work as written.

No shortcut. Running dry never gives a special recovery roll, an automatic refill, or a way around the rest cycle. You can't overrun a pool on purpose to replace a bad recovery roll or to jump to a fresh rest stage.

Each layer recovers on its own. Disposition, pools and statuses each recover only through their own procedure:

- Disposition is set fresh when a genuinely new conflict begins (§10.2). Fresh Disposition doesn't refill pools or clear statuses, and a brief pause in the same struggle isn't a new conflict.
- Pools recover through the rests above. A full pool doesn't heal an injury, and an injury doesn't stop pool recovery unless its rule says so.
- Statuses recover by their kind: a temporary state ends when its cause or duration ends; injuries need treatment and time (§6.6); afflictions follow their source.

Winning a conflict, ending a scene or setting fresh Disposition is not a general reset. Later healing does not refund an accepted payment, refresh an injury trade or erase a Scar (§10.7).

Advance option — Hardened *(6 XP, one-time)*

Recover 1 additional point whenever you make a recovery roll. This Advance may be taken only once. It does not change the fourth rest's full recovery.

6.6 Treatment and Healing

Appropriate care. Treatment must address the cause of the harm:

Harm	Typical care
Wounds, blood loss, poison	Medicine and suitable supplies
Fear, grief, shock	Empathy, reassurance and safety
Confusion, cognitive disruption	Diagnosis, rest or specialist care
Damaged machines or implants	Science or Craft, tools and access
Curses, possession, corruption	A fitting supernatural method or the source's stated cure

A skill doesn't supply the tools, knowledge or fictional permission on its own.

Routine care. In safe conditions, when failure would add nothing, care needs no roll. It gives permission to treat, stabilises where nothing is uncertain, and meets the conditions for natural recovery. It generates no Power. If ordinary treatment could remove one tier of a lasting injury and success is routine, remove that tier and mark the injury *treated* there's no surplus Power or Momentum. Roll only when an uncertain result matters, never just to farm Momentum.

Emergency care stops an injury getting worse: stopping bleeding, splinting a limb, pulling someone away from a harmful influence, isolating a damaged power cell. It doesn't normally reduce the tier. When the outcome is uncertain, roll the treatment skill vs. Standard 15, adjusted by Truths. On a success, the deterioration stops or treatment can begin. On a Success at a Cost, the same, with the normal cost. On a failure, the condition is still untreated; the GM announces any further consequence before another attempt. During scripted conflicts, use the conflict-specific consequence restrictions (§10.7).

Restore on lasting injuries. Restore costs 1 Power per tier (§5). It can clear a temporary condition outright when the action removes its cause: putting out burning clothes reduces *on fire*, calming an ally reduces fear. Lasting injuries are slower:

- Ordinary treatment reduces a given lasting injury by at most 1 tier. Mark it *treated*.
- Further ordinary treatment can't reduce it again until a healing interval (below) actually removes a tier from it. Interrupting rest, changing healers, renaming the injury or starting a new scene doesn't clear the mark, and new harm to the same injury doesn't refresh it. A separate injury has its own mark.
- Spare Power buys other fitting Effects or becomes Momentum as normal.
- Abilities, cyphers and items that explicitly heal a stated number of tiers (such as *healing gel*) follow their own text. Abilities that only change the cost of Restore don't lift the 1-tier limit.

Care in a conflict. Treating someone under opposition uses your action. Emergency care can be a Defend only where the conflict type or an ability allows its skill (such as *Battlefield Surgeon*). Restoring Disposition keeps your side in the contest; it doesn't heal an injury unless the action's rules also provide a healing effect. Healing an injury does not return a Taken Out ally unless the return requirements in §6.4 are met.

Healing intervals *(playtest values)*. Once a lasting injury has had appropriate care and its cause has stopped, safe rest removes one tier per interval. Use the injury's current tier:

Current tier	Safe recovery to remove 1 tier
1	One full night
2	One full day
3	Three full days
4	One full week
5	Appropriate treatment, then one full week
6, not lethal	Remove the incapacitating cause and set a recovery method
6, life-threatening	Stabilise, then definitive care before natural recovery begins (§6.7)

These are game-time intervals, not medical estimates. A full night is the normal overnight rest; a full day is 24 hours in recovery conditions; a full week is seven such days. Intervals can overlap pool rests. Recovery needs shelter, food and care that suit the injury. Light activity is fine; strenuous activity that aggravates the injury stops recovery.

Timing.

- When an injury's tier changes, its next interval uses the new tier.
- If treatment or healing lowers the tier, keep the qualifying time already spent. If that time already meets the new interval, remove one tier and start the next interval at zero. One change can complete only one interval.
- If fresh harm raises the tier, discard progress and start a new interval at the higher tier. Separate injuries don't reset each other.
- A brief interruption pauses recovery; it doesn't erase it. A bad roll on an unrelated action doesn't worsen an injury; that needs a relevant danger or a stated consequence.

Afflictions (poison, disease, possession, curses, ongoing exposure) don't follow the interval table. When the affliction is identified, its source sets what worsens it, what suppresses it, what allows recovery, and whether treatment cures it or only eases the symptoms. A setting book can give specific afflictions, and creatures that recover in unusual ways, their own rules; where it does, those rules win.

6.7 Dying and Stabilisation

Becoming Dying. After Resistance and stacking, life-threatening physical harm that reaches tier 6 makes a living character Dying, if lethal stakes allow that outcome (§10.2). It also gives a Scar as normal (§6.3), unless an explicit breaking-point replacement applies. The character is incapacitated and can't take ordinary actions. Start a 3-segment Dying clock. There is no extra *dying* penalty; the injury already records the harm. Mental defeat,

capture, exhaustion and ordinary fear never start a Dying clock, and a running-dry status is never lethal on its own.

Cadence. When Dying begins, set how the clock advances: at the end of each exchange after the one in which Dying began, during a scripted conflict; or after a stated fictional interval, outside one. The clock advances because the interval passes, not because someone attempts treatment. Several characters can act in the same interval without advancing it further. Moving into or out of a scripted conflict carries the existing deadline over; it doesn't advance the clock or grant extra time.

Further harm. Each further unmitigated physical harm that could worsen the mortal injury marks one extra segment, even though the injury stays at tier 6. One action or hazard can mark at most one extra segment. When the third segment is marked, the character dies.

Stabilising. An adjacent character with suitable means rolls Medicine vs. Hard 18, adjusted by Truths. An ability or a fitting supernatural method can offer another way.

- Success: the patient is stable and the clock stops.
- Success at a Cost: stable, with the normal cost, subject to §10.7 inside conflicts.
- Failure: still Dying. The attempt uses the action, but doesn't advance the clock.

Stabilising doesn't erase marked segments, reduce the injury, refill pools or return the patient to the conflict. A stable patient can be moved with care. If a new event makes them Dying again, the clock resumes from its recorded segments.

Definitive care. Emergency care can stabilise a tier-6 life-threatening injury but can't lower its tier. Lowering it below tier 6 takes definitive care: a suitable procedure, facility or specialist, or an ability or item that explicitly heals the injury (such as *Miracle Worker*, *Not on My Table* or *healing gel*). The GM states what that requires when the injury is assessed and doesn't add requirements once they are met. When definitive care brings the injury below tier 6 and removes its immediate lethal cause, clear the Dying clock.

Immediate death. Use it only when the established outcome leaves no plausible time for rescue, or a specific killing method calls for it (such as a creature's killing strike in a setting book). Announce that danger before the roll, and allow Resistance, escape or interruption where their rules permit it; accepted payments cannot be cancelled through these general options. Once such an outcome is fully resolved, don't add a Dying clock to undo it; equally, don't skip the clock for an ordinary mortal wound just because the description is graphic. Resolve permitted post-conflict finishing procedures before compromise (§10.12).

Setting-specific harm. Use a condition's specific tiers, treatment and breaking-point rules where stated. Replace the core Dying clock only if its rule explicitly supplies an alternative death or stabilisation procedure; different condition tiers alone do not replace it. Testament of Dust's Bled uses its own tiers and recovery rules but retains the core three-segment Dying clock at lethal Bled-6. Do not run a second death deadline alongside it.

After a death. Resolve the death and its established consequences. The group may remember the character through Beliefs, relationships, keepsakes or later story developments; death creates no separate points or automatic Truth.

6.8 Permanent Harm

Where it comes from. An injury doesn't become permanent just because its tier is high. Permanent harm needs an established permanent-injury stake, a specific effect or creature rule, a voluntary bargain, or a Scar-giving event. Generic harmful tier 6 gives a Scar (§6.3), subject to explicit breaking-point replacements, but never by itself severs a limb, destroys an organ, lowers a maximum pool or causes any other permanent mechanical loss.

The wound heals; the loss stays. A permanent change can outlast the injury that caused it. When *severed hand-4* has healed, the hand is still gone: the status measured the acute wound. Record the lasting change as a tag or a character fact, not as a status that never heals.

Adapting. Training, help, prostheses, old-world works or supernatural intervention can change how permanent harm affects play. A replacement doesn't automatically remove a related Scar, and a Scar doesn't make a replacement useless. Don't reduce maximum pools, Edge, skills or Refresh unless the effect or an agreed Advance says so.

7. Progress Clocks

- Sizes: 4 (simple), 6 (complex), 8 (daunting), 12 (epic). Specific rules may prescribe other sizes, such as the 3-segment Dying clock (§6.7).
- Player clocks tick with the Advance effect (1 Power = 1 segment).
- Danger clocks tick when the GM spends Woe (1 Woe = 1 segment) or when an established failure consequence or explicit procedure advances them. An ordinary failed scripted conflict action does not also authorise an unrelated clock tick or GM move (§10.7).
- Racing clocks: two clocks run together (e.g. *Crack the vault 8* vs. *Guards arrive 6*).
- Linked clocks: filling one opens or unlocks another.
- Downtime projects normally use 8- or 12-segment clocks; a specific ability or project may prescribe another size, including 6 segments.

Specific procedures govern. A clock's own rule sets its triggers, cadence and permitted spends. The Grind's 2-Woe tick and one tick per exchange for conflict action rolls (Module B), and the Dying clock's stated intervals and further-harm triggers (§6.7), are not replaced by the generic danger-clock line. A failed treatment attempt does not itself advance the Dying clock.

Clocks are not Disposition. A Journey or project clock measures its named goal; shared Disposition measures a side's ability to pursue its conflict objective. Do not convert loss, healing or clock progress between them without an explicit rule. The general Advance effect does not add a clock-spending option to every scripted action; use the action's permitted effects or a specific exception (§10.6).

8. Truths

Truths are tags that describe the scene, location, faction, or campaign.

- Scene Truths: *Pitch Dark*, *Knee-Deep Water*, *Hostile Crowd*. Each relevant Truth raises or lowers Difficulty by one step (±3) per rank, makes an action impossible or possible, or can be invoked with a Tychē Point.
- Rank. A Truth is rank 1 unless a number follows its name: *Pitch Dark 2* shifts Difficulty by two steps (±6). Rank 2 is the most a Truth can have; anything stronger makes the action impossible.
- Truth cap. Easier and harder Truths cancel step for step. Whatever is left shifts a roll's Difficulty by at most three steps (±9).
- Campaign Truths: 3–5 world statements agreed at session zero (*Magic is real but feared*, *The Corporation owns the police*).
- Creating Truths: players use the Create effect or spend 2 Momentum; the GM spends 2 Woe. A new Truth is rank 1. Pay the same cost again, at once or later, to raise it to rank 2. The GM may also allow this for an existing Truth when the fiction supports it (*Thick Mist* thickening into *Thick Mist 2*).
- Recording a Truth. When a Truth is created, or an existing fact first matters mechanically, state its scope (the people, objects, place, or circumstances it affects), its rank and its removal condition. It only applies within its scope. It also ends when its duration expires; a removal condition never extends a duration (§5). *Smoke fills the courtyard* — sight-based actions in the courtyard; ends when the smoke clears.
- Removing Truths: use the Weaken or Create effect as a counter ("I kill the lights" removes *Brightly Lit*), at GM discretion. Each counter lowers a Truth by one rank, and a rank-1 Truth that is countered is gone.

Conflict permissions. Truths shift Difficulty or establish what is possible; their rank is not an automatic bonus to the action total, Power, Disposition or status tier. Independent conflict tests use Standard 15 plus applicable Truths and explicit modifiers such as Guard (§10.5). Creating or countering a Truth during a conflict still requires a permitted action or explicit exception. The general counter options above do not add Weaken to every ordinary Maneuver, and a Momentum or Woe spend grants no extra scripted turn, free actor reassignment or retroactive cancellation.

Scope is not a free effect. A Truth can establish a feature for a later scenery Maneuver, but creating it does not also resolve that

Maneuver or its Danger (§10.8). A hazardous description does not by itself grant shared Disposition loss and a harmful status together. Explicit harm and area effects follow their own procedures (§10.7, §10.17).

Scale and preparation. Scene-scale Create and currency spends do not by themselves rewrite Site, Region or Campaign Truths; use the projects and major arcs in Module C. A relevant prepared asset can retain its normal action benefit and contribute to an eligible Superiority category, but one fact does not automatically qualify for several categories (§10.3).

See Module C for using Truths to drive a sandbox campaign.

9. Momentum and Woe

9.1 Momentum (shared by the party, max 6)

Gain: unspent Power from rolls. Decay: lose 1 Momentum at the end of each scene.

Spend	Cost
Add a bonus die	1 (first) / 2 (second)
+1 Power on a success	2
Ask the GM a question (Discover)	1
Create a Truth	2
Change one unrevealed scripted action in a conflict (§10.5)	2
Reduce Woe by 1	2

Script timing. Change an action before its volley is revealed. Keep its assigned actor unless an explicit ability permits reassignment. This spend does not grant initiative cancellation, an extra turn, a rotation bypass or permission to cancel an independently resolving action.

Paying with Woe. When the party is short, any spend in this table except *Reduce Woe* can be paid in whole or in part by giving the GM 1 Woe per Momentum, with the GM's approval. Bonus dice can always be paid this way (§2.4). This existing permission also applies to script changes, subject to their normal timing and restrictions.

9.2 Woe (the GM's pool)

Starting Woe: 2 per PC at the start of a session. GM gains Woe from: players buying dice or other Momentum spends with Woe, Success at a Cost (if chosen), failures (+1), complications bought off (+2), refused compels, Escalation (+1, §9.3), and dangerous scene Truths (+1 per scene).

GM spend	Cost
Complication or minor twist	1
Tick a danger clock	1 per segment
NPC bonus die	1 per die
Activate an NPC/monster special ability	1–3
Create a Truth	2
Reinforcements	1 per minion, 3 for a significant NPC
Change one unrevealed action in the NPC side's script (§10.5)	3
Cancel an NPC's complication from the dice (§2.6)	2
Make a roll Risky 1, or raise its Risk by 1 (§2.7)	1

Conflict consequences. Use §10.7 for ordinary failure and Success at a Cost inside conflicts. Do not add an unrelated GM move, automatic injury or extra Disposition loss merely because an action failed. Explicit Woe spends, Specials, hazards and Risky rolls retain their stated effects.

Woe timing and scope. Purchased complications must fit the stakes and timing. They do not retroactively alter committed scripts or cancel independently resolving actions unless an explicit rule permits it. Script changes must occur before the affected volley is revealed; use explicit ability exceptions at their stated timing. Woe cannot cancel an accepted payment through generic consequence-prevention wording (§10.7).

9.3 Escalation

Some acts and items make a situation more dangerous just by being there. They carry the Escalation tag. It gives no bonus and doesn't count toward the tag cap.

- Escalation items. Openly carrying an Escalation item into a scene gives the GM +1 Woe, once per item per scene. An item hidden before the scene starts doesn't count until it's drawn.

- Escalation actions. Declaring an Escalation action (reading a forbidden text, waking a dead machine, breaking a sacred taboo) gives the GM +1 Woe before any roll.
- Keep it rare. A playbook's starting kit should hold no more than one or two Escalation items. Settings list their own.

10. Conflict System

Use a scripted conflict for a consequential struggle in which opposing sides can make several meaningful tactical decisions. A conflict might be a fight, chase, argument, negotiation, infiltration, battle, supernatural contest, or struggle against a dangerous environment.

Each side declares an intent, establishes its starting Disposition, and secretly chooses three actions. Reveal and resolve those actions one volley at a time. Continue until one side wins, both sides are defeated, or the participants agree to a concession.

Disposition measures a side's ability to keep pursuing its objective. It is not health, ammunition, morale alone, or a count of individual participants.

10.1 When to Use a Conflict

Use a scripted conflict when all three conditions are present:

- The outcome matters enough to deserve sustained attention.
- An opponent or significant force can actively resist the intended outcome.
- Several meaningful tactical choices could change how the struggle ends.

Otherwise, use an ordinary roll or resolve the situation without rolling. A named opponent, a dangerous situation, or a large group does not automatically require a conflict.

Each Side Needs an Objective

State what each side wants to accomplish, not merely what it wants to prevent. Suitable objectives include:

- Hold the bridge until the refugees cross.
- Capture the courier before she reaches the harbour.
- Convince the council to release the prisoners.
- Escape the hunters without revealing the refuge.
- Reach shelter before the storm cuts off the pass.

An objective may be defensive. Holding the bridge until the refugees cross gives the defenders something concrete to achieve. Merely stopping the enemy usually needs more definition.

Environmental opposition also needs a stated outcome: the storm strands the travellers, the fire consumes the archive, or the river carries away the crossing.

10.2 Setup

Complete these steps before scripting:

1. Declare intent and stakes.
2. Choose the conflict type.
3. Establish participants and sides.
4. Calculate starting Disposition.
5. Apply Superiority to both sides and resolve any setup defeat (§10.3).
6. Record the adjusted starting Disposition.
7. Establish the acting order and script the first exchange.

Intent and Stakes

Each side states what it gains by winning. Establish what losing allows the opposition to do and whether capture, death, permanent injury, exposure, or another lasting consequence is possible.

Discuss what withdrawal or concession could look like.

Intent limits victory. Defeating a side whose objective is to hold a doorway does not automatically let the winner kill everyone, seize unrelated possessions, or achieve another objective.

Lethal Stakes

Establish lethal stakes before the roll or exchange that could produce a lethal outcome.

Stakes may change when circumstances change, but never retroactively. Explain the new danger and allow affected participants to respond before resolving it.

Lethal stakes make death possible, not automatic (§10.12).

Participants

A participant must be able to contribute to the side's objective. Helping to establish starting Disposition commits a character to that side's stakes. Helping an action during the conflict likewise makes the helper a participant if they were not already involved.

A character who cannot meaningfully contribute may remain outside the conflict. Do not include them merely to increase Disposition. Companions and groups follow §10.9.

Starting Disposition

The leader normally rolls 2d12 + Disposition skill + highest Edge in that skill's pool. Divide the result by three, rounding down. Then:

- Add +1 per eligible helper.
- Apply flat starting-Disposition bonuses and penalties from abilities, creature rank, conditions, and similar effects; these have no stacking cap.
- Apply a minimum of 1.
- Apply opposing Superiority (§10.3).

Record the adjusted total. It remains the recovery cap and compromise reference under §10.9.

Setup Help costs no pool points. Before the leader rolls, each helper explains a meaningful contribution and commits to the

side's stakes. Each eligible helper adds +1 Disposition, without an ordinary Help bonus die.

A free-Help ability provides no additional setup bonus unless expressly stated. Later removal follows §10.9; do not recalculate setup.

Adversary exception. Sides built with Grit use the Adversaries setup procedure instead of the leader's Disposition roll. Preserve explicit exceptions such as Guard when resolving independent tests.

Continuing the Same Conflict

Set fresh Disposition only for a genuinely new conflict with a materially different objective or changed circumstances. Passing through a doorway, changing tactics, or turning a Fight into a Chase does not by itself begin a new conflict. Carry forward:

- Current and starting Disposition.
- Used injury trades.
- Taken Out participants.
- Existing injuries, Truths, and other continuing effects.

If the type changes, establish the new action skills before the next exchange. Do not reapply setup bonuses merely because the type changes.

10.3 Superiority

Preparation can weaken an opposing side before the conflict begins. Gain 1 Superiority for each applicable category, to a maximum of 3:

- Know Thy Foe: discover an exploitable weakness, motive, fear, or vulnerability.
- Know Thy Battlefield: secure an advantageous position or understand circumstances that materially favour your approach.
- Know Thy Players: establish a useful plan, alliance, resource, or other preparation.

Each category applies once and requires a distinct material advantage affecting the opposing side and the declared stakes. Rephrasing one advantage does not qualify it for several categories.

After all other starting-Disposition modifiers and the minimum of 1, reduce each opposing total by your Superiority, to a minimum of 0. Determine both adjusted totals before resolving the outcome. Superiority is not tracked or spent afterward.

Overwhelming Preparation

- Only one side at 0: its opponent wins at no cost, within the declared intent and stakes. Do not script exchanges or calculate compromise.
- Both sides at 0: resolve mutual defeat (§10.12), without scripting or a winner's compromise. Neither receives an outright or no-cost victory.
- Neither side at 0: record both totals and proceed to scripting.

Resolve setup defeat as recorded: do not restore a total to 1, reroll setup, compare negative remainders, or break a simultaneous defeat by comparing Superiority. Only opposing Superiority can reduce the setup minimum of 1 to 0; low rolls or flat penalties alone cannot do so.

Setup defeat does not itself inflict injury, drain Pools, Take Out a participant, or satisfy a creature-specific finishing requirement. Consequences follow the declared stakes and the applicable victory or mutual-defeat outcome.

Preparation and Other Benefits

An asset may retain its normal benefits while also contributing to Superiority. A map might justify preparation and later help an action. These benefits perform different jobs:

- Superiority represents preparation at setup.
- An action tag assists a particular roll.
- A Truth changes difficulty or establishes what is possible.

Apply each only when its requirements are met. One asset does not automatically provide all three.

10.4 Conflict Types

The conflict type determines which skills establish Disposition and resolve actions.

Type	Disposition	Attack	Defend	Feint	Maneuver
Fight	Fight or Brawl	Fight / Brawl / Shoot	Athletics / Endure	Deceive	Notice / Stealth
Chase	Athletics or Drive/Pilot	Athletics / Drive	Athletics / Drive	Stealth	Notice / Survival
Argument	Persuade	Persuade	Will	Deceive	Empathy
Negotiation	Persuade	Persuade	Empathy	Deceive	Investigate
Infiltration	Stealth	Stealth / Tech	Deceive	Craft	Investigate
Battle	Lore (tactics)	Fight	Endure	Deceive	Lore
Spirit Duel	Arcana	Arcana	Will	Deceive	Lore
Hack / Netwar	Tech	Tech	Tech	Deceive	Investigate
Survive the Wild	Survival	Survival	Endure	—	Notice

A dash means the action is unavailable. Settings may add types. Each needs a Disposition skill and a skill for every available action. Use the listed skill that fits the description. An action's name does not remove the need for a plausible approach.

10.5 Scripting and Volleys

Each exchange contains three volleys.

Each side secretly scripts three actions in order, assigning an eligible participant to each. Both sides commit their scripts before revealing the first volley.

Reveal the corresponding actions together, describe them, and resolve their interaction. Repeat for the second and third volleys unless the conflict ends.

If it continues, script another exchange.

Coordination and Rotation

A side may appoint a coordinator to record its script and acting order. The coordinator does not have exclusive authority over the group's decisions.

Track rotation continuously across exchanges:

- Every available participant must act before anyone takes another turn.
- A participant cannot act in consecutive volleys unless they are the only available participant.
- With more than three participants, continue the rotation into the next exchange.
- Helping does not count as taking a turn.

Update rotation when someone joins, withdraws, or becomes unable to act. Assigning an action that later proves unsuitable does not permit a free replacement.

Changing a Script

Before revealing a volley, spend 2 Momentum for the players' side or 3 Woe for the GM's side.

Replace one unrevealed action. Keep its assigned actor unless an explicit ability allows reassignment.

Action Interactions

Your action	Attack	Defend	Feint	Maneuver
Attack	Independent	Versus	Attack independent; Feint trumped	Versus
Defend	Versus	Independent	Defend trumped; Feint independent	Versus
Feint	Feint trumped; Attack independent	Feint independent; Defend trumped	Versus	Independent
Maneuver	Versus	Versus	Independent	Independent

Independent actions both resolve, even if one defeats a side or takes its actor out. Complete each action's costs, choices and effects before removing a participant because of that action; check victory after both independent actions finish.

A trumped action makes no roll and produces no effect. Describe the failed approach briefly. Failure, Woe and doubles use §10.7.

Independent Tests

Roll against Standard 15, adjusted by applicable Truths and other explicit difficulty modifiers, including adversary Guard. Determine Power normally.

Versus Tests

Both actors roll. The higher total wins and gains 1 Power, plus 1 for every full 3 points of margin.

Winning prevents the opposing action's normal effect, even if all Power funds permitted supplementary Effects rather than loss or recovery.

On an exact tie, neither action gains Power or produces its normal effect. Costs already paid remain spent. Success at a Cost does not turn a losing versus roll into success. Resolve doubles and complications under §10.7.

10.6 Actions and Effects

Describe how the action pursues your side's objective.

Action	Purpose	Fight	Argument	Chase
Attack	Advance the objective directly	Press an opening	Establish a decisive point	Close distance
Defend	Restore or protect your position	Regroup behind cover	Answer an objection	Recover a safe route
Feint	Exploit misdirection	Draw and bypass a response	Bait a revealing answer	Fake a route
Maneuver	Establish an advantage	Flank or obstruct	Shift an audience's attention	Block a path

Three Separate Layers

Layer	What it measures
Disposition	The side's ability to continue pursuing this objective.
Pools	A character's capacity for Effort, abilities and Resistance.
Statuses	Lasting or temporary effects that have actually happened to a character.

Losing one does not automatically reduce the others. Ordinary Attack and Feint remove Disposition only, not Pools or statuses. Armour and Resistance do not reduce ordinary Disposition loss unless an explicit rule says otherwise. Defend restores Disposition, not Pools, statuses, equipment or established losses.

Attack

Commit at least 1 Power to remove opposing Disposition equal to the Power committed, plus 1. Apply the +1 base loss once per action, not per purchase. With no Power committed to this effect, remove no Disposition.

Defend

Restore 1 Disposition per Power committed, up to your side's starting value (§10.9). With no Power committed to this effect,

restore none unless a specific ability grants recovery independently.

Feint

Use Attack's Power commitment and Disposition-loss calculation. Feint bypasses Defend but is trumped by Attack; against Maneuver, both resolve independently.

Maneuver

Spend Power on these effects:

Effect	Cost	Result
Impede	1	The opposing side's next acting participant takes −3 on their action roll.
Gain Position	1	Your side's next acting participant gains one bonus die on their action roll.
Disarm	3	Disable a specific weapon, asset or key tag for the rest of the conflict.
Create a Truth	2 per rank	Establish a justified Truth, applying explicit discounts and the normal minimum cost.

Buy Impede, Gain Position and Disarm no more than once each per Maneuver; later successful actions may buy them again. Create may be purchased at a higher rank for its normal cost.

Temporary Effects and Ongoing Conditions

Impede and Gain Position apply to the affected side's next scripted action, including across an exchange boundary. If that action is trumped or otherwise makes no roll, the effect expires unused.

Neither applies to unrelated Resistance or incidental rolls. Gain Position counts toward the normal bonus-dice cap.

Impede is not a tiered status. Multiple pending Impedes do not stack, increase its penalty or extend its duration. Restore does not remove it merely because Restore removes statuses. Impede does not itself restrain, immobilise or render someone helpless.

An ongoing condition needs its own name, tier, scope and removal condition. For example, *entangled-2* hinders movement and actions requiring free limbs, and ends when the net is cut or the target escapes. State fictional restrictions directly; a helpless body or inaccessible weapon is not shorthand for temporary Impede.

Disarming and Denying Options

Identify the disabled asset and explain how. Disabling one asset removes an action category only if it was the side's only plausible means of performing that action. A replacement may restore access when the fiction permits. Switching equipment does not itself change a script.

Supplementary Effects Reference

A successful action may buy its primary effect and the permitted supplementary Effects below, using one Power budget. No primary purchase is mandatory.

Fictional relevance is required, but does not unlock prohibited purchases or harmful-status purchases on ordinary Attacks or Feints. General prices and treatment rules remain in §5.

Effect	Permitted actions	Price / limit	Scope
Weaken	Explicit ability only; any action	As permitted by the ability and §5	Not a cheaper Disarm. Use Maneuver's priced Disarm to disable an asset.
Create	Maneuver	2 Power per rank; explicit discounts and minimum cost apply	Establish a justified Truth.
Enhance	Defend or Maneuver	Normal tier price (§5)	Normal scope and stacking.
Restore	Defend	Normal tier price (§5)	Normal scope, stacking and treatment limits. Maneuver has no default permission.
Discover	Any successful action	1 Power per question; repeatable	Only answers that follow from this action, not unrelated or remote investigation.
Advance	Attack or Maneuver	1 Power per segment; repeatable	A separate established clock genuinely advanced by the action, not a duplicate Disposition track.
Disrupt	Maneuver	3 Power; once per Maneuver	Cancel or delay an established prepared action outside the committed script, or remove 1 available GM Woe.
Extra Feat	Any successful action	Normal price (§5); once per action unless expressly overridden	One related secondary accomplishment within the action's scope, not another turn, roll or scripted action.

Exceptions. Other actions require explicit permission. An exception grants only its named purchase, trigger, cost, frequency and scope; a procedure replacing ordinary Maneuver effects retains that restriction.

Called Shot retains only its named permission and duration. Cheap Shot's named Attack purchase does not unlock Create on every Attack or other supplementary Effects. A free Extra Feat waives cost, not its frequency limit.

Objective and script limits. Advance cannot automatically convert segments into Disposition loss or bypass a still-disputed objective. If clock completion would settle the conflict, establish that relationship before scripting.

Disrupt cannot generically cancel, replace, reveal or delay a committed scripted action; an ability or scenery procedure must expressly permit interference. Removing Woe cannot reverse an existing spend or cancel an accepted payment.

Extra Feat cannot duplicate primary Disposition effects, disguise a prohibited purchase, cancel an independent opposing action or achieve an objective outside the stakes.

Offensive Bonuses

Additional Disposition loss is not additional Power or an additional status tier. Additional status tiers do not increase Disposition loss. A bonus intended for both forms must say so: remove the listed additional Disposition when applying ordinary conflict loss, or increase the harmful status when the Attack instead inflicts one.

Apply each bonus to one component only. If an explicit effect inflicts both Disposition loss and a status, the ability must identify the component or permit a choice; do not apply the same bonus to both.

Attack bonuses do not apply to Feint unless stated. Such bonuses do not improve staking, killing strikes or other finishing procedures unless expressly stated.

10.7 Costs, Failures and Complications

Use normal Effort, Momentum, Woe, Tychē Points, tags and Truths subject to these restrictions.

Ordinary Failure

An ordinary failed independent test produces no action effect and generates the usual 1 Woe. It does not also authorise an unrelated GM move, automatic injury or additional Disposition loss: the failed and opposing actions establish the volley.

Losing or tying a versus test, or being trumped, generates no ordinary-failure Woe. Apply this symmetrically to player and GM actors; costs already paid remain spent. Separately triggered complications, ability costs, scenery Dangers and explicit Woe rules still apply.

Success at a Cost

On an independent test missing by 1–3, gain 1 Power as usual. The player chooses either 1 Woe for the GM or an immediate, proportionate complication arising from the action.

An ordinary cost cannot impose an additional status or extra Disposition loss unless an explicit rule permits it. Suitable costs include exposing an approach, losing access to a minor asset or establishing a limited adverse fact.

Scenery actions use their listed Danger when the consequence option is chosen.

Doubles

Apply critical Power under §2.6. In versus tests, double 12s do not override a higher opposing total or break a tie.

Ordinary successful doubles add +1 Power; winning double 12s add +2 instead. Losing or tied doubles grant no Power or normal action effect.

Double 1s always cause their normal complication but do not automatically lose; successful double 1s also gain the ordinary +1 critical Power. Apply this equally to rolled doubles and doubles created by an explicit ability, including Perfect Strike.

Doubles complications remain within the established stakes and action's scale. They do not cancel an independent action or retroactively change the script. Use the normal rules for buying off a complication with Woe.

Explicit Risks and Harm

Abilities, hazards, Risky rolls, scenery Dangers and other explicit rules may impose their stated consequences. Resolve these separately from ordinary Disposition loss.

Protected Payments

Generic wording such as ignore harm, cancel a consequence, take the hit or protect an ally does not affect shared Disposition. A rule must explicitly mention Disposition to reduce, redirect, restore or prevent its loss.

Generic prevention, redirection, immunity, Resistance and incidental clearing benefits cannot prevent or remove an accepted injury trade, a running-dry status generated by paying a cost, an agreed concession cost or another consequence accepted as payment for a benefit. An exception must expressly identify the protected payment it affects.

Once recorded, a status can be treated or healed through the applicable procedure. Later healing does not refund the benefit, restore Disposition, refresh an injury trade or erase a Scar.

Free, Immediate and Automatic Effects Reference

Free removes only the stated resource cost. It grants no extra turn, rotation bypass or permission to act while Taken Out. A passive benefit or a benefit explicitly requiring no action can apply without consuming a scripted action.

An immediate effect resolves at its stated trigger. It interrupts another action only if explicitly permitted, and cannot retroactively cancel resolved costs or effects.

An additional immediate action must specify its trigger, replacement of scripted actions, rotation treatment, use while Taken Out and interaction with independent actions.

Automatic success replaces the roll for an otherwise permitted action. It supplies no extra action, script change, rescue of a trumped action, expanded stakes or unsuitable approach.

On an independent test, apply the listed Power without rolling. In a versus test, it wins with its listed Power unless the opposing action also succeeds automatically; then resolve a tie unless a specific rule says otherwise. No roll means no dice-based critical or complication.

10.8 Scenery Maneuvers

A Maneuver may exploit an established feature: a Scene Truth or established fact. If it is not established, create or discover it first.

Name the feature when scripting. If it is unavailable at resolution, the Maneuver produces no scenery effect; do not substitute another feature for free.

Each feature supports one scenery action per conflict unless its nature clearly permits reuse.

Action	Requirement	Power	Result	Danger
Grab a Ride	A fixture and clear path	2	Gain Position and move to another reachable location; ignore Impede this volley.	Tier-1 winded.
Tip & Drop	A heavy object and a target below	3	Remove 3 opposing Disposition, without the Attack bonus.	An ally takes tier-1 struck.
Floor Collapse	A support that can be broken	4	Create rank-2 Collapsing Floor in the affected area.	Tier-1 stunned or a lost tag.
Carpet Pull	A suitable covering and unwarned foes	2	Impede each opposing participant's next action roll this exchange.	Your next Defend takes −1.
Drape Drop	Hangings, netting or similar material	1	Impede the opposing side's next action.	Your next action takes −1.
Shove 'Em Off	An edge and an adjacent target	3	One opponent loses their next scripted action while recovering.	Tier-2 off balance.
Make a Hazard	Fuel, fluid or a breakable container	2	Create a rank-1 hazardous Truth in the area.	You are also exposed to it.

The GM may trigger the listed Danger for 1 Woe. Danger statuses are Resistable normally.

A fall is lethal only with established lethal stakes. Describe results consistently: a collapsing floor or spreading fire affects everyone within its established scope. Dangerous Scene Truths generate Woe normally.

In other types, scenery might be a witness, document, crowd, access point, market stall or bridge. Adapt the nearest effect only when its requirements and consequences remain meaningful.

10.9 Shared Disposition and Participation

Each side has one shared total. Do not divide it among participants; there are no individual shares or spill-over. Ordinary Disposition loss removes no particular participant.

A participant stops acting when a status, explicit effect, withdrawal or established circumstance prevents contribution to the objective.

A side loses at 0 Disposition or when none of its participants can continue pursuing its objective. Check victory using the action-completion rule in §10.5.

Companions and Groups

Distinguish a participant, which takes assigned actions and is bound by the side's stakes, from an asset, which supplies tags, information or explicitly permitted helping benefits without independent turns.

Do not count the same companion twice merely because it can perform both functions.

An independently acting companion occupies a place in continuous rotation, uses its listed skills or ratings and can be prevented from acting or Taken Out. It has no separate Disposition track or injury trade unless explicitly granted one.

A group represented by one rules entry is one participant for rotation and area-effect Disposition bonuses, not one per fictional body. Apply specific Bodies or mass-combat rules only where provided.

Setup Help follows §10.2. Ordinary free Help waives its pool-point cost, not relevance, bonus-dice limits or participation risks.

Starting Disposition and Reinforcements

Record adjusted starting Disposition after all setup modifiers and Superiority. It remains fixed for this conflict and determines the normal recovery cap and compromise reference (§10.13).

A genuinely new conflict uses §10.2; a change of location, tactics or type alone does not reset it.

Reinforcements add their listed Grit to current shared Disposition, even above the starting value. They do not change starting Disposition or the normal recovery cap, grant additional scripted actions, permit free actor reassignment or recalculate setup.

Defend and other Disposition-recovery effects restore only up to the starting value unless explicitly stated otherwise. At or above the cap, recovery restores nothing and does not reduce the current total.

A successful Defend may still buy permitted supplementary Effects (§10.6).

Removing a participant, helper, companion or group subtracts no contribution or Grit from current or starting Disposition. Removal may still defeat the side if nobody remains able to pursue its objective.

10.10 Conflict Gear and Assets

Equipment normally provides an action tag, counting toward the normal +2 tag cap. It may also have one explicitly written distinctive quality. Do not invent qualities during resolution.

Asset	Typical tag
Sword or knife	+1 Attack
Shield or prepared cover	+1 Defend
Spear, polearm or scoped rifle	+1 Maneuver
Smoke grenade or false papers	+1 Feint
Relevant evidence	+1 Attack in an Argument
Prepared treaty draft	+1 Maneuver in a Negotiation

An asset helps only when its use explains how it applies.

Optional Distinctive Qualities

- Sword: before the first exchange is scripted, assign its +1 tag to one action category for the conflict instead of always using Attack.
- Axe: when at least 1 Power is committed to a successful Attack's Disposition effect, remove 1 additional Disposition. Take −1 on Defend while using it.
- Shield: once per conflict, after a successful Defend, restore 1 additional Disposition.
- Knife: against a cumbersome weapon at established close range, Disarm costs 2 Power instead of 3.
- Bow: while the opponent cannot reach you and lacks an effective ranged response, Attack versus Attack is a versus test instead of independent.

Distinctive qualities do not automatically grant a second tag. Apply offensive bonuses under §10.6.

Non-Combat Assets

Evidence, promises, maps, supplies, local contacts, fortifications and plans may be assets.

Evidence supports what it establishes; a promise helps only if the recipient values it; a map helps while relevant; supplies and fortifications must first be secured.

Explain arguments through direct dialogue or third-person description. Award no bonus merely for theatrical delivery.

Changing Equipment

Declare active equipment before scripting each exchange.

Switching does not refresh a once-per-conflict quality, erase a continuing drawback or restore a lost asset.

10.11 Accepting Injury

Once per character per conflict, accept a lasting injury to cancel some loss from a successful Attack or Feint.

Declare before applying loss. Only one participant may trade against each Attack or Feint.

Accepted injury	Loss cancelled
Tier 2	1
Tier 3	2
Tier 4	3

Name the injury and explain how it preserves the side's position. It must follow from the action, have a relevant effect, be new or worsen a status, and remain below tier 6 after stacking.

You cannot:

- Pay with an injury already present or an irrelevant or wholly redundant status.
- Trade after being Taken Out.
- Cancel more loss than inflicted.
- Cancel loss from Maneuvers, hazards, voluntary costs or special effects unless permitted.
- Cancel an execution, imposed status or anything other than ordinary Attack or Feint Disposition loss.
- Invent bodily injury to pay for a purely logistical setback.

An accepted injury is a protected payment (§10.7); it cannot be prevented or reduced. It recovers through treatment and time.

The trade cancels incoming loss, not loss already suffered, and does not raise starting Disposition. Refresh only for a genuinely new conflict.

10.12 Defeat, Mutual Defeat and Concession

Apply the action-completion rule in §10.5 before determining the outcome.

Defeat and Finishing Procedures

The winner achieves its intent within the established stakes, subject to compromise. Do not repeat the same unresolved contest; a new conflict requires a materially different objective or changed circumstances.

Defeat does not automatically inflict injury or satisfy a creature-specific finishing requirement.

Where an explicit finishing procedure is required, victory secures the opportunity to attempt it.

Complete the deciding volley and determine victory or mutual defeat, resolve any permitted finishing procedure, then settle compromise. Follow the relevant creature or setting entry for requirements and resolution.

Mutual Defeat

If both sides are defeated in the same volley, or both start at 0 after Superiority, neither wins outright.

Resolve compatible parts of both intents and a shared setback within the stakes. Neither receives an incompatible outcome automatically.

Calculate no winner's compromise. Setup defeat follows §10.3.

Concession

Before the next roll, propose an end to the conflict. State what the opponent gains, what your side retains, all injuries, losses, promises or obligations, and how the immediate struggle ends.

Offer meaningful success that fits the situation. A mindless predator may require an escape opportunity or sacrifice rather than surrender.

If accepted, apply the terms without another roll. Do not also apply compromise unless included. Agreed costs are protected payments (§10.7); injuries recover normally.

If rejected, continue. Conceding grants no automatic Tychē Point.

10.13 Compromise

Compare the winner's remaining Disposition with the original adjusted starting value recorded at setup (§10.9):

Starting Disposition lost	Compromise
None	None

Starting Disposition lost	Compromise
More than 0, less than half	Minor
At least half, less than three-quarters	Significant
Three-quarters or more	Major

Use proportions without rounding. If remaining Disposition equals or exceeds the starting value, there is no compromise.

Reinforcements do not change the denominator: compare these two totals, without reconstructing earlier losses or keeping a separate loss ledger. Setup defeat uses §10.3 instead.

What Compromise Means

The winner achieves its intent, but the loser earns a proportionate concession:

- Minor: limited concession, delay, obligation, expenditure or complication.
- Significant: substantial concession, restricted terms, important loss, serious injury or meaningful part of the loser's objective.
- Major: narrow victory at a major price: lasting obligation, severe injury, important loss or powerful new danger.

These are consequence packages, not mandatory lists. Do not automatically add injury to an adequate non-injury concession.

Compromise cannot simply reverse the result or grant the loser's complete incompatible objective.

Negotiating Terms

1. Establish the grade.
2. The loser proposes terms.
3. Confirm what the winner achieves.
4. Confirm what the loser retains or gains.
5. State all costs and who pays.
6. Credit eligible existing injuries.
7. Resolve eligible Resistance.
8. Record the binding result.

Keep terms proportionate, relevant and within the stakes. If agreement proves difficult, the GM adjudicates using these limits. Disagreement does not cancel earned compromise.

Injury Guidance

When appropriate to the package, use tier 2 for Minor, tier 3 for Significant and tier 4 for Major as starting guidance, not automatic injuries, minimum costs or penalties for everyone.

Existing Injuries

An injury suffered during this conflict satisfies one injury cost assigned to that character if its current tier meets or exceeds the required tier. Each injury counts once.

Do not pool, split, transfer or credit injuries against non-injury consequences. An injury treated below the required tier no longer satisfies the cost.

Add no replacement injury because an existing one satisfies the first.

Resistance

Imposed compromise statuses may be Resisted normally; agreed payments follow §10.7.

Resistance may remove an injury but does not revoke the loser's concession or another stated consequence. Add no replacement cost because Resistance removed the injury.

Binding Results

Victory, concessions, promises and consequences stand. Genuinely new events may change them; do not ignore or immediately reroll them because someone dislikes the result.

10.14 NPCs and Harm

Ordinary NPCs and minion groups cannot trade injury. A named rival built as a full PC may; others require an explicit trait.

Ordinary NPCs have no Pools and reduce imposed harm only through listed Armour, traits or abilities. Apply at most one reduction per imposed status application, never to ordinary Disposition loss or a protected payment (§10.7).

NPC defeat uses §10.12. Capture, escape, injury and death follow the stakes and outcome. Use a Dying clock when rescue matters, not to make an accepted rescue objective impossible.

Creature-specific rules remain in force. Immunity may stop an unsuitable status without stopping Disposition loss in a contest the creature can lose.

Specific breaking points. Apply the normal tier-6 procedure unless the relevant creature or condition explicitly replaces it. Use that entry's stated outcome and the applicable limits against duplicate Scars.

10.15 Order of Resolution

1. Establish objectives, stakes, participants and exits.
2. Calculate starting Disposition and Superiority.
3. Determine both adjusted totals and resolve any setup defeat (§10.3).
4. Script the exchange and assign actors.
5. Reveal the next volley.
6. Determine the interaction.
7. Pay pre-roll costs; resolve running dry.
8. Roll and determine Power.
9. Make permitted post-roll choices and pay their costs.
10. Allocate Power.
11. Calculate Disposition loss separately from statuses.
12. Offer eligible injury trades.
13. Apply remaining Disposition loss.
14. Resist eligible statuses, stack what remains and resolve tier 6, including explicit creature exceptions.
15. Complete any independent opposing action.
16. Check removal, victory and mutual defeat.
17. Before the next roll, allow concession proposals.
18. Resolve permitted creature finishing procedures before compromise.

19. Settle compromise or concession.
20. Recover each layer only through its own procedure (§10.7).

Specific rules override general rules only on the subject addressed.

10.16 Keeping It Fast

- Use full conflicts only when several tactical decisions matter.
- Record objectives and starting Disposition visibly.
- Use three cards or entries for each script.
- Keep one continuous acting order per side.
- Treat minion groups as one coordinated participant unless separation matters.
- Describe volleys briefly; reserve extended narration for decisive moments.
- Negotiate one coherent compromise package, not accumulating penalties.

Disposition around 8–11 is the initial pacing target. Aim for two or three exchanges and roughly 15–20 minutes, then adjust through playtesting rather than adding steps.

10.17 Area Effects

Provisional for playtesting. This Area Rule replaces earlier per-member Disposition wording and the rule that gave full effect to one target and tier-1 splash to the others.

An area effect affects everyone within its established area whom the effect can reach. Establish the area and affected participants before resolving it. An area effect does not automatically distinguish allies from enemies; selective targeting requires an explicit rule or circumstances that keep others outside its reach.

Disposition loss in conflicts. When an area Attack or Feint applies its normal Disposition-loss effect:

1. Apply the committed Power + 1 to the opposing side's shared Disposition once.
2. Add 1 Disposition loss for each additional opposing participant affected beyond the first.

Do not assign Disposition loss to individual participants. There are no individual shares or spill-over. A group represented by one rules entry counts as one participant, not one per fictional body (§10.9).

Example: an area Attack commits 3 Power to Disposition loss and affects three opposing participants. It removes 6 shared Disposition: 3 Power + 1 for the normal Attack, +2 for the two additional participants.

Apply any eligible injury trade against the combined loss (§10.11). The area Attack remains one Attack: no more than one participant may accept an injury against it.

Explicitly inflicted statuses. When an area effect explicitly inflicts a status, every affected character receives the full purchased or listed tier. Resolve each character's Resistance or NPC harm reduction separately, then stack the remaining status normally.

Example: an effect that inflicts *burned-3* in an area inflicts *burned-3* on every affected character, not tier 3 on one and tier 1 on the others.

An ordinary conflict Attack or Feint still inflicts no status merely because it is an area effect. Apply both Disposition loss and statuses only when an explicit rule grants both. Outside conflicts, resolve statuses normally; do not introduce Disposition loss. Apply offensive bonuses to their stated component, not automatically to both (§10.6).

Playtest flags. Test whether splash makes large groups lose shared Disposition too quickly; test full-tier statuses against groups, including separate Resistance costs; and test Unleash and NPC area Specials against this common procedure.

10.18 Interpose

Bulwark Role Trait. Once per exchange in a conflict, when an ally would receive an imposed status that you can physically or otherwise fictionally intercept, you may take that status in their place. Outside conflicts, you may likewise intercept a fitting incoming status; this trait adds no separate frequency limit outside conflicts.

Declare Interpose before the original target rolls Resistance or applies any harm reduction.

- Redirect the entire incoming status to yourself. The original target receives none of that status.
- Resolve your own normal Resistance or NPC harm reduction against it, then stack what remains normally. Do not first apply the original target's Resistance, armour or other reduction.
- Ordinary NPCs remain limited to one reduction per imposed status application (§10.14). Interpose itself redirects the status; it does not reduce its tier.
- Interpose does not redirect or reduce shared Disposition loss.

- You cannot Interpose against an accepted injury-trade payment, a running-dry status, an agreed concession cost, a compromise cost or another accepted payment.
- You must be able to intercept the source of harm in the established fiction. You cannot protect an ally from an area effect that already affects both of you.

Example: a guardian with Interpose can step into a shock-baton strike that would inflict *jolted-3* on an ally. The guardian receives *jolted-3* and uses its own eligible reduction. It cannot intercept ordinary Disposition loss or shield that ally from a blast that already catches them both.

10.19 Guardian Self-Repair

This procedure supplies the activation, frequency and timing for the Guardian Self-Repair Special in Adversaries §4.

Once per guardian per exchange, after the guardian succeeds on its assigned scripted action, including Success at a Cost, it may spend 1 Woe to choose one:

- Restore 2 of its side's shared Disposition, up to its original adjusted starting Disposition.
- Remove up to 2 tiers from one existing physical status on that guardian that its repair systems can address.

Self-Repair supplements the successful action. It requires no additional action or Power. The action qualifies even when all its Power funds permitted supplementary Effects.

Resolve Self-Repair at the end of the triggering volley, after both independent actions and their immediate consequences, but before final defeat, mutual-defeat and defeat-triggered Special checks. The guardian must still be able to participate and pay the full 1 Woe. Shared Disposition at 0 does not itself prevent activation.

Recovery from 0 is allowed in this window. Use the post-repair total to determine the outcome; repair may prevent defeat or change an otherwise mutual defeat into a victory. It cannot reopen a finalized outcome, reverse setup defeat or an accepted concession, or override an explicit recovery prohibition such as Last Stand's pending-defeat restriction.

Each guardian tracks its own once-per-exchange use. Failed, tied, trumped or unperformed actions do not qualify. The opportunity expires at the end of its triggering volley and cannot be saved. An extra volley that is not a new exchange does not refresh the allowance.

Choose Disposition or status repair, not both. At or above the Disposition cap, recovery restores nothing without reducing an existing excess. Disposition recovery does not heal statuses, refill pools, erase Scars or return a Taken Out participant. Status repair does not restore Disposition or pools, refresh an injury trade or grant an otherwise unavailable return. It cannot prevent an accepted payment from being recorded or refund its purchased benefit.

10.20 Domain Scope in Scripted Conflicts

During a scripted conflict, Domain scope determines whether the proposed working is fictionally appropriate and what it can affect. Resolve its assigned action using the conflict's normal independent or versus procedure. Do not add a separate scope roll or scope-based numerical adjustment unless an explicit rule requires one.

This clarifies the Domain procedure used by the Adept and imported by the Testament of Dust Occultist. Independent workings retain applicable Guard, Truths and explicit modifiers. Versus workings compare opposing totals. Domain permission grants no extra action, interaction bypass or harmful status on an ordinary conflict Attack. Outside scripted conflicts, the existing scope-Difficulty procedure remains unchanged.

10.21 Guardian Protocol

A successful Protocol Discover reveals only the actions assigned to the targeted guardian in the next exchange, including their positions in that exchange. Record those assignments as committed when the information is supplied; other participants' assignments remain unrevealed.

This guarantees disclosure of that next exchange, not automatic confirmation of all future exchanges. Characters retain what they have learned and may use observations and an understood operating pattern to predict later actions without paying merely to remember them.

The GM may change a disclosed action through the normal paid script-change procedure before its volley is revealed, retaining its assigned actor unless an explicit exception permits reassignment. A paid change does not automatically update the hunters' information or notify them. Normal Tells, observations and explicit information effects still apply. The original disclosure must have been true when supplied. Do not freely rewrite a disclosed assignment merely because formal next-exchange scripting has not yet occurred.

Protocol grants no extra action, free hunter script change, free actor reassignment or rotation bypass. A guardian that later becomes unable to act does not gain permission to act; resolve an unperformable assignment under the ordinary rules without free replacement.

11. Playbooks

Each playbook entry provides:

- Base pools and Edge
- Anchor skill (must be +3 or +4)
- Special abilities: the generic playbooks each offer eight special abilities and a capstone. Choose 1 special ability at creation without the normal extra-ability price; any ★ Major surcharge still applies.
- XP trigger: one playbook-specific behaviour that earns XP
- Load-out list: playbook items plus generic items, Blades-style light/normal/heavy load
- Relationship prompts: 1 ally and 1 rival

Settings rename and reskin playbooks (Adept becomes "Hedge Witch" in fantasy, "Netrunner" in cyberpunk) but keep the structure.

Creation extras. You may buy up to 2 additional playbook abilities at creation, each for 1 Refresh. A ★ Major costs a further 1 Refresh when taken, so a ★ creation extra costs 2 Refresh total. Minimum Refresh remains 1 (Core Rules §4.1; Generic Playbooks §1.1–1.2).

Later acquisition. New abilities normally cost an Advance; ★ costs remain additional. Veteran abilities from another playbook become available after 6 Advances and cost an additional 1 Refresh. A capstone unlocks after 12 Advances with at least 4 abilities from that playbook, costs no Refresh, and is limited to one per character. See §12.2 and Generic Playbooks §1.2 for the detailed acquisition rules; reaching a threshold is not an automatic award from this overview.

A playbook's theme does not override conflict action skills, timing, rotation or Effect permissions. Free abilities and benefits grant no extra scripted turn merely because they cost no resource.

11.1 Generic Core Playbooks

Playbook	Anchor	Base pools (Sōm / Mēt / Psy / Pne)	XP trigger	Concept
Bellator	Fight or Brawl	12/10/6/8	Address a challenge with force or threats	Front-line muscle
Furcifer	Stealth	8/12/8/8	Address a challenge with stealth or precision	Infiltrator, scout, thief
Savant	Lore or Investigate	7/8/13/8	Address a challenge with knowledge or insight	Scholar, detective, scientist
Interlocutor	Persuade	7/9/9/11	Address a challenge with charm, lies, or bargaining	Diplomat, con artist, leader
Explorator	Survival	11/11/7/7	Address a challenge with endurance or the land	Ranger, pilot, explorer
Adept	Arcana or Tech	7/8/9/12	Address a challenge with your powers or gadgets	Mage, psychic, hacker

12. Advancement

12.1 Earning XP (end of session)

1 XP per "yes" unless noted:

- Did you hit your playbook XP trigger? (1, or 2 if it happened in a desperate scene)
- Did you accomplish your Goal? (+2)
- Did one or more of your World, Other, or Self Beliefs drive a meaningful decision?
- Did your Instinct get you into trouble or save the day?
- Did you face consequences from a weakness tag or Scar?

The Belief question awards at most 1 XP per session, not 1 XP per Belief. Upholding, questioning, or acting against a Belief can qualify when it drives a meaningful decision; merely reciting or rewriting it does not.

MVP vote: the table votes on one standout moment each session; that player gets +1 Tychē Point at the next session (above Refresh, within the cap).

12.2 Spending XP (every 6 XP = 1 Advance)

- +1 to a skill (following the pyramid rule)
- +3 to one pool, or +1 Edge (max 3 Edge per pool)
- A new playbook special ability (★ abilities also cost 1 Refresh; veteran acquisition costs are additional, below)
- A new power tag, or rewrite a weakness tag into a power tag

- +1 Refresh (buys back Refresh spent on abilities or artifacts; max base 3 + 1 per 3 Advances)
- A higher-tier Focus ability: Tier 2 after 3 Advances; Tier 3 after 6 Advances. Taking the ability costs an Advance; reaching the threshold does not grant it automatically (Focus Rules §1.1).
- +1 Effort Level (to Level 2 after 3 Advances; Level 3 after 9 Advances)

Focus choices. Tier 1 is gained at creation. At Tiers 2 and 3, choose one of the tier's two options when buying that ability. Once eligible for the tier, its unchosen option can be taken later as a normal Advance. A ★ option also costs 1 Refresh when taken. These prerequisites and prices follow Focus Rules §1.1, not an additional charge for each lower tier.

Veteran abilities. After 6 Advances, an ability from another playbook may be taken as an Advance. It costs 1 Refresh in addition to any ★ cost: a veteran ★ ability therefore costs 2 Refresh. This is a different acquisition route from a creation extra; do not charge the creation-extra price again (Playbook Rules §1.2).

Capstones. A capstone unlocks after 12 Advances if the character has at least 4 abilities from that playbook. It costs no Refresh, and a character can have only one capstone. Use the detailed playbook rule for its acquisition; this summary adds no automatic award or additional XP price (Playbook Rules §1.2).

Refresh limits. Apply the minimum Refresh of 1 and the current Refresh cap when making purchases (§4.1). The minimum concerns the Refresh rating, not current Tychē Points. New abilities retain their action requirements, timing and protected-payment limits; an Advance does not grant an extra scripted turn or reset an ongoing conflict.

12.3 Reviewing Beliefs and Instincts

Review the relevance of your Beliefs at session end; ordinary revisions happen at milestones. Reaffirm, revise, or replace them to reflect development in play.

- Reaffirm: keep a conviction and commitment that still matter.
- Revise: update a fulfilled or obsolete action clause while keeping the underlying conviction.
- Replace: write a new Belief when experience changes your outlook or the former commitment no longer belongs in the campaign.
- Relationships: review an Other Belief when the relationship meaningfully changes; agree on shared premises with the other player as in §3.5.

Acting against a Belief does not automatically remove Tychē, impose a status, damage a pool, or force a rewrite. The player decides whether the experience leads to reaffirmation or change. Do not rewrite a Belief during a decision merely to claim a reward. Rewriting alone grants neither XP nor Tychē.

Keep one World, one Other, and one Self Belief. Goals remain separate and are rewritten each session. Instincts remain separate and can change at milestones.

13. Example of Play

Kade, a *Reckless Furcifer who Never Leaves Anyone Behind* (Mētis Edge 1, Effort Level 2), is creeping through a warehouse to free a captured friend. Kade has advanced beyond creation and purchased Effort Level 2; a new character starts at Level 1 (§2.4, §12.2). He has enough Mētis to pay both Effort costs below. Scene Truths: *Dim Lighting*, *Patrolling Guards*.

- Roll: Stealth +3, power tag *quiet boots* +1, power tag *knows this district* +1 (tags capped at +2). The GM sets Hard 18 but *Dim Lighting* lowers it to Standard 15. Kade needs 10+ on the dice.
- Effort, part 1: Kade spends 3 − 1 Edge = 2 Mētis for a bonus die → 3d12 keep 2.
- Result: dice show 9, 9, 4 → keep 9 + 9 = 18, +5 = 23. That's 8 over → 3 Power, plus doubles on a success → +1 = 4 Power.
- Effort, part 2: Kade spends another 2 Mētis for +1 Power → 5 Power.
- Spend: Advance the *Reach the Cell* clock by 3 (3 Power), Discover (1 Power): "Where is the key?" — "On the sergeant's belt." 1 Power left → +1 Momentum.
- Later: the sergeant's dread patron, a bound spirit, lashes out with *terror-3*. Kade Resists with Pneuma (Edge 0), so 2d12: highest die 7 → cost 2 Pneuma. The status drops to *terror-1*.
- Compel: the GM compels *Reckless*: "You can't wait for backup; you go in now." Kade accepts and gains +1 Tychē Point.

13.1 A Scripted Conflict

Later, Kade, Mira and Tarin confront two guards at the warehouse gate. This is a separate example. The earlier lighting and patrol Truths no longer apply at this location; Kade's temporary terror has been cleared through appropriate care after the spirit's influence ended (§6.6), not merely because the scene changed. His earlier pool expenditure is not automatically refunded. The PCs want to get their rescued friend through the gate; the guards want to hold them until reinforcements arrive. All three PCs can contribute. The group establishes capture and nonlethal injury as stakes, not death.

Setup. Mira leads with Fight +3 and the highest Edge in its pool, 1. Her setup dice are 7 and 8: 7 + 8 + 3 + 1 = 19. Divide by 3 and round down to 6, then add +1 for each of her two eligible helpers: starting Disposition 8. There are no other flat modifiers or Superiority. Setup Help supplies these points, not extra Help dice; its pool-point cost remains an open ruling (§10.2).

The guards contribute Grit 5 and 3, so their side also starts at 8 Disposition, without a setup roll. Neither guard has a personal share to lose. Record both adjusted starting totals for Defend limits and later compromise (§10.9).

Commit the exchange. Before the first reveal, the PCs assign Kade a Maneuver, Mira an Attack and Tarin a Defend. The guards assign the first guard a Maneuver, the second a Defend and the first an eventual Feint. Both sides obey continuous rotation: every available participant acts before anyone repeats, and nobody acts consecutively. The first guard's third-volley action is legal because the second guard acts between its turns (§10.5).

Volley 1 — Maneuver versus Maneuver. Both actions resolve independently. Kade uses Stealth +3 and one relevant tag for +1 to slip around the first guard and open a path. His dice are 7 and 6, for a total of 17. The guard has Guard +1, so Kade's target is Standard 15 + 1 = 16; no Truth changes it here. He succeeds with 1 Power and buys Gain Position.

The guard's independent Maneuver totals 15 against Standard 15: an ordinary success with 1 Power. The GM spends that Power on Impede. This result needs no Success-at-a-Cost consequence and adds no status or Disposition loss.

Neither Maneuver changes Disposition. Gain Position waits for the PCs' next scripted action, and Impede affects that same next action. They do not apply to an intervening Resistance roll.

Volley 2 — Attack versus Defend. Mira receives Gain Position's bonus die. She rolls 9, 6 and 2, keeps 9 + 6, adds Fight +3 and her weapon's +1 Attack tag, then subtracts 3 for Impede: total 16. The general weapon tag is not counted again. The guard's Defend totals 13.

Mira wins by 3, producing 1 Power plus 1 for the full 3-point margin: 2 Power. She commits both to Attack, removing 3 shared Disposition (2 Power + 1). The guards fall from 8 to 5. Their losing Defend restores nothing. No particular guard loses Grit, leaves the rotation or receives a wound merely from that loss. Both pending Maneuver benefits are now spent (§10.6).

Volley 3 — Defend versus Feint. Tarin's Defend is trumped: he makes no roll and restores no Disposition. The first guard'sFeint rolls independently and succeeds with 2 Power, committed to remove 3 PC Disposition.

Before applying that loss, Tarin accepts a new lasting *sprained shoulder-3*, describing how he holds the gate open while the others push through. The injury follows from the action and preserves the side's position. A tier-3 injury cancels 2 incoming loss, so the PCs lose only 1 Disposition, falling from 8 to 7. Tarin marks his once-per-conflict injury trade used; at most one participant could trade against this Feint (§10.11).

The injury is a payment: Tarin cannot reduce it with armour or Resistance, redirect it to an ally or clear it with an incidental benefit. Later treatment and healing can affect it normally but do not refund the trade. The injury remains below tier 6 and does not itself take him out.

Continue or settle. At the exchange's end, the PCs have 7 Disposition and the guards 5; neither side has won. Continue rotation into the next exchange rather than resetting it. Changing an unrevealed action costs 2 Momentum for the PCs or 3 Woe for the GM and normally retains its assigned actor. A brief pause does not refresh Disposition or Tarin's injury trade.

Suppose the PCs later win with 4 of their starting 8 Disposition remaining. They lost exactly half, so the compromise is Significant, using the proportion without rounding. That calls for one outcome-first package, not an automatic additional tier-3 injury. Tarin's existing injury can receive eligible credit once when settling that package; the group does not count it repeatedly or automatically add another wound. The PCs achieve their stated intent, subject to the negotiated compromise, not permission to seize unrelated property or kill the guards (§10.12–10.13).

Afterward. Fresh Disposition in a genuinely new conflict will not refill pools or heal Tarin's shoulder. Appropriate ordinary treatment can remove at most one tier of this lasting injury before a healing interval removes another; recovery follows §6.6. If someone had been Taken Out, simply healing a status would not grant a return to an ongoing conflict without the explicit return permission required by §6.4.

14. Design Notes — What Was Kept, Changed, Cut

Source	Kept	Changed	Cut
Fate	Skill pyramid, Tychē Points, invoke/compel, Refresh as cost of power	Aspects are replaced by tags and Truths	Fudge dice, stress boxes
Cypher	Pools, Edge, the sentence, Effort on rolls and on Power, cyphers and artifacts (Module A)	Four pools instead of three; Effort buys bonus dice instead of lowering difficulty	d20 task levels, GM intrusions (replaced by compels and Woe)
:Otherscape	Power/weakness tags, statuses with tiers, effects, burning tags	Power comes from roll margin; tag cap +2	Themebooks, Improve/ Abandon tracks
Mouse Guard	Full conflict scripting, shared Disposition, outcome-first compromise, BIG, weapons as action bonuses, the Grind (Module B)	Rolled Disposition divides the setup total by 3 before helpers and flat modifiers; actions spend Power	Nature, Persona
Blades	Playbooks, resistance, stress-as-currency, clocks, load-out	Stress tracks are the four pools	Action dice pools, Position/ Effect grid, crew sheets
2d20	Momentum, Woe, Truths, Module C, buy-offs, Escalation	Momentum from unspent Power; Truths shift Difficulty; complication range → Risk die (§2.7)	d20 roll-under

14.1 Known Risks

- Currency load: pools + Tychē + Momentum + Woe is the upper limit for medium crunch. Keep spend menus short on the sheet.
- Modifier range (revised): max is skill +4, tags +2, helpful status up to +6, Tychē invoke +2. Statuses are now the largest swing. Playtest a ±3 status cap.
- Effort for Power may make high-Edge characters very efficient. Watch Edge-3 pools where Effort is free; consider a minimum cost of 1.
- Resistance dice (revised): Edge now adds Resistance dice (2 + Edge, keep the highest) instead of reducing the cost, and only a double 12 is free. Below Edge −1 you keep the lowest of |Edge| dice, so stacked penalties (such as *Exposed* and *Shaken* on a 0-Edge pool) make Resisting very expensive; watch how often that happens. High-Edge pools still pay about 1 per Resist, so watch whether Resistance drains pools faster than before, and whether the double-12 result (1–6%) is too rare to matter.
- Four pools means more pool points to track. The sheet should put all four in one row with Edge beside each.
- Conflict length: with scripting used for every big contest, the conflict test (§10.1) is what stops overuse.
- Running dry (revised R3): running dry now imposes a status at tier 1 + overrun instead of an automatic Taken Out, and a Scar comes from tier 6 instead of from an empty pool. Playtest the 2-recovery-points-per-tier rate for depletion statuses, the one-Scar-per-event limit, and how often Resisting at an empty pool reaches tier 4 or higher. Explicit creature breaking-point replacements apply only where stated (§6.3).
- Damage cycle (unified): watch whether the injury trade is a hard choice or always taken, and whether it drags conflicts out. It is once per character per conflict, with at most one participant trading against each Attack or Feint; tier 2/3/4 cancels 1/2/3 incoming Disposition loss (§10.11). Compromise is one outcome-first package, not an automatic injury: tiers 2/3/4 are guidance, and eligible existing injuries receive credit once (§10.13). Test the healing intervals, the 3-segment Dying clock, and whether the 1-tier treatment limit makes Restore-cost abilities (*Field Medic*, *Field Surgeon*) feel too weak against lasting injuries. Later healing does not refund payments or refresh injury trades.
- Shared Disposition: each side has one Disposition track (§10.9), so ordinary loss no longer removes individuals. Current rolled setup is 2d12 + Disposition skill + the highest Edge in its pool, divided by 3 and rounded down; add +1 per eligible helper and all flat modifiers afterward at full value, apply a minimum of 1, then Superiority (§10.2–10.3). There is no second halving or flat-modifier stacking cap. Grit-built sides use the adversary setup exception. Watch whether a lone remaining participant acting repeatedly feels heroic or too forgiving, and whether larger parties get too many injury trades.
- Historical simulation caveat: earlier notes reported mirrored fights about 23.5% shorter with shared rather than personal Disposition, and a separate twice-halved setup averaging about 6 Disposition (range 3–9) and about 6 volleys. Those figures describe earlier procedures, not validation of the current divide-by-three setup with full-value flat modifiers. Re-run comparisons before using those figures to predict current conflict length; a fixed track of 5 remains a possible playtest comparison, not an alternate rule here.
- Attack and Feint +1: a successful Attack or Feint removes its committed Power + 1 Disposition (§10.6). The +1 is loss, not Power, so it cannot be spent on other effects. Declare an injury trade before applying the resulting loss. Watch whether Defend can keep pace, whether Feint becomes the default action, and how the +1 stacks with ability bonuses such as *Crowd Work* and *Every Trick*

in the Book. Additional Power, Disposition loss and status tiers remain separate; ordinary Attacks and Feints do not also inflict statuses.

- Superiority: up to 3 Superiority reduces opposing starting Disposition after all other modifiers and the minimum of 1 (§10.3). Only Superiority can reduce the adjusted start to 0, yielding a no-cost victory within the stakes. Watch whether preparation becomes routine, how often both sides claim it, and whether distinct preparation categories are being confused with repeated descriptions of one advantage. A preparation asset can retain its normal action benefits when independently relevant; this is not an automatic claim to several Superiority categories.
- Open conflict rulings: setup Help's pool-point cost, exceptional doubles against opposed totals and the Woe treatment of losing versus tests remain unresolved (§10.2, §10.5). Feint versus Maneuver resolving independently, and PC/opposition symmetry and Superiority eligibility, retain their playtest flags. These notes do not settle them.

CHAPTER III

Optional Modules

Six drop-in modules for longer campaigns: one-use cyphers and dangerous artifacts, the grinding cost of travel and hardship, a sandbox where the world itself is written in Truths, downtime, factions and investigation.

Use any, all, or none. A setting book may recommend some.

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Combining Modules

Choose the modules the campaign needs. Use an explicit replacement instead of running both versions of the same procedure:

- Downtime (D) replaces Module B.4's Players' Turn procedure. Core field rests and Module B's Grind-condition recovery remain separate (D.1).
- Factions (E) replaces Module C.5's basic faction action procedure. Its starting-cluster procedure E.1A replaces C.8; retain the rest of Module C.
- Downtime with Factions uses one World Turn per stay, after endeavours resolve (D.7, E.10). A longer stay does not create extra World Turns or faster Strain recovery.
- Inquiry (F) applies its explicit clue and Insight procedures in Inquiry scenes. It does not replace ordinary conflict resolution; changing scene labels does not reset an ongoing struggle.

Specific module rules govern their stated exceptions. For example, the Grind's 2-Woe clock tick does not use the generic danger-clock rate, and a cypher's no-roll use does not grant an extra scripted turn. Keep pools, statuses, Disposition, project clocks and faction Qualities distinct unless an explicit rule connects them.

Unspecified interactions remain open rulings, not permission to add effects, costs or resets. The individual module sections identify retained playtest questions and provide their full procedures.

Module A — Cyphers & Artifacts (Cypher)

Cyphers are frequent, disposable power-ups that encourage players to use them rather than hoard them. Artifacts are rare, reusable items that may run out.

A.1 Cyphers

Sample cypher table (d12):

d12	Cypher	Tier	Effects
1	Healing salve / med-gel	2	Restore
2	Smoke charge	2	Create (*smoke cover*)
3	Flashbang / thunderstone	3	Attack (dazed), Weaken
4	Truth serum / mind-read charm	2	Discover ×2
5	Adrenal shot	3	Enhance (surging), restore 3 Sōma
6	Lockbreaker	3	Advance (any lock or security clock)
7	Ward token	3	Negate one incoming status of tier 3 or less
8	Phase key	4	Create Truth (*passage through the wall*) for one scene
9	Courage draught	2	Restore (fear), restore 2 Pneuma
10	Seeker	2	Discover (location of one person or object)
11	Firebomb	4	Attack (on fire), Create (*burning*)
12	Wild card	d6	Player names a reasonable Effect; GM sets the form

- What they are: one-use items or effects — potions, grenades, scrolls, nanite injectors, blessed relics, strange tech. Each has a tier (1–6).
- Using one: an action, usually with no roll. The cypher generates Power equal to its tier, spent only on the Effects listed on the cypher. Some create a Truth or a story tag instead. Listed fixed benefits follow their own text; do not turn them into additional unrestricted Power.
- Cypher Limit: each PC can carry 2 cyphers (some playbooks or Focuses grant 3).
- Over the limit: at the end of each scene, the GM gains 1 Woe per extra cypher and may trigger a Volatile result (roll d12: 1–4 one cypher fires randomly; 5–8 one cypher is ruined; 9–12 nothing happens yet).
- Subtle cyphers (setting option): instead of physical objects, cyphers are luck, insights, or favours ("a contact owes you", "a

flash of insight"). They work the same way and fit low-magic or modern games.

- GM pacing: give out 1–2 cyphers per PC per session. They should feel like loot that gets spent.

One Power budget. Divide the cypher's generated Power among its listed Effects; a list of Effects does not grant the full budget to each. Create costs 2 Power per Truth rank before explicit discounts (Core Rules §5). For example, a tier-2 Smoke charge can spend its 2 Power on rank-1 smoke cover; a tier-4 Firebomb that spends all 4 Power on a rank-2 burning Truth has none left for its listed Attack. A harmful status, a Truth and shared Disposition loss are different components, not interchangeable descriptions of the same purchase.

Use in scripted conflicts. No roll does not mean no action. An item entry must identify the scripted action or explicit triggered exception that permits its use. Apply automatic success only to an otherwise permitted action under Core Rules §10.5: it does not rescue a trumped action, change the script, reassign an actor, bypass rotation or allow use while Taken Out. No roll produces no dice-based critical or complication. A cypher's listed Effects permit those Effects within its stated use; they do not add them to every ordinary Maneuver or Defend.

Open mappings. The short sample entries do not fully specify scripted action categories, versus interactions or immediate-use timing for every cypher. In particular, the Ward token's reaction timing and the scripted mapping of status-inflicting cyphers need explicit item text or a separate ruling. This pass does not supply those missing exceptions. Set them before resolution rather than inferring a free interrupt from the item's name or no-roll use.

Harm and protection. An ordinary conflict Attack removes shared Disposition, not a harmful status. Status-inflicting cyphers use their explicitly listed harm component; they do not also remove Disposition unless the item expressly grants both. The Ward token and other generic prevention cannot negate ordinary Disposition loss, injury-trade payments, running-dry statuses, agreed concession costs or other protected payments (Core Rules §10.7).

Healing. A cypher that merely lists Restore follows the normal limits for lasting injuries: ordinary treatment removes at most 1 tier, then marks the injury treated until a healing interval removes a tier (Core Rules §6.6). Its tier is a Power budget, not an explicit promise to heal that many injury tiers. An item expressly healing a stated number of tiers follows its own text. Restoring Sōma or Pneuma does not clear a status, refund an injury trade or erase a Scar; healing does not itself return a Taken Out ally to an ongoing conflict (§6.4).

Area. A grenade, blast or spreading-fire description alone does not supply an unstated area mechanic. When an item explicitly has an area effect, establish everyone it can reach and use Core Rules §10.17: full listed or purchased status tier with separate Resistance or NPC reduction, or ordinary shared Disposition loss once plus 1 per additional opposing participant affected. Apply both layers only when expressly granted. A group represented by one rules entry counts as one participant, and allies are not automatically excluded.

Cypher format:

> *Flashbang (Tier 3)* — Effects: *Attack (dazed), Weaken.* Form: *palm-sized canister. Draught of Iron Skin (Tier 2)* — Effects: *Enhance (armoured), Restore. Lasts one scene.*

For a complete playable entry, also state its action or trigger, targets, duration, removal conditions and any area or conflict exceptions. The short formats above are effect summaries, not complete timing specifications.

A.2 Artifacts

- What they are: reusable items of real power — a flaming sword, a psychic amplifier, a starship's AI core.
- Tags: an artifact has 1–2 power tags (counting toward the +2 cap) and usually a special ability. Do not count its general item tag and conflict action tag twice for the same benefit on one roll (Core Rules §10.10).
- Depletion: each artifact has a depletion rating, e.g. 1 in d12. After each use, roll d12; on that number or lower, it is depleted (broken, drained, or needs a downtime clock to restore).
- Attunement: powerful artifacts (marked ★) must be attuned and cost 1 Refresh while attuned (§4.1). A PC can attune to a maximum of 2 artifacts.
- Artifact quirks: each artifact has a weakness tag that can be compelled for Tychē Points (*thirsts for blood*, *talks too much*, *draws the Hunters*).

An artifact's ability obeys its stated action requirements and the same conflict boundaries as a cypher. Switching equipment does not refresh a once-per-conflict benefit or restore a depleted item. Defend restores shared Disposition, not artifact charges or lost equipment, unless an explicit rule provides that additional effect.

Artifact format:

> ★ *Ember-Brand (longsword)* — Tags: *blade of living flame, +1 Attack (conflict gear).* Ability: *spend 1 Power to add* burning *to any status you inflict.* Depletion: *1 in d12 (goes cold until bathed in a forge).* Quirk: cannot be hidden.

Ember-Brand modifies a status that another permitted effect actually inflicts. Its ordinary conflict Attack tag does not itself inflict a status, and the ability does not turn Disposition loss into burning harm. Establish any status's tier, scope and removal condition under the normal status rules; do not infer a second free status or damage layer from the name.

Module B — The Grind & Travel (Mouse Guard)

The Grind turns time, distance, and hardship into slow, steady pressure. It pairs with Mouse Guard's GM's Turn / Players' Turn structure.

B.1 Session Structure

Phase	What happens
GM's Turn	The mission. The GM presents obstacles; rolls advance the Grind under B.2, with scripted conflict actions grouped by exchange.
Players' Turn	Downtime after the mission. Players spend Checks to take actions: recover, research, craft, pursue Goals.

B.2 The Grind Clock

- During the GM's Turn, the GM keeps a Grind clock visible to the table.
- Each roll outside scripted conflict actions ticks it by 1; conflict action rolls are grouped as 1 tick per exchange, not one per volley, actor or die.
- Size by hostility: 4 (harsh: desert, deep winter, the underworld), 6 (normal wilderness or dangerous city), 8 (gentle or well-supplied).
- When it fills: every PC gains the next Grind condition they don't have yet, then the clock resets. The GM may also spend 2 Woe to tick it.

The Grind is an explicit hardship procedure, not an additional GM move awarded by ordinary conflict failure. Preserve its listed cadence and 2-Woe tick cost rather than substituting the generic danger-clock rate. It neither removes shared Disposition nor automatically inflicts a bodily injury.

Open timing. B.2 does not fully specify the treatment of incidental Resistance or recovery rolls during an exchange, a conflict ending partway through an exchange, or the exact point a filled Grind clock applies its condition. These remain separate timing rulings; the one-tick grouping for conflict action rolls does not resolve them. Do not use an unstated timing exception to cancel an independently resolving action (Core Rules §10.5, §10.12).

B.3 Grind Conditions (taken in order)

Order	Condition	Effect	Cleared by
1	Hungry & Thirsty	Short rests restore nothing	A meal, a Survival roll (Restore)
2	Weary	Effort costs +1	A full night's rest
3	Exposed (cold, heat, wet)	−1 Sōma Edge	Shelter and a recovery roll
4	Shaken	−1 Pneuma Edge; Fear statuses +1 tier	A Will or Empathy recovery roll, or a Belief moment
5	Sick	−1 to all rolls; can't recover pools	Medicine roll (Hard) + rest
6	Broken	Taken Out of the mission; gain a Scar	Players' Turn only

Grind conditions are statuses for Restore, but they don't stack — each is a separate condition. The Order column gives their acquisition sequence, not a harmful status tier. Apply each condition's listed effect and recovery requirement; Hungry & Thirsty is not automatically tier 1, nor Sick automatically tier 5. Broken explicitly removes the character from the mission and gives a Scar; do not add a second generic tier-6 Scar merely because it is sixth in the list.

Separate layers. A condition that prevents contribution to a conflict can remove that participant without subtracting Disposition. A side loses when nobody can pursue its objective, after independent actions finish. Clearing a Grind condition does not refill a pool, heal a separate injury, erase a Scar or grant permission to rejoin an ongoing conflict; apply Core Rules §6.4–6.6 and §10.9. Pool recovery remains subject to Hungry & Thirsty and Sick as listed above.

Resistance scope remains open. This table does not specify a general Resistance procedure for acquiring its non-tiered Grind conditions. Do not infer one from the Order numbers. Ordinary imposed tiered harm uses the core Resistance rules; running-dry statuses and accepted payments retain their own exclusions. This compatibility pass does not decide whether or how a Grind condition can be Resisted.

B.4 Checks (Players' Turn)

- Earn Checks during the GM's Turn by applying one of your weakness tags or Scars to your own roll (−1). You earn 1 Check, or 2 if the penalty makes the roll fail.
- Everyone gets 1 free Check in the Players' Turn.
- Spend 1 Check for one Players' Turn action: a recovery roll against a Grind condition or status, a downtime clock roll, a research or crafting roll, restoring a burned tag, attuning an artifact, or a scene that pursues your Goal.
- Sharing: you can give a Check to another PC whose scene you take part in.

This makes weaknesses a deliberate resource: hurt yourself now to earn recovery and downtime later. Spending a Check permits the activity, not automatic success or recovery beyond its applicable limits. Treatment of lasting injuries follows §6.6; another Check or a new scene does not clear the treated mark. Checks grant no extra scripted turn or rotation bypass. If Module D is used, it replaces B.4 with its own Players' Turn and stay procedure.

B.5 Travel

A journey is a Journey clock (6 for a short trip, 8 for a hard trip, 12 for an expedition). Each leg (a day or a stage), the party assigns roles; each role makes one roll:

Role	Skill	On success, spend Power on
Guide	Survival or Drive/Pilot	Make Time — Advance the Journey clock
Scout	Notice or Stealth	Spot Trouble — Discover, or cancel one encounter the GM has prepared
Quarter-master	Survival or Craft	Forage / Ration — clear Hungry for the party, or +1 Supplies
Lookout	Notice or Will	Keep Watch — the party isn't surprised; Restore Shaken

- Supplies: the party has Supplies as a status (start at 3–6). Lose 1 per leg. At 0, everyone becomes Hungry & Thirsty automatically and the Grind clock size drops by 2.
- Terrain and weather are Truths that set Difficulty (*Muskeg*, *Whiteout*, *Rapids*, *Washed-out Road*).
- Encounters: the GM spends Woe (1 for a minor encounter, 3 for a major one), or uses the Scout's failed roll.
- Portages and hard stretches: a special leg (Endure or Athletics roll for every PC); failure ticks the Grind clock twice.

Journey, hardship and conflict. Advance buys 1 Journey segment per Power (Core Rules §7). That progress is not Disposition loss, and neither track automatically changes the other. A travel encounter uses the ordinary conflict test (§10.1): a single obstacle may need one roll, while a sustained chase or struggle against the wild may merit scripting. Use that conflict's action skills, rotation and permitted effects; the travel role menu does not become a general conflict Maneuver menu.

The Scout's option concerns a prepared encounter, not cancellation of an already resolved action or automatic victory in an ongoing conflict. Changing from travel narration to a Chase or Survive the Wild does not itself reset an existing conflict's Disposition, used injury trades or Taken Out participants (§10.2). A genuinely new conflict needs a materially different objective or changed circumstances.

Retained travel questions. The short role entries do not state every Power price for their special options; the hard-stretch rule also leaves whether its two failure ticks replace or add to the ordinary roll tick unspecified. This pass preserves those entries and does not invent prices or extra ticks.

Module C — Truth-Driven Sandbox (2d20)

Truths become the backbone of an open-world campaign: regions, sites, and factions are defined by Truths that players can discover, exploit, and change.

C.1 Truth Layers

Layer	Example	Lifespan
Campaign	*The old empire's roads still hold its magic*	Changes only through major arcs
Region	*Lawless borderland*, *Endless rain*	Changes through faction clocks
Site	*Flooded lower levels*, *Ghosts guard the vault*	Changes when PCs act on them
Scene	*Pitch Dark*, *Hostile Crowd*	One scene

Record scope, rank and removal condition when a Truth matters mechanically (Core Rules §8). Its layer describes scale and persistence, not a larger numerical rank: rank 2 remains the maximum, and the net Difficulty shift remains capped at three steps. A removal condition does not extend a Scene Truth beyond its duration.

C.2 Site Sheets

Each location gets a short sheet:

- 3 Truths (at least one hidden; at most one at rank 2)
- A Woe seed: 1–3 Woe the GM adds when the party arrives
- A danger clock (what happens if the party lingers)
- A secret (something worth discovering)
- Rumours (see C.4)

State the danger clock's actual trigger or deadline. Its presence is not permission to add a tick or an unrelated GM move to every ordinary failed conflict action; use Core Rules §7 and §10.7.

C.3 Truth Generator Tables (d12)

Roll once per column or pick.

d12	Terrain / Feature	Atmosphere	Hazard	Secret
1	Ruined fortification	Eerie silence	Unstable ground	Hidden passage
2	Dense forest	Constant rain	Disease	A traitor among allies
3	Flooded lowland	Oppressive heat	Predators	Buried treasure
4	Market town	Festival crowds	Watchful authorities	A forgotten god sleeps here
5	Mountain pass	Biting wind	Rockfall	Smuggling route
6	Abandoned facility	Flickering lights	Toxic air	Experiment gone wrong
7	River crossing	Thick fog	Rapids	Drowned village below
8	Sacred grove	Watched by unseen eyes	Spirit anger	A pact with the old powers
9	Remote camp	Desperation	Bandits	Someone is not who they claim
10	Underground ways	Echoes	Collapse	Lost civilisation
11	Noble estate	Hollow luxury	Political danger	Blackmail ledger
12	Wasteland	Unnatural stillness	Exposure	Gateway to elsewhere

C.4 Rumours

A rumour is an unconfirmed claim, not yet an established Truth. When players test it through Discover, investigation or arriving, the GM rolls d12 to determine what is actually true:

d12	Result
1–4	False — and someone benefits from spreading it
5–8	Twisted — partly true, with a dangerous difference
9–12	True — becomes a Truth

Resolve an unsettled rumour with this table; do not use it to retroactively overturn a fact already established by successful investigation. Record the actual finding, including any meaningful difference from the claim. Discovering a hidden Truth reveals what exists; it is not the same as creating a desired fact.

C.5 Faction Turns

Module E replacement. If Module E is enabled, use its World Turn procedure (E.10) instead of this section's faction action procedure; do not run both. With Module D, that World Turn takes place after the stay's endeavours (D.7). Retain the rest of Module C.

Without Module E, between sessions (or each in-world week), the GM takes a World Turn:

1. Each active faction rolls 2d12 + its rating (+1 to +4) vs. Standard 15 for its current project.
2. Power ticks the faction's project clock (sized by the change it makes, below).
3. When a clock fills, the faction creates, removes, or changes the appropriate Site or Region Truth (e.g. *The Guild controls the river* replaces *The river is free*). Campaign Truths still require a major arc, not an ordinary completed clock.
4. PCs who hear about it can respond; PC actions can tick faction clocks forward or back using Advance.

A faction project changes a Site Truth with an 8-segment clock, a Region Truth with a 12-segment clock, and a Campaign Truth only through a major arc (C.6). Under Module E, use its declared-project, capability and action rules rather than substituting this basic rating roll.

C.6 Player Influence on Truths

- Discover effects and Momentum spends reveal hidden Truths.
- Create effects and 2 Momentum create Scene Truths; bigger changes need a progress clock (8 segments for a Site Truth, 12 for a Region Truth).
- Major arcs can rewrite Campaign Truths. These are the "legacy" moments of the campaign.

Create costs 2 Power per Truth rank before explicit discounts; a 2-Momentum creation starts at rank 1, with the same cost again to raise it to rank 2 (Core Rules §5, §8). A Scene Truth cannot bypass a larger project's scale merely by naming a lasting regional outcome.

Acting in a conflict. Use permitted scripted actions and explicit exceptions for Discover, Advance or other Effects not on the ordinary action menu (§10.6). A faction project clock is not shared Disposition: winning a conflict achieves its stated intent within the stakes, not automatic completion of every related project. A Truth can establish a scenery feature, but exploiting it requires the scenery Maneuver's own requirements and Power cost (§10.8). Preparation can justify Superiority only when its distinct category and relevance are established (§10.3).

C.7 Session Zero: Entanglements

Use this at the start of a campaign, after players have picked a Descriptor, Playbook and Focus but before Beliefs, Goals and

tags are final. It takes about 60 to 90 minutes for four players. The result is a story map and your first Campaign Truths.

Elements. Each PC is a circle on the map. Everything else is placed on the map and joined to PCs by lines, each with a short description.

- Character (square): a named NPC, such as a mentor, a rival, a debtor or a friend.
- Organization (diamond): a group that could become a faction (C.5, Module E).
- Prop (diamond): an object that matters to the story.
- Set (diamond): a place that matters.
- Situation (triangle): an event or pressure, past, present or looming.

Phases. Go around the table once per phase. Each player adds elements and draws lines from their PC. A player can't use the same shape twice in a row. Each phase then gives a 2d12 output:

Phase	Type	Each player adds	Output for the PC
0 Setup	Setup	The Focus link and one line to another PC.	The ally and rival prompts.
1 Origin	Major	Two elements.	A Belief drawn from one of them.
2 Rise	Standard	One element.	One power tag.
3 Branching Out	Meta	One element, plus one extra: connect two non-PC elements, replace one of your own lines, or give another PC a new element.	An Instinct or a named ally.
4 Turning Point	Major	Two elements.	A weakness tag and your first Goal.

Using the map.

- Triangles. Wherever two PCs have conflicting lines to the same element, mark it. Those are the first compels and the first scenes.
- Wedges. The GM picks one line to threaten in the first session.
- Late arrivals. A new PC runs the same phases against the existing map.

Campaign Truths. Finish by writing 3 to 5 Campaign Truths (§8) from the map. Each Situation is a candidate, and each Organization that most PCs touch gives one. Mark Organizations that conflict with each other as faction candidates for C.8.

Lines into factions. When a line joins a PC to an Organization, use it to propose the appropriate Module E record, keeping organizational policy separate from personal ties and authority:

- *Sworn member of*, *commissioned by*: a membership or office Truth (E.4). Establish the recognized appointment or process and record its permissions, jurisdiction, duties, duration and removal condition; a line does not grant unlimited command.
- *Patron of*, *funded by*: a patronage record (E.4), stating what is supplied, the service expected, limits and ending conditions.
- *Owes*, *is owed by*: a favor or obligation (E.7). Agree the service, limits, notice and settlement terms rather than treating the line as an unlimited debt.
- *Feuds with*, *hunted by*: grounds for adverse starting Standing when they describe the faction's policy toward the party (E.3). Record the actual relationship; *fears* alone does not establish hostility or change Standing.
- *Betrayed*, *estranged from*: a personal exception when the history concerns that PC rather than the whole party (E.4). It replaces the normal relationship Truth for its subject instead of stacking with it.

Props and Sets connected to an Organization are candidate assets. Record them as usable faction assets only when ownership, control, access and operational reach support that use (E.2). A line showing interest in a relic or a disputed estate does not itself give the faction possession or the full resources of that place.

Relationships are not automatic bonuses. Record relevant Truths with scope, rank and removal condition. A named ally or faction connection does not itself grant free Help, an independent turn, a personal Disposition track or a preparation bonus. Apply the relevant Help, participation and Superiority requirements when the resource actually contributes (Core Rules §10.2–10.3, §10.9; Module E.6).

C.8 Building Factions: Long Knives

If Module E is in use, use E.1A instead. Without Module E, build the starting factions for C.5 like this. Do not also generate a second starting cluster through this procedure.

1. Place. Name the location. Record it as the first Region Truth (C.1).
2. Gather. List the groups the PCs' lines point to: Organizations from the map, plus fragments of them. Note what each wants in the area and who would oppose it.
3. Cluster. Pick about four factions that would find one another aggravating. Law or a local lord often belongs even if no PC touches them.
4. Sheet. For each faction write:

- Has: one obvious asset and one less obvious one. These set its rating: +1 minor, +2 solid, +3 major, +4 dominant.
- Wants: its current project, with a clock sized by the change it makes (8 for a Site Truth, 12 for a Region Truth; C.6) and the result Truth it creates or changes when the clock fills.
- Link: how it connects to the PCs.
- Relations: allied or hostile toward each other faction. Where it matters, write the relation as a Truth (§8).

5. Incident. One faction does something underhanded or aggressive that affects the others. Treat it as a project that has already filled: record its result Truth. The PCs may see it but can't prevent it.
6. Reaction. Give each other faction a response as a linked clock (§7), opened by the incident.

7. Future. Write the result Truth each clock creates if the PCs do nothing. Make at least one visible to the players, and bad enough that they want to act.
8. Involvement. Note how each PC is pulled in. Appeals from factions should be biased and based on limited information.

The incident is starting history. Step 5 establishes an event already completed before ordinary play. It is not permission to cancel a PC's resolved action, skip an ongoing conflict or declare a new faction project complete in response to resistance. Once play begins, use C.5 or Module E's replacement procedure, and respect established intent, stakes and action timing. Campaign-scale changes still require a major arc rather than an ordinary completed Site or Region clock.

Module D — Downtime (Torchbearer, Imperium Maledictum)

Downtime is the stretch between expeditions when the party is safe enough to recover, prepare, build and answer to the people around them. It has three equal jobs: recover and prepare (treat injuries, restore tags, restock), make and grow (craft, research, adapt to loss) and connect (tend allies, settle obligations, push on the wider world). Module D adds no new currency. It runs on Checks, Power, clocks and Woe, all of which already exist.

D.1 When It Applies

- Haven. Downtime begins when the party reaches a place with shelter, food and enough safety that nobody expects an attack tonight: a village, outpost, monastery, camp or home base. The GM decides.
- Field rests stay separate. Core Rules §6.5 rests, and Module B's night's rest and Grind-condition recovery, work as written. They give no Checks or endeavours. Reaching a haven is not itself a general reset: pools, statuses and Scars still follow their own recovery procedures. Healing does not refund an accepted payment or refresh an injury trade.
- A stay ends when the party leaves the haven or is forced out. Finished work stands; clocks keep their progress.
- Replaces Module B.4. If you use Module D, the Players' Turn follows these rules.

D.2 The Stay

Length and intervals. An interval is one full week. Healing intervals (Core Rules §6.6) run alongside it. *All numbers in this module are playtest values.*

Stay	Length	Free Checks per PC
Brief	Up to 3 days	1
Ordinary	About a week (1 interval)	2
Extended	Each further full week is another interval	+1 per extra interval

- Checks. Free Checks are added to any Checks earned on the expedition (B.4: applying a weakness tag or Scar to your own roll). Spend 1 Check for one endeavour. Unspent Checks are lost when the stay ends. You may give a Check to another PC whose endeavour you join.
- Stay Woe. The GM does not use expedition Woe in downtime. The stay starts with 1 Woe per PC. Woe gained from downtime rolls joins this pool, which pays for the stay's event, complications and danger clocks, then is discarded (§9.2).
- Momentum gained in downtime decays at the end of each scene and never leaves the stay (§9.1). Tychē Points do not refresh unless the downtime begins a new session (§4.1); invokes, declares and compels work as normal.
- Goals. At the end of the stay, each player writes one Goal for the next expedition (§3.5).
- World Turn (Module E). If Module E is in use, a stay contains one World Turn (E.10). The cadence with Module D is between adventures. The World Turn uses no Checks and no Stay Woe.

D.3 Upkeep

Staying costs something. Instead of a currency, the stay carries an Upkeep clock of 6. Settings may change its size or replace it with their own currency.

Standard	Ticks / interval	What it provides
Meagre	0	Shelter and food. Truth: *Poor Rest* (+1 step to Recuperate)
Ordinary	1	Reliable lodging and meals
Comfortable	2	Privacy and workspace. Truth: *Well Appointed* (−1 step to Recuperate and Make)
Hosted	0	A host provides everything. Record an obligation (E.7): the service owed, its limits, notice, and what settles it.

- If the clock fills: the haven demands payment. The GM gains 2 Stay Woe, a Debt complication appears, and the clock resets to 2.
- Routine provisioning (restock party Supplies to 4, ordinary repairs) needs no roll and ticks Upkeep by 1.

- Hospitality is not free. A host creates an obligation only when the terms are agreed. A vague claim of you owe me is an unresolved negotiation (E.7).

D.4 Endeavours

An endeavour is a stretch of focused effort during the stay.

- Routine. If failure would add nothing and the outcome is certain, no roll is needed. It generates no Power and no Momentum (§6.6).
- Uncertain. If the result matters, roll the listed skill against Standard 15, adjusted by Truths. Spend Power on Effects (§5). Unspent Power becomes Momentum, which decays.
- Success at a Cost: the GM adds a consequence, or the stay pool gains 1 Woe (player's choice, §2.5). Failure: the effort doesn't take; the GM announces any consequence before another attempt, and the stay pool gains 1 Woe.
- Light or Strenuous. A character with a lasting injury who takes a Strenuous endeavour does not progress that injury's healing interval this interval (§6.6).

Scenes that become conflicts. Use Core Rules §10.1 to choose the procedure: a consequential negotiation or other actively opposed struggle with several meaningful tactical choices may need a scripted conflict, not one endeavour roll. The normal Standard 15 and general Effect menu above do not replace conflict action interactions, versus tests or the restricted action effects. Inside that conflict, use §10.5–10.7 for scripting, costs, failures and complications. Spending Checks or receiving free Help grants no extra scripted turn, free actor reassignment or rotation bypass. A shared endeavour does not create a separate Disposition track for each contributor.

Shared endeavours. A shared endeavour has one goal for the party or a subgroup. It costs 2 Checks, paid from the participants' pooled Checks.

- Choose a lead. Each participant describes their contribution.
- The lead rolls. Participants add Help as in §2.4, within the +2 bonus-die cap.
- Spend Power as usual. The result benefits all participants.
- Participants need not pay equally. Non-participants pay nothing.

Endeavour	Tag	Skill	Typical Effects
Recuperate	Light	Medicine, Empathy, Craft	Restore; restore a burned tag; mark an injury *treated* (−1 tier)
Prepare	Strenuous	Survival, Persuade, Drive/Pilot	Create a Truth (*Provisioned*, *Passage Arranged*); Discover
Make and Mend	Strenuous	Craft, Tech	Advance a project clock; Create; restore a depleted artifact
Investigate	Light	Investigate, Lore, Notice	Discover; confirm a rumour (C.4)
Develop	Light	Varies	Advance a Scar or loss-adaptation clock (D.5)
Connect	Light	Persuade, Empathy, Intimidate	Create a contact Truth (D.6a); subtle cypher (A.1); Advance a faction clock only if the affected project is established (E.10)
Sustain	Strenuous	Craft, Persuade, Lore	Remove Upkeep segments

For an unlisted activity, the GM names a skill, a Light or Strenuous tag and the nearest Effects.

- Recuperate counts as appropriate care (§6.6). It does not change treatment limits: at most 1 tier per lasting injury, then *treated* until a healing interval removes a tier. It restores one burned tag (§3.4). It cannot remove a Scar, refill pools (the 4th rest already does) or clear an affliction beyond what its source allows. Treating an injury does not itself return a Taken Out participant to an ongoing conflict; the explicit return requirements in §6.4 still apply.
- Prepare can supply Superiority (§10.3) only against a named opposition declared beforehand, only one category per stay, and only if the preparation is concrete. The cap of 3 per conflict still applies. Distinct categories need distinct material advantages; repeating or renaming one preparation does not supply several categories. Apply earned Superiority during conflict setup after other modifiers and the minimum of 1. A prepared asset can also help an action when relevant, but does not automatically provide every kind of benefit.

D.5 Projects

A project is any goal too big for one endeavour. Use an 8- or 12-segment clock (§7), ticked by Advance. Each roll toward it costs 1 Check.

Project	Size	Notes
Crafting a notable item, restoring a workshop	8	Needs access and materials
Restoring a depleted artifact (A.2)	8	Needs fitting tools
Adapting to permanent harm (§6.8): prosthesis, retraining, workaround	8	Does not remove a Scar
Changing a Scar (§6.3)	12	Completing the clock counts as the milestone
Changing a site (C.6)	8	A Site Truth
Changing a region (C.6)	12	A Region Truth

- Milestones. For long projects, the GM names 2–3 milestones along the clock, such as *secure the premises*, *obtain equipment*, *complete the work*.
- Minimum time. A project cannot finish faster than the fiction allows, whatever the Checks.
- Unfinished projects keep their progress until the next stay.
- Optional: Study Toward an Advance. Off by default. A 6-segment clock, ticked in Develop endeavours. When it fills, the

character gains 1 XP. Use it only if your table wants training to feed advancement directly (§12 has no training rule).

D.6 Between-Adventure Events

Roll d12 once at the start of an ordinary stay, before endeavours are declared, or choose a result that fits the fiction. In an Extended stay, roll again every second interval after the first. An event should offer a choice, not remove the stay.

d12	Family	What changed	Offer	If ignored
1–2	Quiet	Nothing disturbs the party	Plans proceed	—
3	Opportunity	A specialist passes through	One endeavour gets −1 step Difficulty (*Expert Help*)	They leave
4	Opportunity	A bargain on supplies	Routine provisioning ticks no Upkeep	The chance passes
5	Relationship	An ally is in trouble	A shared endeavour helps them; create a favour Truth	Their clock ticks
6	Relationship	A rival or old acquaintance arrives	Compel a tag or Belief; Connect or Intimidate to change the relationship	They act against the party
7	Obligation	A past promise comes due	1 Check discharges it if it is within the agreed terms (E.7). Refusing it follows E.7 (one Standing).	The creditor presses the claim
8	Obligation	Costs rise	+1 Upkeep tick; Sustain is −1 step this stay	Debt grows
9	Settlement	A service is short-handed	Truth *Short-Handed*: +1 step to Recuperate and Make	Services stay limited
10	Settlement	A dispute, festival or quarantine	Connect gets −1 step; arrival or departure may be restricted	The mood hardens
11–12	Consequence	A faction's plan shows	Reveal the result of that faction's latest declared project action (E.10). This is not an extra tick.	It is harder to answer next stay

D.6a Reputation in Downtime

Downtime does not create reputation by itself. Distinguish the following:

- Standing (E.3) changes only through consequential deeds a faction learns of and attributes to the party.
- A reputation tag records what a character is known for. Earning one follows the applicable character-growth or setting rules; a Connect endeavour does not grant one by itself. It counts toward the normal tag cap unless an ability explicitly grants an exception; apply that exception only within its stated scope.
- An ability may establish a reputation as a Campaign Truth, as with the Bellator capstone *Legend of the Field* (Generic Playbooks §3.1). Apply the Truth and any additional benefits as that ability states.
- A contact Truth (D.4 Connect) describes a relationship with a named person. State what that relationship makes possible and whom it concerns. It does not by itself grant a reputation tag or change faction Standing.

Momentum, Woe and scene-scale Create effects cannot buy reputation (E.11). A relationship Truth (E.3) and a reputation tag apply independently: one shifts Difficulty and the other adds to the roll.

D.7 The Stay in Order

- Establish. The GM names the haven, its services and the stay length.
- Show deadlines. Reveal known changes, clocks and obligations.
- Set Upkeep. Choose a standard (D.3).
- Event. Roll or choose (D.6).
- Declare. Players declare individual and shared endeavours and spend Checks.
- Resolve. Play out only the consequential scenes. Healing intervals run alongside.
- World update. Take the World Turn here, after endeavours resolve, so the stay's results (Standing changes, evidence Truths, completed favors) are part of E.10 step 1. Without Module E, tick only clocks tied to established plans or deadlines. The GM may spend Stay Woe to tick danger clocks, but never to advance a faction project (E.10).
- Close. Discard leftover Checks and Stay Woe. Record unfinished projects, write a Goal, prepare to depart.

Example. The party spends an ordinary week (2 free Checks each) at a river outpost. Ysolde has a tier-3 injury; Brannock needs a new tool kit. The event is d12 = 9: the outpost is short-handed (*Short-Handed*). They choose Ordinary upkeep (1 tick). Ysolde spends 1 Check on Recuperate (Light): routine care, no roll, and the injury

is marked *treated* (tier 3 to tier 2). She does nothing Strenuous, so her healing interval continues under §6.6; the stay's week does not replace that procedure. Brannock and an uninjured companion pool 2 Checks for a shared Make and Mend push on an 8-segment kit project. Brannock rolls Craft, the companion Helps within the normal bonus-dice cap, and 3 Power Advances 3 segments. Ysolde does not join that Strenuous endeavour. At the close the project clock keeps its progress, and each player writes a Goal.

Module E — Factions, Standing & Obligations

Organizations have ambitions, resources, loyalties, and limits. This module connects their struggles to the party's adventures: factions provide opportunities and assistance; the party's actions determine what those factions can accomplish.

Use this module when alliances, patronage, collective action, or political consequences matter. It is optional and remains setting-neutral. These rules are a playtest draft, not tested balance claims.

When enabled, this module replaces the faction action procedure in Module C.5. Retain the rest of Module C. Use the core rules for PC checks, Effects, Truths, clocks, and conflicts except where an explicit organizational exception appears below.

E.1 Faction Records

A faction is an organized group pursuing a shared purpose: a household, village council, guild, temple, company of soldiers, criminal network, or administration.

Record:

- Name, purpose, and long-term ambition.
- Operational reach: the places and communities where it can act.
- Five Qualities, each rated 0 to +4.
- Two or three assets and one vulnerability.
- Standing toward the party, from −3 to +3.
- A representative who can explain or authorize requests.
- One current project and its clock.
- An important ally and rival, where relevant.
- Outstanding favors, obligations, offices, and personal exceptions.

Prepare full records only for active factions. A name, purpose, and Standing suffice for a background group. Begin with three active factions; normally track no more than five at once.

The party may found or lead a faction. Give it ratings justified by its actual people and resources; do not purchase a second character sheet with personal pool points. Leadership grants only the authority its governing structure recognizes.

E.1A Building the Starting Cluster (Long Knives)

Use this when starting a campaign, after the C.7 story map is drawn. It produces the first faction records (E.1), their starting Standing, and the opening situation. It takes about 30 to 45 minutes. This replaces C.8 when Module E is enabled; do not build a second starting cluster through the basic procedure.

Size. Aim for four factions: three active (full records) and one background (name, purpose and Standing). E.1 recommends starting with three active factions and tracking no more than five.

1. Place. Name the location. Record it as the first Region Truth (C.1).
2. Gather. List the groups the PCs' lines point to: Organizations from the map, plus fragments of them. Note what each wants in the area and who would oppose it.
3. Cluster. Pick four groups that would find one another aggravating. Law, a local lord or an imperial office often belong even if no PC touches them.
4. Record. Fill in each active faction's record (E.1) using the table.

Long Knives field	Becomes	How
Has	Qualities, assets, vulnerability (E.1, E.2)	The *obvious* asset sets the faction's highest Quality (+3, or +4 for a dominant power). The *less obvious* asset sets a second Quality (+2). Other Qualities are 0 or +1. Explain every nonzero Quality through concrete assets. The vulnerability is something opponents can target; it need not match a low Quality.
Wants	Ambition, project, primary Quality, clock (E.1, E.10)	Write the long-term ambition, then one current project with its intended outcome and its primary Quality. Choose the clock by the change it makes: 4 or 6 for a limited or local action, 8 for a Site Truth, 12 for a Region Truth (E.10, C.6).
Link	Standing and representative (E.3, E.4)	Set starting Standing (below). Name a representative. Record membership, patronage and favor lines from the C.7 map (E.4, E.7).

Long Knives field	Becomes	How
Relations	Ally and rival (E.1)	Name one important ally and one rival for each active faction where relevant.

Starting Standing. Use the C.7 map to establish the faction's actual policy toward the party, not an automatic score from one PC's title or debt:

- A sworn membership or patronage line may support +1 or +2 when it reflects welcoming or trusted treatment. If only that PC has the relationship, record a personal exception instead of automatically improving party Standing (E.4). Membership and patronage retain their own permissions and terms.
- A rivalry or pursuit may support −1 or −2 when the faction's actual treatment is distrustful or hostile. Being a debtor or being afraid does not alone establish hostility; record the obligation or fear separately and set Standing from the relationship (E.3, E.7).
- No established relationship: 0.
- Reserve ±3 for relationships that actually meet Enemy or Allied treatment; a blood feud or binding oath may justify that starting history but is not a substitute for establishing it. Where Standing is not 0 and the relationship matters, record the scoped relationship Truth (E.3).

A personal exception replaces that relationship Truth for its subject; it does not stack with it or automatically extend to companions. Define office, patronage and obligation limits separately. A representative's friendly attitude does not grant authority to commit resources the faction cannot or will not supply (E.4–E.6).

Qualities and Cohesion. A local faction normally has about 5 to 8 points across its Qualities, and a regional power about 9 to 12 (the Reed Quay Association in E.13 totals 9). A Quality of 0 means the faction can't independently mount a major action in that field (E.2). Don't start a faction with permanent Cohesion 0 unless you want it to begin in a Fracture crisis (E.12).

5. Incident. One active faction takes an underhanded or aggressive action that affects the others. Treat it as a completed project: its clock is full and can't be unticked (E.10). Record the result as scoped Truths with rank and removal condition (E.8, E.10). If it was an exceptional commitment, mark Strain on its primary Quality (E.9). The PCs may see the incident but can't prevent it.
6. Reaction. Each active faction declares its first-turn action: project action, primary Quality, intended outcome and any exceptional commitment (E.10). A faction with a credible method may obstruct another faction's *uncompleted* project instead (E.10). The incident's result can only be reversed by a new undertaking.
7. Future. For every active project, write its intended outcome and the scoped Truth it creates if the PCs do nothing (E.8). Use the pacing table to say roughly when. Make at least one visible to the players, and bad enough that they will want to act.
8. Involvement. For each PC with a line into the cluster, write one hook as an undertaking with a foreseeable strategic effect (E.8): which project it advances or obstructs through the Advance effect, and the likely change in Standing (E.3). Leave discoverable signs of secret projects (E.10). A played scene replaces the equivalent off-screen work, not the faction's other activity (E.10).
9. First turn. Take the first World Turn only after play begins. Don't ask for a faction roll to confirm what the party already accomplished (E.8). Off-screen actions use no Momentum, pools, Tychē or Woe (E.10).

Starting history, not a forced resolution. Step 5 establishes the opening incident as already completed before ordinary play. It does not let the GM cancel a resolved PC action, bypass a contested scene or fill another project automatically once play begins. Resolve subsequent PC struggles through the appropriate core procedure and faction actions through E.10. Completing a Site or Region clock does not itself rewrite a Campaign Truth; that still takes a major arc.

Pacing (playtest). Average Power per World Turn for 2d12 + one Quality against Standard 15, before doubles and opposition. The turns below are rough clock-size-to-average-Power estimates, not guaranteed deadlines or a measured distribution of completion times. Overflow is discarded, and actual pacing depends on the declared action, opposition and applicable rules. These retained figures are not conflict win-rate or Disposition-length predictions.

Quality	Average Power per turn	Turns to fill 8	Turns to fill 12
0	0.65	about 12	about 18
+1	0.83	about 10	about 14
+2	1.04	about 8	about 12
+3	1.27	about 6	about 9
+4	1.52	about 5	about 8

E.2 Organizational Qualities

Quality	Measures
Might	Organized force, military readiness, and coercive capacity.
Treasure	Accessible wealth, credit, and financial organization.
Influence	Information networks and ability to shape outside decisions.
Territory	Productive infrastructure, population, holdings, transport, and logistical reach.
Cohesion	Internal loyalty, legitimacy, discipline, and shared identity.

Rating	Capability
0	No independent organized capability in this field.

Rating	Capability
+1	Limited.
+2	Established.
+3	Strong.
+4	Exceptional.

Qualities measure capability, not fixed population or geographical size. A small veteran force can have strong Might. A mobile caravan can have Territory through its vehicles, workforce, and supply arrangements.

Explain every nonzero rating through concrete assets. Influence +3 might mean couriers, shipping agents, and sympathetic officials. It does not mean the faction knows every secret.

A Quality of 0 does not prohibit its members from acting as individuals. It means the organization cannot independently mount a major action in that field without establishing the missing capability or securing outside support.

A permanent Cohesion of 0 is a *crisis* when a faction has fallen to it (E.12). A faction built at Cohesion 0 begins with its Fracture clock created and no automatic tick that turn.

Assets and reach

Assets determine what the faction can actually do. A treasury cannot occupy a town without personnel; soldiers cannot cross a sea without transport. A rating never creates an unstated army, fleet, office, or network.

When an asset matters mechanically, record a Truth with scope, rank, and removal condition. Use its concrete additional advantage, not a second bonus merely restating the Quality. Might already includes the ordinary readiness of the force that justifies its rating.

Record a distant branch separately when local capabilities matter. The imperial institution's full resources are not automatically available to every provincial official.

Changing Qualities

Change a permanent rating only after a lasting change to the capacity it represents. Losing one shipment normally changes an asset, creates Strain, or sets back a project. Losing the principal treasury and credit network may reduce Treasure.

An improvement normally requires an appropriate 8- or 12-segment project, a concrete new resource, and an outcome large enough to justify the next rating. Repetitive minor jobs cannot manufacture permanent growth. No Quality exceeds +4.

E.3 Standing

Standing measures the faction's normal policy toward the party, not the feelings of every member.

Score	Relationship	Normal treatment
−3	Enemy	Actively seeks the party's capture, expulsion, destruction, or lasting defeat.
−2	Hostile	Obstructs the party and supports credible action against its interests.
−1	Distrustful	Demands safeguards, compensation, or supervision.
0	Uncommitted	Judges requests on their immediate merits.
+1	Welcoming	Offers ordinary hospitality, introductions, and opportunities.
+2	Trusted	Shares sensitive information and considers meaningful assistance.
+3	Allied	Treats the party's welfare as an organizational interest within agreed limits.

Standing is not membership, command, fear, or internal unity. A faction may be cohesive and hate the party, or welcome the party while suffering mutiny. A feared enemy can comply with a threat without becoming friendly.

Relationship Truths

When identity is known and the relationship materially affects cooperation, access, or credibility, use one relationship Truth:

Standing	Truth	Rank
−3 / −2	Enemies of the Faction / Hostile Reception	2 adverse
−1	Distrusted by the Faction	1 adverse
0	None	—
+1	Welcome Among the Faction	1 helpful
+2 / +3	Trusted by the Faction / Bound by Alliance	2 helpful

Each relevant rank shifts Difficulty one step (3 points), following Core Rules §8. Helpful and adverse Truths cancel normally; the net shift remains capped at three steps. Relationship Truths do not automatically modify combat, technical work, stealth, or deception.

Scope: recognized dealings with this faction where the relationship affects the request. Removal: replace the Truth when Standing changes or the relevant relationship ends. A personal exception replaces this Truth for its subject; it never stacks with it.

Trust does not compel obedience. Even an ally may refuse something beyond its means, authority, commitments, or capacity to survive. Ordinary assistance already willingly available needs no roll.

Changing Standing

Change Standing for consequential deeds the faction learns about and attributes to the party:

- +1: complete important work, protect a valued asset, uphold a difficult agreement, or make a meaningful sacrifice.
- +2: avert an organizational catastrophe or deliver a transformative victory.
- −1: cause significant avoidable loss, break a meaningful agreement, or seriously undermine the faction.
- −2: betray it, destroy an irreplaceable asset, or deliberately deliver it into an enemy's hands.

Apply changes once per undertaking, normally at its conclusion or when the consequences become known. Usually apply a net change of at most one step per faction per adventure; reserve two steps for decisive events. Clamp Standing between −3 and +3.

Paid work may demonstrate reliability. Honest failure is not betrayal. Declining an ordinary job is not an automatic penalty. Trivial gifts and repeated errands do not improve Standing indefinitely.

Secret deeds create no immediate public change. Record pending exposure when necessary. False accusations may change treatment; record the accusation as a Truth so disproving it offers a route to repair.

Helping one faction does not automatically offend every rival. Change another faction's Standing only when its interests were meaningfully affected and it knows whom to credit or blame.

E.4 Personal Exceptions and Authority

Use party Standing by default. Record an individual exception only when a particular relationship matters: an estranged child of the leader, a sworn member, an acknowledged oathbreaker, or someone who saved a representative's life.

Give the character an effective Standing for that relationship when needed. Party +1 and a character's temple exception −2 means the temple normally welcomes the group but treats that character as hostile in relevant dealings.

An exception applies to its subject, not automatically to everyone standing beside them. A trusted member can arrange an audience for companions without making them trusted members. Personal deeds change the exception unless the faction reasonably holds the whole party responsible.

Membership and office

Record membership, commissions, and offices as scoped Truths, not another numerical Influence track. Examples include Sworn Member, Commissioned Envoy, Licensed Supplier, and Captain of the Northern Watch.

State the permissions, jurisdiction, duration, duties, and removal conditions. Authority requires appointment, election, sponsorship, initiation, or another established process. Standing may open that opportunity; it does not replace it.

A legitimate seal may make access possible. It does not substitute Standing or a faction Quality for Persuade or another PC Skill.

Patronage

Record what a patron supplies, the service expected, what lies outside the arrangement, and what ends it. Routine agreed service is not a new favor each time. Refusal matters according to the actual agreement, not an unlimited claim on the character.

E.5 Seeking Aid

1. State the assistance, timing, location, authorizing representative, burden, and offered compensation.
2. Check capability, reach, available assets, and the representative's authority.
3. Grant willing, available, inconsequential assistance without a roll.
4. Use a single core check for limited uncertainty; use an Argument or Negotiation conflict when the core conflict criteria are met.
5. If the request is impossible now, explain what would have to change.

For a single request check, establish burden before applying relationship and other Truths:

Base Difficulty	Burden
Easy 12	Minor inconvenience or readily available assistance.
Standard 15	Meaningful expense, limited exposure, or diverted personnel.
Hard 18	Serious expense, danger, secrecy, or political embarrassment.
Formidable 21	A major commitment threatening an important interest.
Heroic 24	An extraordinary but still possible commitment.

PCs roll normal Skills. Pools pay for Effort and Resistance; do not add a pool as an attribute. Persuade, Deceive, and Intimidate reflect different methods and consequences. Evidence, compensation, leverage, and timing can change the request's feasibility or relevant Truths.

For that single request check, use normal core outcomes, Power, doubles, and currencies. A Success at a Cost grants the agreed help with the normal consequence-or-Woe choice. Failure does not secure the help and produces an appropriate move. A failed request cannot be repeated unchanged: introduce materially new terms or circumstances.

Extra Power can improve agreed scope, speed, or discretion where normal Effects and the fiction support it. It cannot buy permanent Standing or unlimited resources.

When the request is a conflict. Establish each side's intent and stakes, then use the selected conflict type's action skills, shared Disposition and scripting. The burden ladder above is for a single request check, not a replacement target for every volley: independent tests normally use Standard 15 with applicable Truths and explicit modifiers; versus tests use opposed totals. A trumped action makes no roll. Apply the restricted failure and cost consequences in Core Rules §10.7 rather than adding the single-check GM move. Victory grants the agreed intent within the stakes, subject to compromise, not unrestricted command of the faction (Core Rules §10.2, §10.5–10.6, §10.12–10.13).

E.6 Faction Support in Party Scenes

A Quality establishes what support the faction can organize; Standing, authority, and obligations govern whether it is provided. No faction Quality is added directly to a PC roll.

Support has one concrete application:

- Permission: equipment, credentials, transport, or access makes the action possible, or removes the need for a particular roll.
- A scoped Truth: actual conditions change Difficulty under Core Rules §8.
- Active Help: a participating ally uses the core Help procedure, pays its normal cost, and shares the risk. A faction's accompanying NPC pays the Help cost from its own pools if it is built with them. An ordinary NPC has no pools and cannot pay ordinary Help costs (§6.1); use a named NPC built with pools unless an explicit rule permits another helping benefit. Qualities are not personal pools. Free Help, where explicitly granted, waives the stated cost, not relevance, risk or the bonus-dice cap.

Do not award all three for the same contribution. Stronger Qualities increase feasible reach, reliability, and scale, not an automatic numerical bonus. Might +4 can organize support beyond Might +1; it does not grant +4 Fight.

Accompanying allies. Distinguish an independently acting participant from a supporting asset. A participant enters continuous rotation, uses its listed skills or ratings and is bound by the side's stakes. An asset supplies its stated benefit without gaining an independent turn. Do not count one companion twice or give it a separate Disposition track merely because it accompanies the party. Removing it subtracts no shared Disposition, though a side loses if nobody can continue pursuing its objective (Core Rules §10.9).

Setup Help supplies +1 Disposition per eligible helper instead of also granting an ordinary Help die; its pool-point cost remains an open ruling (§10.2). A faction's size, Quality or number of fictional personnel does not by itself grant that many eligible helpers. Apply the normal contribution and participation requirements.

An escort may make a friendly checkpoint automatic. It cannot make every later negotiation easier simply because it exists. Personnel face the real risks of deployment, and a borrowed resource is not freely duplicable or permanently transferred.

E.7 Favors and Obligations

A favor is a specific acknowledged promise. An obligation is the same record from the debtor's side. Record debtor, creditor, service, limits, notice, deadline or duration, and what settles it. Record who can call it in and whether it benefits the party or a named individual.

Agree to scope when the promise is made. "You owe us something" is an unresolved negotiation, not a blank cheque. Favors can be payment for work, part of an alliance, or compensation for aid.

Calling in a feasible, acknowledged favor within its terms requires no request check. Roll only for a separate uncertainty: evading inspection, locating a vessel, or reaching a destination. Broader or newly dangerous work may require renegotiation; establish whether the changed circumstances fall within the original agreement before rolling.

Possible settlements include fulfillment, an accepted substitute, partial settlement, or an agreed delay. Genuine inability is not automatically betrayal, though concealment or indifference may damage trust.

Knowingly refusing a feasible agreed obligation normally costs one Standing; severe betrayal may cost two. Owing a favor does not remove a player's control over their character. State the consequences and let them choose.

Calling in an earned favor does not reduce Standing. Repaying one does not automatically improve it. Falling Standing does not erase outstanding promises. A favor transfers only with the debtor's consent.

Agreed costs and actual assistance. A favor grants its stated service, not automatic success on every later task, free Help, an extra scripted turn or control over another participant. If a promise is part of an accepted concession or another benefit's payment, generic prevention, Resistance, redirection or incidental clearing cannot erase that accepted cost (Core Rules §10.7). Renegotiation requires agreement; later healing of an injury does not refund the benefit or revoke the concession.

E.8 Adventures and Strategic Advantages

Before an undertaking, explain its likely strategic effect when the characters can reasonably foresee it. "Secure the bridge and our forces can cross this turn with a rank-1 advantage" gives the players a meaningful choice.

Successful adventures may:

- Accomplish an objective outright.
- Advance or obstruct a project through the Advance effect.
- Establish a scoped Truth for a later faction action.

Examples: Enemy Deployment Exposed; Crossing Secured; Troops Paid Before the Muster; Reformers Have Public Support; Southern Squadron Will Not Intervene.

Record scope, rank, duration, and removal condition. Rank 1 is normal; rank 2 requires a decisive advantage. One-use preparation applies to the next relevant action and then expires; persistent advantages endure only as long as their established circumstances do. Apply the core Truth cap.

A roll does not automatically create a lasting Truth merely because it succeeds: use the appropriate core Effect or establish it as the agreed outcome of the completed undertaking. Larger lasting changes need the appropriate project or milestone, as in Module C.6.

Do not require a faction roll to confirm what the party already accomplished. Capturing a bridge does not lead to another roll to see whether it was captured. A separate roll may determine whether the army exploits that opportunity.

Distinct consequences can follow one achievement, but never award duplicate progress or duplicate modifiers for the same

work. One bad PC roll does not automatically damage a whole faction; consequences must reach its people or resources.

One contribution. If a PC endeavour does the work a faction's project action would do (the party sabotages the project itself), that endeavour replaces the faction's own roll for that project this turn. Never count both for the same work.

A played conflict still uses its permitted action effects. Advance or Discover requires an appropriate action or explicit exception; this strategic summary does not add them to every ordinary Maneuver. Ordinary Attack or Feint Disposition loss is not project progress, and a victory grants the stated objective within the stakes rather than completing unrelated clocks (Core Rules §10.6, §10.12).

E.9 Commitments and Strain

A faction normally takes one major project action per World Turn without automatic Strain. Exceptional deployment can exhaust a capability.

Mark one relevant Quality as Strained when the faction takes an additional major action, makes an exceptional deployment to support the party, overextends to meet a deadline, or suffers an explicit exhaustion consequence. Ordinary hospitality, meals, and introductions do not qualify.

A Strained Quality operates one rating lower, minimum 0. Strain does not stack on that Quality and is not also an adverse Truth for the same exhaustion. A faction can take at most one additional major action per turn; declare it and mark Strain before resolving that additional action. It must strain the primary Quality of that action, which must not already be Strained. Thus additional actions cannot be repeated indefinitely.

Timing. Strain from an additional or exceptional action is marked when the action is *declared* (E.10, step 2), so that action and every other action that phase use the lowered rating.

Clear Strain after one full World Turn in which the affected capability is not used for a major action or exceptional commitment, provided recovery remains plausible. Ordinary background activity does not prevent recovery. Strain alone reducing effective Cohesion to 0 does not trigger Fracture; use permanent Cohesion for E.12.

Exhaustion is not destruction. Rest can recover tired guards; it cannot rebuild a burned warehouse. Track persistent losses separately.

E.10 World Turns

Choose one cadence: each in-world week, between adventures, or another agreed meaningful interval. Do not take extra turns simply because a session ended. This procedure replaces Module C.5 while Module E is enabled.

With Module D. The cadence is between adventures: one World Turn per stay. Strain (E.9), Fracture clocks (E.12) and project clocks count in World Turns. A long stay doesn't recover Strain faster, and a short one doesn't skip it.

1. Resolve known consequences of recent play; update Standing, obligations, assets, and exceptions.
2. Declare each active faction's project action, primary Quality, intended outcome, and any exceptional commitment.
3. Resolve actions and opposition. Use ratings at the start of the action phase; apply resulting permanent changes after all declared actions resolve. This prevents turn order from erasing a declared action without warning.
4. Resolve completed clocks, crises, and eligible Strain recovery.
5. Reveal observable developments through news, witnesses, altered conditions, or encounters. Secret projects need not reveal their details, but consequential changes should leave discoverable signs.

Organizational resolution

Roll 2d12 + the relevant effective Quality against Standard 15, adjusted by task difficulty and relevant Truths. Use one primary Quality, not the sum of two. Other capabilities may be prerequisites or provide distinct concrete circumstances; their ratings are not automatic extra modifiers.

- Success: 1 Power, plus 1 per full 3 points over the target.
- Success at a Cost (miss by 1–3): 1 Power and a concrete setback appropriate to the action.
- Failure (miss by 4+): no progress; introduce a relevant setback.
- Doubles follow the core's success/cost/failure twist rules, including double 12s and double 1s.

Organizational exception: off-screen faction actions do not gain or spend the party's Momentum, PC pools, or Tychē Points, and do not generate or spend Woe. Uncommitted Power is discarded. Resolve twists narratively; there is no off-screen Woe buy-off. PC scenes retain all normal core currencies.

Project clocks

Segments	Typical scope
4	Limited local action with few obstacles.
6	Substantial operation or contested local objective.
8	Complex undertaking or lasting institutional change.
12	Major regional transformation.

Commit Power at one segment per Power. A single faction action advances one declared project or produces one limited immediate result; it cannot purchase unrelated outcomes. Cap progress at the remaining segments; discard overflow. Link clocks for wider ambitions.

Use Module C.6 for lasting Site, Region, and Campaign changes: normally 8 segments for a Site Truth, 12 for a Region Truth, and a major arc for a Campaign Truth. A short operational clock does not bypass those requirements.

Opposition and disruption

A faction may spend its action obstructing a known project if it has a credible method. Roll its relevant Quality against Standard

15, adjusted by the target's concrete defenses and other Truths. The target's Quality rating is not automatically a Difficulty shift.

On success, spend Power to remove uncompleted progress, one segment per Power. Remove no more than is present and discard excess. A defending faction may devote its own action to countermeasures, producing appropriate protection or removing the obstructing capability. Do not add a free reaction roll for every attempted disruption.

Declare obstruction or countermeasures in step 2 as the faction's one major action. A faction that defends does not also advance its own project.

Apply all same-turn progress and disruption to a clock together before checking completion. A clock that completes cannot later be "unticked": reversing its established result needs a new undertaking.

If two clocks with contradictory result Truths complete in the same turn, neither result is established as written: the GM and players agree on a compromise Truth, and both factions are Strained.

PCs can use Advance to remove progress when sabotage or delay directly supports that effect. Establish the affected project before the roll. A played scene replaces the equivalent off-screen work, not the whole faction's unrelated activity.

Completion

A project grants its declared result, not every benefit the victor might want. Create, remove, or change a Truth when appropriate; record scope, rank, and removal condition. Completion does not automatically make a Truth rank 2 or increase a Quality.

E.11 Conflict, Objectives, and Pressure

Use core Argument, Negotiation, or Battle conflicts when the action deserves a played conflict. Use normal core Disposition, scripting, Power, concessions, and compromise.

Each side has one shared Disposition total, not a track for every faction member. Complete independently resolving actions before checking victory. Defeat does not itself inflict injury, permanent organizational loss or every objective the winner could want. Resolve mutual defeat under Core Rules §10.12; a winner's compromise uses §10.13 and its outcome-first package, with eligible existing injuries credited once rather than automatic extra injuries. E.10's compromise Truth for contradictory completed project clocks is a separate organizational procedure, not a played conflict's compromise grade.

Standing grants no automatic Superiority. Insider intelligence, an arranged audience, or a secured guarantee can qualify as actual preparation under the core's categories and cap. Evaluate distinct advantages, not labels. Combat receives no direct Standing modifier.

State strategic objectives separately:

- Raid: take or destroy specified resources.
- Occupy: hold a particular place.
- Break resistance: disable a specified fighting force.
- Humiliate: undermine prestige before a relevant audience.
- Annex: establish lasting control over a holding.
- Reconcile: restore cooperation between internal groups.

Winning a battle does not automatically create stable government. Occupation may open a separate integration project and establish Population Rejects the Occupation. One conflict does not grant unrelated spoils or objectives beyond its stakes and compromise.

Woe in faction scenes

Use Woe normally during PC scenes to introduce supported complications, reinforcements, or danger-clock progress. Hostility is a motive, not an unlimited Woe source. A completed World Turn project establishes its result without an extra Woe payment; a new scene complication uses the normal rules. Never charge twice for the same event.

Inside scripted conflicts, ordinary failure does not also authorise an unrelated GM move, automatic injury or extra Disposition loss. Ordinary Success at a Cost likewise adds no status or extra loss without explicit permission. Specials, hazards, Risky rolls and other explicit consequences retain their stated effects and timing (Core Rules §10.7). Woe cannot retroactively change a revealed script or cancel independently resolving actions through generic complication wording. The core's unresolved Woe ruling for losing versus tests remains open.

Woe cannot directly buy a Standing reduction. It can expose evidence or create circumstances that cause one. Momentum and scene-scale Create effects likewise cannot buy permanent reputation.

E.12 Damage, Crisis, and Reorganization

Target the capability actually harmed. Destroying payroll may damage Treasure; exposing agents may damage Influence; losing an estate may damage Territory; defeat may damage Might; betrayal may provoke a Cohesion crisis.

Use an asset loss, setback, adverse Truth, or Strain for limited harm. Permanent rating loss requires a lasting reduction in organizational capacity, established by the stakes or a completed undertaking. Do not subtract a rating point merely for losing any roll. Ordinary shared Disposition loss does not directly reduce a Quality, mark Strain, remove an asset or tick Fracture; those need their own established consequence or explicit trigger.

Fracture

When permanent Cohesion reaches 0, establish an internal crisis and start a 4-segment Fracture clock. Advance it once at the end of each subsequent World Turn that ends with permanent Cohesion still 0. A newly created clock does not receive this automatic tick in its creation turn. Explicit consequences may advance it further.

Restoring permanent Cohesion stops automatic progress but does not erase existing fractures. Reconciliation or another concrete undertaking removes progress. When the clock fills, the faction splits, disbands, loses central authority, or transforms

according to the established situation. Its people and assets do not simply vanish.

Branches, alliances, and mergers

Separate a local branch when its resources or loyalties differ materially. Do not use a resource twice as if parent and branch had independent copies. An alliance provides agreed access and obligations, not summed ratings.

A merger is a reorganization project. Reassess Qualities from the actual combined capacity once integration occurs; do not automatically add ratings or increase matched scores. Hostile absorption may bring assets while reducing Cohesion or creating adverse Truths. Defeating a smaller organization can grant a useful asset without increasing a rating.

E.13 Example: Reed Quay Association

An illustrative faction, not setting canon.

Field	Record
Purpose	Protect river trade and control profitable landing places.
Reach	Lower river settlements and commercial offices in the provincial capital.
Might +1	Dock guards and armed crews.
Treasure +3	Freight income and commercial credit.
Influence +2	Agents, weighmasters, and clerks.
Territory +2	Barges, warehouses, and landing rights.
Cohesion +1	Members cooperate primarily for profit.
Standing +2	Trusted; Nera, master of the eastern landing, represents the association.
Vulnerability	Its principal charter is legally disputed.
Project	Secure Exclusive Ferry Rights, 8 segments: a lasting local institutional change.
Favor	Conceal up to six people aboard one outbound barge this season, with a day's notice; no declared contraband.

The party requests public freight records. Nera willingly supplies them; no roll is needed. Access to sealed judicial records is a different request, possibly requiring an introduction or commission.

The association funds a lawful journey and provides a commercial introduction. Passage permits the journey; the introduction grants an audience. Neither grants +3 Persuade because Treasure is +3.

The party retrieves admissible evidence that a rival obtained a charter through bribery. As the agreed outcome of the undertaking, Rival Charter Under Legal Challenge becomes a rank-1 Truth for the ferry-rights project until the challenge is adjudicated. If the party obtains a final judgment itself, do not roll again to establish that judgment.

On the World Turn, the association uses Influence +2. The evidence lowers the Standard 15 target to Easy 12. Dice of 7 and 9 total 16; +2 gives 18, producing 3 Power. It commits three segments. Without the evidence, the same total against 15 would produce 2 Power.

Later, the party saves the winter grain convoy at substantial personal risk. Once the association learns what happened, Standing may rise to +3. A new favor is not automatic: the association must explicitly promise one.

If the association undertakes an additional urgent funding action that turn, Treasure becomes Strained before that action and operates at +2. It cannot take a third major action. Recovery needs a later full turn without a major Treasure commitment and with plausible access to its credit network.

E.14 Table Reference

Question	Rule
What can it do?	Qualities, assets, and operational reach.
Will it help us?	Standing, authority, commitments, and reasonable requests.
What do PCs roll?	Their normal Skill; never add a faction Quality.
What does support do?	Permission, a scoped Truth, or actual Help; no duplicate benefit.
What does the faction roll?	2d12 + one effective Quality, normally vs. Standard 15.
How does it progress?	1 Power per project segment; no off-screen Momentum or Woe.
How do adventures matter?	Achieve an objective, affect progress, or establish a strategic advantage.
How often does it act?	One major action each World Turn; at most one additional action causing Strain.
What is owed?	A written favor or obligation with scope, limits, and settlement.
What causes collapse?	Permanent Cohesion 0 opens a Fracture crisis, not instant disappearance.

For a faction record, copy E.1 and leave space for five ratings, five Strain marks, Standing, personal exceptions, one project clock, and outstanding promises. Keep rating explanations concrete and show the players changes their characters can observe.

Module F: Inquiry & Revelation

Use this module when a mystery is the point of the game: a murder, a vanished caravan, a forbidden text, a buried ruin. It separates finding from understanding. Finding the clue is never the challenge. Reading it correctly is.

The module changes nothing outside Inquiry scenes. Conflicts, travel, Resistance, Momentum and Woe all work as written. Its explicit Inquiry benefits are not additions to every scripted action's Effect menu.

F.1 The Core Rule

> *If a scene holds a core clue, and a character has a fitting skill rated +1 or higher, that character finds it. No roll. No cost. No failure.*

- Core clue. A fact the group needs to reach the next scene or to understand the Truth of the case. Every Inquiry scene has at least one.
- Fitting skill. Any skill from the setting's skill list that the GM can reasonably tie to the clue. Several skills can reach the same clue by different routes.
- Description. The player says what the character does and which skill it uses, or the GM offers the clue unprompted to a character who clearly has it.
- Stuck groups. If nobody has a fitting skill, the clue floats (§F.6) to another source. A core clue is never locked behind a missing skill.

Finding a clue automatically is not automatic success at an unrelated conflict action. It grants no Power, extra scripted turn, script change or permission to act while Taken Out. Do not require a Probe or Buy merely to obtain the guaranteed core clue.

F.2 Insight: The Extra Layer

A core clue gets you to the next scene. Insight is everything beyond that: motive, timing, who else was involved, what the culprit will do next, a shortcut, an ally. Insight is optional, and you can gain it in two ways.

Method	How it works
Probe	Roll 2d12 + the skill vs. a Difficulty set by the GM (usually Standard 15). Each Power you spend on Discover (Core Rules §5) is one Insight. The usual outcomes apply: a miss by 1–3 is a Success at a Cost, and a miss by 4+ is a Failure that gives the GM 1 Woe. A failed Probe never removes a core clue.
Buy	Spend 4 – Edge points (minimum 1) from the skill's pool, with no roll. You gain exactly one Insight. The pool is the one that pays for that skill in Effort and Resistance (Core Rules §3.3).

Probe is cheap but risky. Buy is safe but drains the pool you also need for Resistance and Effort. Players should have to choose between them.

Payment. Work out permitted discounts and the minimum cost, then pay the Buy in full. It is a voluntary benefit purchase, not Resistance or an imposed cost, so it cannot overrun an insufficient pool (Core Rules §6.1). Spending the exact last points still runs the pool dry normally. No-roll use does not waive that payment.

WHICH POOL PAYS?

Sōma: long vigils, exhumations, hard physical labour. Mētis: meticulous search, tailing, lock and mechanism work. Psychē: deduction, records, anatomy, languages. Pneuma: reading people, rites, dread places, the uncanny. The GM may allow a different pool when the fiction supports it (Core Rules §3.3).

F.3 What an Insight Can Be

When you gain an Insight, choose one. The GM may veto a choice that does not fit the scene.

- Detail. A true fact that deepens a clue you already have. It can help you solve the case, but it is never required to reach the next scene.
- Edge. Create a Truth that fits what you learned (*the guard captain is afraid of the cellar*). It lasts for the scene, or until the case ends if the group spends an extra Power or point.
- Contact. Name an ally, informant or source, and say how you know them. The GM adds a short tag.
- Spotlight. Show real expertise in front of others. You gain a free invoke of one tag or Truth about your standing, once per scene. Use this to shine, not to win a fight.
- Foresight. The GM tells you one thing the opposition is about to do.

If no Insight fits, nothing happens and no points are lost. Buy costs are refunded.

Benefit scope. Edge is the name of this Insight option, not an increase to a pool's Edge. Its Truth uses the normal default rank, scope and removal condition (Core Rules §8); the listed case-long extension is an explicit Inquiry exception, not a general change to Create's cost or duration. The extra Power or point's payment source remains unspecified here; this pass does not invent a currency choice.

A Contact provides the stated relationship or access, not automatic faction Standing, a permanent reputation tag, free Help or an independent turn. A Spotlight invoke does not itself award permanent Standing or reputation. Foresight provides information, not free actor reassignment, a script change or retroactive cancellation of the opposition's action. Use the core conflict rules for acting on any of these benefits (§10.3, §10.5, §10.9).

F.4 Boosted Skills and Recovery

- Boosted skill. At creation, mark one skill you hold at +1 or higher. When you Buy an Insight with it, regain 1 point to

the paying pool. Mark another skill each time you have taken 4 Advances.

- Recovery. Pools recover as usual (Core Rules §6). The GM may also offer a refresh opportunity: a night in an archive, a round of drinks in the right tavern, a meal with a scholar. Each restores 2 points to the pool that fits.
- Help. One ally may Help a Probe as normal (Core Rules §2.4), or contribute a relevant skill to a Buy. Add +1 point of discount per helper, to a minimum cost of 1.
- Tags. A power tag that applies to the skill adds +1 to a Probe, as usual. Burning one gives +1 Power.

Pay before boosted-skill recovery: regaining 1 point is not a discount that lets an otherwise unaffordable Buy proceed. If payment runs the pool dry, apply its running-dry consequence normally; the later point does not clear that status. Pool recovery and status healing remain separate, and neither removes a Scar. A refresh opportunity is this module's explicit recovery exception, offered by the GM, not an automatic refill whenever an Inquiry scene begins or ends.

Probe Help and tags retain normal relevance, risk and caps, including the +2 power-tag cap and the +2 bonus-dice cap. The Buy's pool-point discount is not a bonus die or additional Insight. Free Help, where granted, waives its stated cost rather than relevance or risk.

F.5 Danger and the Clock

Inquiry has no failure state, so it needs pressure from somewhere else. Pressure comes from the opposition, not from missed rolls.

- Woe pays for Reaction. When a Probe fails, or when the group lingers, the GM gains Woe as normal. The GM may spend Woe on an Antagonist Reaction: the culprit destroys evidence, a witness vanishes, a patron grows impatient, an ambush is arranged.
- The case clock. Start a 6-segment clock (Core Rules §7) called *They Know We Know*. Tick it when the group makes noise, takes a long time, or when a Probe fails by 4+. When it fills, the opposition acts decisively.
- Danger is a separate scene. A scene either asks "what do we learn?" (Inquiry) or "what do we survive?" (Conflict, Hazard). A scene that is both is two scenes: finish one, then start the other.
- Clues never depend on winning a fight. Winning may give Insight, but a core clue must be reachable even if the group loses, flees or is captured.

The case clock's failed-Probe tick is an explicit Inquiry trigger, not a tick on every ordinary failed scripted action. Antagonist Reactions still respect established facts and the core-clue guarantee; destroying a source cannot make the case's required information unreachable.

Separating Inquiry and danger scenes does not make a continuing struggle a genuinely new conflict. Carry forward current and starting Disposition, used injury trades, Taken Out participants and continuing effects when the same conflict continues (Core Rules §10.2). Do not refresh pools or clear injuries merely by changing the scene label. Inside a scripted conflict, use its ordinary-failure restrictions and complete independently resolving actions before checking victory (§10.7, §10.12).

F.6 Building a Case

Work backward from the Truth, then forward through scenes.

1. The Truth. Write one paragraph: who, what, why, and how it was done.
2. The Hook. Tie it to a Belief, Goal or Instinct of at least one PC.
3. The Twist. Something that widens or changes the case halfway through.
4. The Conclusion. A confrontation, a choice, or a public accusation. Core clues bring the group here, but the players decide what to do with what they know.
5. The scenes. Link them with clues, as below.

Clue type	Use
Core clue	Points to a scene or to the Truth. Always found, never rolled for.
Lead-in	A clue that points *to* a scene. Give every scene at least two lead-ins from different scenes, so the case is a web and not a line.
Floating clue	The GM places it wherever the group looks first. Use it for the clue the case cannot do without.
Leveraged clue	Available only once the group holds another clue. Example: a suspect clams up until you confront them with the ledger.
Pipe clue	A detail that seems like colour now and pays off later.
Red herring	True, interesting and misleading. Never a lie told by the narrator. Give each one a source and a reason.

Scene types: Introduction, Core (holds core clues), Alternate (another route to a clue), Subplot, Action (Conflict or Hazard), Reaction (the opposition responds) and Conclusion.

F.7 Running Inquiry

- Cover the skills. Build an Investigator Matrix, a table of the party's skills against the case's scenes. Give each PC a scene where their skills matter most.
- Be generous. Give information freely. Let players chase red herrings. Give minor NPCs a past and a want.
- Core clues lead to the end, not through it. Following them only gets the party to the last scene. Insight and good reasoning decide whether they arrive prepared.
- Listen and improvise. When players theorise, borrow their best ideas, provided they do not contradict a core clue or the Truth.
- Share the world. A good Insight lets the player describe the contact, the rumour or the detail, within the Truths already established.
- Prompt early. For the first session or two, remind players what their skills can do.

F.8 Weird Methods

Oracles, divinations, scrying, speaking to the dead and similar methods are tools that produce clues, not answers. An Arcana-style skill finds core clues like any other. The result is a true but partial, symbolic or conditional reading. Use Pneuma for the Buy or Probe. Opponents who expect scrying can block it, mislead it, or leave a false trail with their own working. Let the setting decide whether such evidence counts as proof.

QUICK REFERENCE

Core clue: fitting skill (+1 or higher) → found, free.
Probe: 2d12 + skill vs. Standard 15; each Power on Discover = 1 Insight.
Buy: 4 − Edge (minimum 1) from the skill's pool = 1 Insight, no roll; pay in full.
Boosted skill: Buy with it → regain 1 point after payment.
Case clock: 6 segments; tick on noise, delay, or a Probe failed by 4+.
Danger: a separate scene, not an automatic resource reset; clues never depend on winning.

CHAPTER IV

Adversaries

Build opposition on an index card, budget the fight, script it, and run it through the conflict system. Terse reference for the GM.

Every adversary has one thing it is clearly best at. Show the table the Tell.

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1. Principles

- No pools. Ordinary adversaries do not track Sōma, Mētis, Psychē or Pneuma. Grit contributes to their side's starting shared Disposition; it is not a personal track. Shrugs are free Resists. Rivals built as full PCs use their PC resources and applicable exceptions.
- Tags are already counted. Ratings include tags. PCs still Discover, Burn and compel them.
- Woe is fuel. Ordinary adversaries buy bonus dice (1 Woe each, max +2 including free dice) and fire Specials with Woe. They never use Effort and cannot overrun Woe costs.
- One best action. Every card has one clearly best action and a Tell that hints at it. Give the players something to script around.
- Index-card size. If it does not fit on a card, cut it.

2. The Card

```
NAME — Kind · Rank · Role                                  Threat N
Grit N · Guard +N · Shrugs N · Armour N
Attack +N · Defend +N · Feint +N · Maneuver +N · Other +N
Harm: status (source)
Power tags: … · Weakness tags: …
Kind: traits from the Kind package
Role: role trait
Specials: Name (Woe cost): effect
Tell: the visible sign before it uses its Best action
Wants: what it is after in this scene
```

Field	Meaning
Grit	The adversary's contribution to its side's starting shared Disposition. Add up Grit across a side; adversary sides do not roll for Disposition. Do not track or deplete individual Grit shares.
Guard	Added to Standard 15 when a PC's independent roll targets this adversary.
Shrugs	Free Resists per scene; each cuts an incoming status by 2 tiers. Extra Shrugs cost 1 Woe. Subject to the one-reduction limit below.
Armour	−1 tier of physical harm per point; subject to the one-reduction limit below.
Ratings	Bonus on each conflict action. Other covers rolls outside a conflict.
Harm	Status inflicted by a successful Attack outside a conflict. Tiers equal Power.
Threat	Its cost against the encounter budget. Always equals Grit.

Reduction and payments. Ordinary NPCs apply at most one eligible reduction per imposed status application (Core Rules §10.14); do not stack Armour and repeated Shrugs against the same status. Neither reduces ordinary shared Disposition loss or protected payments. General immunity, prevention and redirection likewise cannot cancel accepted injury trades, running-dry statuses, agreed concession costs or other accepted payments (§10.7). Later treatment or healing follows its own rules and refunds no benefit.

3. Building an Adversary

Step 1 — Concept and Kind

One line: who it is and what it wants. Pick a Kind: Human, Beast or Guardian (§4), or a Kind supplied by the setting.

Step 2 — Rank

Rank is how dangerous it is *now*. It sets every number.

Rank	Grit = Threat	Best / Fair / Weak	Tags: Guard	Shrugs	power / weakness	Specials
Minion group (3–6 Bodies)	3	+4 / +2 / +0	+0	Bodies	2 / 1	1 group trait

Rank	Grit = Threat	Best / Fair / Weak	Guard	Shrug	Tags: power / weakness	Specials
Minor	3	+5 / +3 / +1	+0	0	2 / 1	1
Established	5	+6 / +4 / +2	+1	1	3 / 1	2
Great	8	+8 / +5 / +3	+2	2	4 / 2	3
Paramount	12	+10 / +7 / +4	+3	3	5 / 2	4

Settings supply any Kind-specific construction exceptions; do not add a setting bonus again when its listed Grit already includes it.

Tiers. Minion groups are the mob. Minor and Established are rivals. Great and Paramount can serve as bosses, but Rank alone does not grant Boss Phases. Explicit phased-boss designation follows §7.1.

Use +6 as a starting-PC benchmark from skill and tags, not a universal maximum. With one bonus die, that PC wins a versus roll about this often against an adversary that rolls no bonus dice:

Adversary rating	+2	+4	+6	+8	+10
PC win chance	85%	77%	67%	56%	about 45%

Each Woe die you add moves the odds back toward the adversary. These are roll benchmarks, not encounter-win predictions; versus totals, exceptional doubles and ability-created doubles follow Core Rules §2.6 and §10.5. The listed benchmarks are not current encounter-balance validation.

Step 3 — Role

The Role names the Best action and gives one trait. Assign Fair to two other actions and Weak to the last. A Beast or simple machine has no Feint: it gets Best, Fair, Fair.

Role	Best	Role trait
Brute	Attack	Heavy Hitter. First successful Attack each exchange gets +1 Power. Resolve area effects under Core Rules §10.17; do not multiply this bonus across shared Disposition. Outside conflicts, its Harm is +1 tier.
Shooter	Attack	Dead Aim. Free bonus die on its first Attack each scene.
Bulwark	Defend	Interpose. Once per exchange, it may intercept an ally's imposed status before Resistance or harm reduction, using its own normal reduction instead. No shared Disposition loss is redirected. Outside conflicts, it may likewise intercept fitting harm without a separate frequency limit. Follow the full timing, exclusions and area restrictions in Core Rules §10.18.
Skirmisher	Maneuver	Hit and Run. A successful Maneuver also removes 1 Disposition from the opponent.
Controller	Maneuver	Shape the Ground. Once per scene, Create a Truth for 1 Woe (not 2) or for 1 Power from a Maneuver.
Trickster	Feint	Ambush. If the PCs have not noticed it when the conflict begins, its side starts with +2 Disposition.
Leader	Defend or Maneuver	Command. While the Leader remains able to participate, minion groups on its side get +1 to all ratings, and changing its side's script costs 2 Woe (not 3).

Step 4 — Tags

Write as many as the Rank allows.

- Power tags explain the Best action: faster than you can see, old-world steel, a hundred donors.
- Weakness tags are levers PCs can find with Discover: proud beyond reason, fears fire, fixed in place.
- Burning a power tag (Weaken 1, Disarm 3, Called Shot) lowers the rating it supports by 1 for the scene. If the tag powers a Special, the Special is off for the scene instead.
- Using a Discovered weakness gives the PC +1 on the roll.
- Compelling a weakness costs 1 Momentum or 1 Tychē. The adversary acts on it and the GM gains 1 Woe.

Use the effect permissions of the procedure being resolved (Core Rules §5, §10.6). A successful scripted action may buy relevant Discover; this summary grants no unrelated questions or additional status permission. General Weaken requires an explicit ability in conflicts; use Maneuver's priced Disarm for ordinary asset denial. Called Shot retains only its named permission and duration.

Step 5 — Specials, Harm, Tell, Wants

Pick Specials from the Kind menu up to the Rank limit. Price a new one:

Woe	What it can do
0	Always-on trait, or a once-per-scene minor trick (Armour 1, step between shadows).
1	+1 Power or a free bonus die on one roll. A tier-2 status on one target. Cancel one PC trick. One minion as reinforcement.
2	Create a Truth. A tier-3 status. Leave the scene. An area effect.
3	Changes the scene: a significant reinforcement, recover 2 tiers or 3 Disposition, a danger-clock tick plus an effect.

This is pricing guidance, not an unrestricted spend menu. Write a Special's trigger, action requirement, targets and component explicitly. Free waives only its listed cost; it grants no extra turn or rotation bypass. Additional Power, Disposition loss and status tiers are distinct, and a bonus does not apply to both loss and harm unless stated. Cancelling a trick does not cancel a protected payment (Core Rules §10.5–10.7).

Area Rule (provisional for playtesting). Use Core Rules §10.17. Establish the area and everyone it can reach; there is no automatic ally/enemy selection. An area Attack or Feint removes its committed Power + 1 from shared Disposition once, plus 1 per additional opposing participant affected. No individual shares or spill-over. A group represented by one rules entry counts as

one participant, not one per Body. Explicit statuses apply at full purchased or listed tier to every affected character, with separate Resistance or NPC reduction. An ordinary conflict Attack gains no status merely for being an area effect. Apply both layers only when an explicit rule grants both. At most one participant may accept an injury trade against the combined loss of a single area Attack or Feint.

4. Kind Packages

Human

- Morale. Outside conflicts, a minion group or Minor flees or surrenders at half Bodies or when its leader is Taken Out, unless a Leader still stands.
- Can be talked to. Persuade, Intimidate, bribes, Argument and Negotiation all work.
- Gear is in the ratings. Write Armour separately.
- Build Great or Paramount rival hunters as full PCs.

Special	Woe	Effect
Volley	2	Group or Shooter. An area Attack.
Dirty Trick	1	Any success also Impedes the opposing side's next scripted action (−3 on its action roll), not a tiered status or a penalty to Resistance. Pending Impedes do not stack and expire if that action makes no roll.
Call for Help	1 per minion / 3	Reinforcements arrive and add their Grit to the side.
Hostage	2	Create the Truth "a knife at their throat." Attacks against its side are one step harder.
Last Stand	2	Defeat-triggered. At an eligible defeat at 0 shared Disposition, postpone defeat for one final volley for both sides (§6.10). Once per side per conflict; no personal extra action.
Fanatic	0	Ignores Morale.

Beast

- No Feint. Ratings are Best, Fair, Fair. The missing Feint is the trade-off.
- Cannot be reasoned with. No Persuade or Argument. Intimidate and fire work. Every beast starts with a weakness such as fears fire.
- Morale as Human. Packs scatter when the pack leader falls.

Special	Woe	Effect
Pack Tactics	0	Group trait. +1 Attack if another member of its side Attacked earlier this exchange.
Pounce	1	Free bonus die on its first Attack in a scene. If it wins, apply Impede to the opposing side's next scripted action under Core Rules §10.6.
Savage Bite	1	+1 Power on a successful Attack.
Thick Hide	0	Armour 1.
Venom / Infection	2	After a successful Attack during a conflict, pay 2 Woe to record one deferred poisoned-2 application against the target. Resolve it when the conflict ends under §6.12, regardless of the outcome; compromise does not cause another application. Outside conflicts, inflict poisoned-2 on the hit instead, paying the same listed cost. Once inflicted, the poisoned status rises by 1 tier per scene until treated; a pending record does not progress.
Howl	2	A minion pack (Grit 3) arrives at the end of the exchange.
Bolt	2	It leaves the scene.

Guardian

- Unfeeling. Immune to fear, Intimidate, Persuade, Duel of Wills and Pneuma statuses. No Morale; it never flees.
- Protocol. It scripts in a pattern. One Discover reveals its next exchange's script.
- Machine. The glitched status lowers all ratings by its tier. A PC with access can use Science as Attack (shutdown) or Maneuver (override).
- Simple machines have no Feint. Thinking constructs Feint normally.

Special	Woe	Effect
Suppressing Fire	2	An area Attack.
Scan	1	Cancel a Stealth-based Maneuver's effect, or reveal a hidden PC.
Self-Repair	1	Restore 2 of its side's shared Disposition (up to the side's starting value) or 2 tiers of physical status.
Lockdown	2	Create the Truth Sealed Doors.
Shock Field	1	When a PC loses a versus roll to it in melee, record one deferred jolted-2 application against that PC (§6.12). This trigger is not limited to Attack.
Fail-safe	3	Defeat-triggered. At eligible final defeat at 0 shared Disposition, an active Guardian detonates before finishing procedures, assigning burned-3 to each PC within reach as an additional compromise injury (§6.11). The Guardian is destroyed.
Calls the Works	2	Another guardian arrives.

Special procedures and remaining scope. Last Stand uses §6.10; Fail-safe uses its separate compromise procedure in §6.11; Shock Field, Venom / Infection and any setting Special that explicitly refers to it use the outcome-independent deferred-injury procedure in §6.12. These are explicit Special exceptions, not ordinary Attack effects or permissions to cancel protected payments. A setting supplies its own additional Kind packages and Special entries; the shared procedures grant no unstated trigger, extra turn or actor reassignment. Other unstated interactions remain open.

5. Encounter Budget

Legacy calibration; playtest flag. The retained budget uses P = about 8 plus party size as a historical benchmark, not the current PC setup formula. Current rolled setup divides 2d12 + Disposition skill + highest pool Edge by 3, rounds down, then adds helpers and flat modifiers at full value before the minimum of 1 and Superiority (Core Rules §10.2–10.3). Recalibrate the expectations below against that procedure; this pass changes no Threat, Grit or budget numbers. Spend Threat (= Grit) against the retained benchmark only with that limitation in mind.

Difficulty	Threat budget	Extra Woe	Legacy expectation
Easy	½ P	none	PCs win without spending Tychē. Openers and calibration.
Standard	P	none	PCs should win and take a Minor or Significant compromise.
Hard	P + 3	+2	PCs win only if they play well. One bad Disposition roll can lose it.
Deadly	P + 6 or more	+4	Signpost it. Flight, bargaining or burning Tychē are real outcomes.

Party size	2	3	4	5
Legacy P	10	11	12	13

- Mix at least two Roles. A Controller with a Skirmisher pack and a Minor Brute gives players script decisions.
- Keep actors to party size + 1 or fewer. Put extra bodies into minion groups.
- Count Woe separately. Session Woe (2 per PC) plus any setting-provided introduction Woe can stack fast. If the encounter already carries introduction Woe, treat Hard as Standard plus Woe.
- Disposition-cutting PC abilities (such as −2 or −3 to the opposing side) apply after the budget.
- Superiority (Know Thy Foe, Know Thy Battlefield, Know Thy Players) lowers opposing Disposition by 1 per eligible distinct category, up to 3, after other setup modifiers and the minimum of 1. Only Superiority can reduce an adjusted start to 0. Determine both sides' adjusted totals first: if only one is 0, its opponent wins at no cost within the stakes; if both are 0, resolve simultaneous setup defeat as mutual defeat without scripting or a winner's compromise (Core Rules §10.3, §10.12). Symmetry and eligibility retain the core playtest flags.
- Variance warning. The PCs' Disposition roll can materially change the matchup; adversary Grit is fixed. If the result makes the struggle unusually dangerous, signpost it and offer exits rather than treating the legacy difficulty label as a guarantee.

6. Running Adversaries

6.1 Setup

1. State intent, stakes and exits for both sides (Core §10.2). State whether death is possible before any roll.
2. Before calculating starting Disposition, record any eligible phased-boss designation and fixed Start/Half Special assignments (§7.1). Designate at most one phased boss per side; designation adds no Grit or Woe.
3. Add up Grit across the side. Apply Ambush (+2 when eligible) and other flat setup modifiers at full value, then a minimum of 1, then opposing Superiority. Determine both sides' adjusted totals before resolving setup. If only one is 0, its opponent wins at no cost within stakes; if both are 0, resolve mutual defeat. Neither outcome activates phases or proceeds to scripting. Record the original adjusted starting Disposition for recovery limits and compromise; do not divide Grit or add an already included setting bonus again.
4. Set Woe: 2 per PC plus Difficulty extras plus any setting-provided introduction Woe, counting introduction Woe only once in the campaign and retaining any already established session balance.
5. Commit one three-action script for the side, assigning an eligible participant to each action. A minion group is one participant, not one actor per Body.

6.2 Scripting

Each exchange is three volleys. Commit three actions and their actors before the first reveal (Core Rules §10.5).

- Track rotation continuously across exchanges: every available participant acts before anyone repeats; no consecutive turns unless only one participant is available.
- Consider opening with the strongest eligible actor's Best action.
- Vary the script to avoid predictable patterns; repeating an action category is legal when actors and rotation permit it.
- Consider a Defend or Maneuver when the side's shared Disposition is under half its starting value. These are tactical suggestions, not mandatory scripts.
- Show the Tell before the Best action; telegraph an opening action before its reveal.
- Update rotation when a participant leaves or becomes unable to act. An unsuitable or unperformable assigned action grants no free actor replacement; normal script changes retain the assigned actor unless an explicit ability permits reassignment.
- Disarm disables the named asset, not automatically an action category. If another plausible approach remains, the assigned actor may use it; switching gear does not change the script. Otherwise the action may be lost. Before reveal, the GM may pay 3 Woe (2 with an eligible Leader) to change the unrevealed action, not its actor.

6.3 Action Results

- Attack. Commit at least 1 Power to ordinary loss to remove committed Power + 1 from opposing shared Disposition; apply the +1 once per action, not per purchase. No commitment means no loss. An area Attack applying ordinary loss adds 1 per additional opposing participant affected (Core Rules §10.17). No status unless explicitly permitted.
- Defend. Each committed Power restores 1 shared Disposition up to the original adjusted starting value. No commitment means no recovery unless an explicit ability grants it independently. At or above the cap, recovery restores nothing but removes no existing excess. Defend does not restore a personal Grit track, heal statuses or return a Taken Out participant; permitted supplementary purchases remain available.
- Feint. As Attack for loss. It resolves independently against Defend, is trumped by Attack, opposes Feint and resolves independently against Maneuver.
- Maneuver. Power buys Impede (1), Gain Position (1), Disarm (3), Create a Truth (2 per rank), permitted supplementary Effects or an eligible scenery action. Buy Impede, Gain Position and Disarm at most once each per Maneuver. Impede and Gain Position affect the relevant side's next scripted action, not Resistance; they expire unused if it makes no roll. Pending Impedes do not stack, and Gain Position counts toward the bonus-dice cap.
- Independent rolls against an adversary use Standard 15 plus its Guard, adjusted by applicable Truths and explicit modifiers.
- Versus rolls: the higher total wins with 1 Power, +1 per full 3 points over the opponent. Double 12s do not override a higher total or break a tie. Winning ordinary doubles add +1 Power; winning double 12s add +2 instead. Losing or tied doubles grant no Power or normal action effect. Double 1s cause their complication without automatically losing; successful double 1s also gain the ordinary critical Power. Apply the same procedure to ability-created doubles. An exact tie produces no normal action effect or Power. Losing by 1–3 does not qualify for Success at a Cost. Versus losses, ties and trumped actions generate no ordinary-failure Woe (Core Rules §2.6, §10.5–10.7).
- Supplementary spending. Use Core Rules §10.6 for each action's permissions and limits. No primary purchase is mandatory; all Power may fund permitted supplementary Effects, without double spending. Winning versus prevents the opposing normal effect even if no Power funds loss or recovery; independent opposing actions still resolve. Exceptions grant only their stated scope.
- Automatic success. Replace only an otherwise permitted action's roll, not its interaction or assigned turn. Use listed Power; in versus it wins unless both automatically succeed,

then tie unless expressly overridden. No extra action, rescue of a trumped action or dice-based critical/complication follows.

- Resolution order. Trumped actions make no roll and produce no effect. Both independent actions finish before checking victory, even if one defeats a side or takes an actor out. Check eligible Last Stand before final settlement (§6.10). For a phased boss, check thresholds only after removal and victory are determined and the conflict continues without pending defeat (§7.1). Use §§6.11–6.12 for Special aftermath timing.

6.4 Woe Economy

Gain Woe from player-bought dice, eligible independent failures (+1), Escalation (+1), dangerous scene Truths (+1 per scene) and bought-off complications (+2). Versus losses, ties and trumped actions generate no ordinary-failure Woe, symmetrically for player and GM actors. Separately triggered complications, explicit costs and scenery Dangers retain their own rules (Core Rules §10.7).

Spend	Cost
Bonus die on an adversary roll	1 per die, max +2 including free dice
Fire a Special	1–3
Reinforcements	1 per minion, 3 significant
Change an unrevealed scripted action before reveal	3 (2 with an eligible Leader)
Tick a danger clock	1 per segment
Extra Shrug	1
Trigger a listed scenery Danger	1

Spend on the Best action early. Unspent Woe at session end is wasted tension. An ordinary failed conflict action does not also authorise an unrelated GM move or extra harm. Independent Success at a Cost follows Core Rules §10.7; ordinary costs add no status or extra Disposition loss without explicit permission. Complications respect stakes and independent-action timing.

6.5 Reinforcements

Reinforcements add their listed Grit to current shared Disposition only, even above the original adjusted starting value. They do not raise starting Disposition, the normal recovery cap or the compromise reference (Core Rules §10.9, §10.13). Defend and other recovery restore only up to the original start unless explicitly overridden. At or above the cap, restore nothing and do not remove an existing excess; other permitted Defend purchases remain available. Removal subtracts no Grit. Joining participants enter continuous rotation under Core Rules §10.5; arrival grants no extra scripted action, free actor reassignment or setup recalculation. Only a genuinely new conflict establishes a new start. Boss phase references and thresholds remain fixed (§7.1). During a Last Stand volley, reinforcement arrival remains legal under its own timing, but its Grit cannot raise the pending-defeat side above 0 (§6.10).

6.6 Minion Bodies

Minion groups have Bodies (3–6) instead of Shrugs. Each successful Attack outside a conflict drops 1 Body. Extra Power spent on Extra Feat drops another. At half Bodies or fewer, ratings drop by 1. At zero, the group is gone. Morale usually ends it sooner. Ordinary conflict Disposition loss removes no Bodies and does not deplete an individual Grit share. A group represented by one entry is one participant for rotation and area-effect loss bonuses.

6.7 When Adversaries Win Or Lose

- Defeat. A side loses at 0 Disposition or when nobody can continue pursuing its objective. Complete independent actions before checking victory. An eligible Last Stand may postpone defeat at 0 for one final volley (§6.10); finish that extension before finishing procedures or settlement. Defeat is not automatic death or injury; outcomes stay within intent and stakes. Removal subtracts no Disposition. If both sides are defeated in the same volley, or both start at 0 after Superiority, use mutual defeat, not a winner's compromise (Core Rules §10.3, §10.12). Simultaneous setup defeat scripts no exchanges and does not itself inflict injury, drain pools, Take Out an individual or satisfy a finishing requirement.
- No injury trade. Ordinary adversaries and minion groups cannot use it (Core §10.14). A named rival built as a full PC can, subject to §10.11: once per character per conflict, at most one participant per Attack or Feint.
- Compromise. Resolve deferred Special applications before ordinary existing-injury credit; include any eligible Failsafe assignments under §6.11. Neither procedure changes the ordinary compromise grade. Use the winner's original adjusted starting Disposition recorded at setup, unchanged by reinforcements. Remaining Disposition at or above that start means none lost; use the final remaining total, not cumulative loss or a separate reinforcement ledger. Use the starting Disposition lost: none = None; more than 0 but less than half = Minor; at least half but less than three-quarters = Significant; three-quarters or more = Major, without rounding. Negotiate one outcome-first package. Injury tiers 2/3/4 guide its severity, not automatic additions. Credit eligible existing injuries once. NPCs may use eligible reduction against imposed compromise statuses, not agreed payments; Resistance does not revoke the loser's concession or create a replacement injury cost (Core §10.13).
- Concession. Offer one before the next roll (Core §10.12); one third of starting shared Disposition is a tactical prompt, not a restriction. Propose concrete gains and retained interests suited to the opponent: humans may surrender, beasts may be distracted or allowed to flee, and a Boss may negotiate retreat. Guardians do not normally offer concessions. If accepted, apply the agreed terms without another roll or an additional compromise unless included. Recorded deferred Special applications remain imposed, Resistable Special effects under §6.12; concession terms must acknowledge

them and cannot waive them or turn them into protected payments. Do not add an unstated retreat benefit or danger-clock tick.

6.8 Outside Conflicts

- Passive opposition. Difficulty = 12 + the adversary's relevant rating. A Minor's Defend (Fair +3) gives 15; an Established Steward's Defend (+6) gives 18. This outside-conflict procedure does not replace Standard 15 + Guard for independent conflict tests.
- Active opposition. Roll versus: 2d12 + rating.
- Harm to adversaries. Attack Power inflicts statuses as normal. Apply at most one eligible NPC reduction per application. Tier 6 applies the status's established scope and breaking-point procedure; explicit creature replacements apply only where stated. Apply any explicit creature-specific status ceiling from the setting. Do not introduce Disposition loss outside conflicts.

6.9 Other Conflict Types

The same card runs any type in Core §10.4. Swap Attack, Defend, Feint and Maneuver for that type's skills and keep the ratings, Grit and Woe costs. Rename Specials to fit: Hostage becomes a leverage threat in an Argument, Lockdown a sealed network in a Hack. A reskin still needs a plausible approach and cannot widen intent, stakes or effect permissions.

6.10 Last Stand

Last Stand is a defeat-triggered Special costing 2 Woe. It gives both sides one final volley, not an individual action outside rotation.

Activation. Complete the deciding volley, including both independent actions, then check removal, defeat and mutual defeat. If a side is defeated at 0 shared Disposition, at least one participant remains able to pursue its objective, and a participating bearer has Last Stand unlocked and usable, the GM may pay 2 Woe before finalizing defeat. A Taken Out or otherwise unable bearer cannot activate it. Exclude setup defeat, mutual defeat and defeat solely because nobody can continue.

For a designated phased boss, Last Stand must already have unlocked at Half and become usable from a subsequent volley (§7.1). Reaching 0 does not unlock it retroactively. Non-phased bearers follow their own availability rules.

One final volley. Postpone defeat, finishing procedures and compromise until exactly one additional volley resolves. Both sides follow normal action interactions, costs, helping, participation and continuous rotation. Use each side's next unrevealed scripted action and its assigned actor. If the exchange has ended, each side secretly commits one action and an eligible actor, then reveals normally. This is not a new exchange: do not refresh exchange-limited abilities or tick clocks merely for scripting the added action. Changing an unrevealed action retains the normal cost and assigned actor; Last Stand grants no free change or reassignment. An unperformable action has no free replacement.

Defeat stays pending. The activating side remains at 0 shared Disposition. Defend, reinforcement Grit and other Disposition recovery cannot raise it during this volley or cancel its pending defeat. This restriction does not prevent otherwise legal supplementary purchases, status healing or other explicit effects. Reinforcements may arrive under their listed timing and participate only when normal scripting and rotation permit; arrival grants no immediate action. Last Stand neither returns a removed participant nor allows action through incapacity.

No new phase activates while defeat is pending. Previously activated benefits apply only while the boss remains eligible; there is no phase refresh or bonus action.

Final outcome. Complete all independently resolving actions. The activating side then loses; if its opponent is also defeated, resolve mutual defeat. Otherwise determine the winner within the stakes from the final state. A side may use Last Stand only once per conflict; multiple bearers do not stack or chain extensions. Resolve eligible Fail-safe next, then permitted finishing procedures, deferred applications and ordinary compromise (§§6.11–6.12). Last Stand grants no immunity to those outcomes.

6.11 Fail-safe

Fail-safe is a separate defeat-triggered Special, not an action or a deferred application under §6.12. It costs 3 Woe and must already be unlocked and usable. A phased boss's defeat-triggered unlock follows §7.1; final defeat cannot supply a missed unlock.

Trigger and participation. After the deciding volley and any Last Stand extension, determine the final outcome. When its side loses at 0 shared Disposition, a Guardian still able to participate may pay 3 Woe and detonate before permitted finishing procedures and compromise. Being Taken Out or otherwise unable prevents activation; shared Disposition reaching 0 does not by itself remove an individual. Exclude setup defeat, accepted concessions, mutual defeat and defeat solely because nobody can continue. Do not reopen an already settled outcome.

Detonation. Establish reach from the Guardian's position and the fiction. Assign one burned-3 additional compromise injury to each PC within reach; do not expand the target set to allies, bystanders or other NPCs. The detonation destroys the Guardian. It grants no action, volley or shared Disposition loss and cannot change the losing side into a winner. Last Stand and Fail-safe are separate purchases: pay 2 Woe and then 3 Woe at their respective triggers; no reserved or waived cost follows from the first purchase.

Assignment is not early harm. Record the blast injuries when the Guardian detonates. Do not impose those compromise statuses before a finishing procedure or use them to lower its Difficulty. Their status application occurs at compromise settlement, after the §6.12 applications below.

Additional injuries and credit. These explicit Special assignments are due even if the winner otherwise owes no injury or its ordinary compromise grade is None. They do not increase the ordinary grade or require unrelated injuries. Settle the assignments

alongside any ordinary compromise costs under Core Rules §10.13: credit each eligible existing injury at most once across the complete settlement, never once for Fail-safe and again for another injury cost. Apply eligible Resistance and reduction to imposed injuries normally. Agreed payments remain protected. Resistance removing an injury creates no replacement cost and does not cancel a separate consequence.

6.12 Deferred Special Injuries

Shock Field, Venom / Infection and any setting Special that explicitly refers to it use this procedure. Fail-safe instead uses §6.11; no other Special is brought into this procedure merely by similar wording.

Record each application. Each qualifying paid activation records one incoming application against the affected target: Special, target, status, tier and trigger order. Shock Field records jolted-2 when a PC loses a versus roll to the Guardian in melee, not only on Attack. Venom / Infection records poisoned-2 after a successful Attack; it does not require a versus win if the Attack resolves independently. Each Special retains its listed target restrictions. A tie or trumped no-roll action does not qualify. Each further application needs another qualifying trigger and another payment; there is no once-per-PC cap. This creates no new outside-conflict Shock Field procedure. Setting Specials retain their listed outside-conflict effects and immediate benefits; deferral applies only to the recorded status application.

Pending is not inflicted. A record is not an active status. It imposes no penalty, does not stack or cause tier-6 consequences, cannot be treated or healed yet, and changes neither Disposition nor participation when recorded.

Every outcome. Recorded applications remain due after victory, defeat, mutual defeat or accepted concession. Finalize the outcome after any Last Stand extension, resolve eligible Fail-safe activation and then any permitted finishing procedure before applying these records. Concession terms must acknowledge pending applications; they cannot waive them or convert them into unresistable agreed payments. These remain imposed Special effects.

Resolve individually. Before ordinary compromise's existing-injury credit or Fail-safe injury settlement, resolve records in trigger order. Apply eligible Resistance and harm reduction separately to each incoming application, then stack what remains normally. Do not combine records into a larger incoming status before Resistance. Resolve resulting tier-6, Scar, Dying or explicit creature-specific consequences normally. An application reduced to tier 0 creates no status or replacement cost.

No payment by an existing injury. Compromise credit cannot discharge a deferred application. Normal stacking with an existing matching status still applies. After all applications resolve, an injury actually remaining may satisfy one eligible ordinary compromise injury cost under Core Rules §10.13. Pending records alone supply no credit. Across Fail-safe and ordinary costs, each injury is credited only once (§6.11).

Binding outcome. These applications, Resistance costs and resulting status consequences do not restore Disposition, reopen the settled outcome or grant an action or volley. Clear each record after resolution. Then settle Fail-safe assignments and ordinary compromise where applicable; apply any agreed concession costs under their protected-payment rules. Recover each layer only through its own procedure.

7. Templates

Seven generic cards. Reskin freely. Ratings follow the Rank table.

RAIDER BAND — Threat 3

Human · Minion group (4 Bodies) · Shooter

Grit 3 · Guard +0 · Bodies 4 · Armour 0
Attack +4 · Defend +2 · Feint +0 · Maneuver +2 · Other +2
Harm: wounded (carbines)
Power: plenty of bullets, know the ground · Weakness: break and run
Kind: Morale. Role: Dead Aim.
Group trait: Volley (2): area Attack.
Tell: hats come off as rifles shoulder.
Wants: the strongbox, no heroics.

HOUND PACK — Threat 3

Beast · Minion group (5 Bodies) · Skirmisher

Grit 3 · Guard +0 · Bodies 5 · Armour 0
Attack +2 · Defend +2 · Feint — · Maneuver +4 · Other +2 (Notice +4)
Harm: wounded (bites)
Power: noses for blood, run as a pack · Weakness: fears fire
Kind: no Feint, Morale (scatter if the handler falls). Role: Hit and Run.
Group trait: Pack Tactics (0).
Tell: the circling tightens.
Wants: drive the prey toward the den.

KNIFE IN THE DARK — Threat 3

Human · Minor · Trickster

Grit 3 · Guard +0 · Shrugs 0 · Armour 0
Attack +3 · Defend +1 · Feint +5 · Maneuver +3 · Other +3 (Stealth +5)
Harm: wounded (paired knives)
Power: one with the shadows, a knife for every hand · Weakness: the oath before my life
Kind: Morale. Role: Ambush.
Specials: Dirty Trick (1).
Tell: the nearest lamp gutters.
Wants: no witnesses.

BOUNTY VETERAN — Threat 5

Human · Established · Brute

Grit 5 · Guard +1 · Shrugs 1 · Armour 1 (oilskin and mail)
Attack +6 · Defend +4 · Feint +2 · Maneuver +4 · Other +4
Harm: wounded (silver-and-wood shotgun), +1 tier from Heavy Hitter
Power: silver-and-wood shot, twenty years of hunts, a veteran hunter's reputation · Weakness: greedy for the bounty
Kind: Morale; can be bargained with. Role: Heavy Hitter.
Specials: Last Stand (2), Call for Help (1 per minion: two hired guns).
Tell: he thumbs back both hammers.
Wants: the bounty, and the credit.

HEDGE ADEPT — Threat 5

Human · Established · Controller

Grit 5 · Guard +1 · Shrugs 1 · Armour 0
Attack +2 · Defend +4 · Feint +4 · Maneuver +6 · Other +4 (Lore +6)
Harm: wounded or shaken (rite)
Power: binding rites, a ledger of debts, hands that never shake, sees in the dark · Weakness: proud beyond reason
Kind: Morale. Role: Shape the Ground.
Specials: Dirty Trick (1), Hostage (2).
Tell: he straightens his cuffs.
Wants: finish the rite before dawn.

GATE WARDEN — Threat 5

Guardian · Established · Bulwark

Grit 5 · Guard +1 · Shrugs 1 · Armour 1
Attack +4 · Defend +6 · Feint +2 · Maneuver +4 · Other +4 (Science +6)
Harm: wounded (shock-baton)
Power: old-world steel, knows every corridor, obeys the bloodline · Weakness: answers to the old codes
Kind: Unfeeling, Protocol, Machine. Role: Interpose.
Specials: Self-Repair (1), Lockdown (2).
Tell: "Please remain where you are."
Wants: guests kept safe, intruders out.

THE IRON MARSHAL — Threat 8

Human · Great · Leader · Boss

Grit 8 · Guard +2 · Shrugs 2 · Armour 1 (house mail)
Attack +5 · Defend +8 · Feint +3 · Maneuver +5 · Other +5
Harm: wounded (old-world sabre)
Power: remembers the founding, a hundred sworn swords, the house is armed, never loses a flank · Weakness: proud beyond reason, believes the old stories
Kind: Morale (Fanatic in her presence). Role: Command.
Specials: Call for Help (1 per minion / 3), Hostage (2), Last Stand (2).
Tell: she sets down her glass.
Wants: the intruders alive, kneeling and useful.

7.1 Boss Phases

Approved procedure; balance unvalidated. Boss Phases change a designated adversary's available options and ratings as its side loses ground. They use shared Disposition, never a personal Grit track. Phase activation costs no Woe; using a Special or calling reinforcements still requires its listed cost and procedure.

Eligibility and Fixed Designation

When preparing an adversary, the GM may mark a Great or Paramount adversary as a Phased Boss. Rank and the Leader role do not grant phases automatically. Before calculating starting Disposition, designate at most one eligible phased boss per side and record the designation on its card or conflict record. A side may have none. Do not add, transfer or replace a designation after setup, including through reinforcement arrival or removal.

Minion groups, Minor and Established adversaries require an explicit eligibility exception. A full-PC rival requires an explicit phase-capable entry; fictional importance alone does not qualify it. Other adversaries retain their own ratings, Role traits and Specials but gain no phase benefit unless expressly included. Do not split a coordinated side merely to obtain more phase systems; separate sides need genuinely distinct objectives and independent participation.

Designation alone adds no Grit, starting Disposition, Threat, Woe, turn, script change, reinforcement or unlisted Special, and grants no immunity to defeat or finishing procedures. Encounter cost and phase bonuses still require playtesting.

Setup and Fixed Thresholds

If setup ends in overwhelming preparation or simultaneous setup defeat, activate no phases. Otherwise record the boss side's adjusted starting Disposition after all modifiers and Superiority as the phase reference. Record Half as half that value rounded down, and Desperate as one third rounded down. There is no minimum threshold.

The reference and thresholds stay fixed for this conflict. Recovery, reinforcements, removal and lawful return do not recalculate them. Changing location, tactics or conflict type in the same unresolved struggle does not reset them.

A reference of 1 gives thresholds 0 and 0; a reference of 2 gives 1 and 0; a reference of 3 gives 1 and 1. A threshold at 0 normally cannot activate before defeat. If both thresholds are met at one eligible check, record Half first, then Desperate, with no intervening action window. Phase designation does not guarantee that every phase occurs.

Special Ownership, Availability and Revelation

Owned means listed on the card. Available means its phase and other prerequisites permit use. Revealed means the players have learned about it. A Tell, observation or information effect can reveal a locked Special without unlocking it.

The following restrictions apply to the designated phased boss, not automatically to every adversary on its side or to ordinary non-phased adversaries.

Ordinary activated Specials are phase-locked. Record each one's Start or Half assignment before calculating starting Disposition; assignments stay fixed, regardless of setup results, scripts or changing circumstances.

Ordinary Specials	Start	New at Half
1	1	0
2	1	1
3	1	2
4	2	2

The table counts ordinary activated Specials only. Passive and defeat-triggered Specials use the separate schedule below. All count toward the card's normal Special limit unless an existing rule expressly excludes them; phase eligibility adds no slots. All table-allocated ordinary Specials are unlocked after Half. Desperate grants no additional Special unlock.

- Start: Start-assigned ordinary Specials are available when the conflict proceeds beyond setup. Passive Specials operate from Start under their own listed conditions.
- Half: Half-assigned ordinary Specials unlock; defeat-triggered Specials unlock and are revealed. They become usable from the next volley, including a later volley in the same exchange. After volley 3, that means the next exchange's first volley.
- Missed defeat triggers: a defeat-triggered Special cannot trigger before it is unlocked and usable, including on a defeat during the volley that would otherwise qualify for Half. Do not unlock after the conflict ends or claim a passed trigger retroactively.

Unlocking or revelation is not activation. Normal trigger, action requirement, declaration timing, Woe cost, targets, fictional permission and participation restrictions remain. The committed action must still permit use. There is no extra turn, free script change, actor reassignment or automatic permission to act while Taken Out.

Half unlocks an owned reinforcement option only; it grants no new Special, automatic arrival, free cost or alternative arrival procedure. Apply §6.5 for Disposition accounting. Availability does not activate a Special or bypass its procedure: Last Stand uses §6.10, Fail-safe uses §6.11, and deferred Specials use §6.12 when their entries explicitly refer to it.

Phase Checks and Benefit Timing

Complete the volley's actions, including independent actions and any expressly permitted effects that must resolve before victory. Then determine removal, victory or mutual defeat. Only if the conflict continues and the designated boss remains able to participate, compare current shared Disposition with each unactivated threshold. Activate every eligible phase whose threshold is met.

Use the final total at that check, not the lowest total reached during the volley. Crossing a threshold and recovering above it before the check grants no activation or pending entitlement. Once activated, a phase does not reverse or activate again through recovery or reinforcements.

Record activation at the check. Newly activated rating changes and other phase benefits apply from the next volley, never retroactively. They may modify an already committed action's later roll but do not change its category or assigned actor. If both phases activate together, their benefits begin together next volley.

Phase	Benefit
Opening	Role trait, passive Specials and Start-assigned ordinary Specials operate under their own conditions. Show a clear Tell.
Half	Unlock the assigned ordinary and defeat-triggered Specials under the schedule above. Owned reinforcement options retain normal costs and timing. Grant no duplicate Command bonus.
Desperate	The recorded Best action category gains +2 to its rating. Defend uses the card's Weak rating as its base. Show a desperate tactic, offer a deal or reveal an exit; no extra negotiated benefit follows automatically.

Desperate Rating Precedence

Before scripting the first exchange, record the boss's Best action category for Desperate. While its phase benefits are active, replace Defend's base rating with the card's Weak rating first, then apply eligible modifiers. If Defend is the recorded Best action, use Weak +2. For example, a boss with Best Defend +8 and Weak +3 uses Defend +5 in Desperate, before other eligible modifiers.

The +2 stays attached to the recorded category. A later ability changing ratings does not move it unless it expressly changes the phase designation. These changes affect the designated boss only and grant no additional Power, automatic success, harmful-status permission or action.

Participation, Suspension and Lawful Return

Check phases only while the designated boss remains able to participate. When it becomes unable to participate, keep its designation, reference, thresholds, phase markers and unlock history. Activate no new phase during its absence and transfer none of its designation to another adversary.

Phase-derived rating benefits are suspended while it cannot participate. Unlocks are not erased but grant no permission to act, activate a Special or return while Taken Out. If another rule legally returns it to the same unresolved conflict, previously activated phase benefits resume from the next volley. Do not reset setup, rotation, used abilities or phase triggers.

At the next normal end-of-volley check for which the boss is eligible, test unactivated thresholds against the current total. Do not reconstruct threshold crossings during its absence. A return after the conflict ends cannot reopen it or activate a phase retroactively.

Command applies only while its Leader remains able to participate; phases neither restore nor duplicate it. Passive Specials follow their own conditions: Start availability does not make them dependent on a Half/Desperate rating benefit or override their participation restrictions. A Special expressly allowed to trigger while its owner is unavailable uses that permission only if already unlocked and usable; any Last Stand or Fail-safe use must still meet §§6.10–6.11.

Recovery and Outcome References

Starting Disposition remains the normal recovery cap and compromise reference; reinforcements increase current Disposition only (§6.5; Core Rules §10.9, §10.13). No phase refreshes either value or creates a new conflict. Apply §§6.10–6.12 for defeat-triggered Specials and deferred injuries; phase availability grants no further exception. Numerical calibration, rendered layout and encounter balance remain unvalidated.

7.2 Example Exchange

Party of three. Opposition: Bounty Veteran (5), Knife in the Dark (3) and a Hound Pack (3), Threat 11. This matches the legacy P = 11 budget for three PCs, not a guaranteed Standard matchup under current setup. In this example the PCs have noticed the Knife, so Ambush does not apply; there are no other setup modifiers or Superiority. The opposition records starting shared Disposition 11. Its Woe pool is 6.

Before any reveal, the party commits Attack, Defend, Defend, assigned to three eligible PCs in rotation. The opposition commits Pack Maneuver, Knife Feint, Veteran Attack in that order.

- Volley 1: Attack versus Maneuver is versus. The Pack spends 1 Woe on a bonus die and wins by 4, generating 2 Power. It buys Impede (1) and Gain Position (1). Hit and Run also removes 1 shared PC Disposition. Impede applies to the party's next scripted action, not necessarily the PC who just acted. Telegraph the Knife's next action with the guttering lamp.
- Volley 2: the Knife's Feint resolves independently; the party's Defend is trumped and makes no roll. The pending Impede expires unused on that no-roll action. Gain Position supplies the Knife one bonus die, within the normal cap. Its successful Feint removes committed Power + 1 shared Disposition, without an automatic wound. Telegraph the Veteran thumbing back both hammers.
- Before volley 3 is revealed, the players may spend 2 Momentum to change their unrevealed action while retaining its assigned actor. The GM may likewise pay 3 Woe to change the opposition's unrevealed action, not react to a revealed result. If neither changes, the Veteran's Attack opposes the final PC's Defend. On the Veteran's first successful Attack this exchange, Heavy Hitter grants +1 Power.
- If a status or explicit effect Takes Out the Pack, remove it from participation without subtracting its 3 Grit from shared Disposition; ordinary loss does not individually remove it. Complete any independently resolving actions before checking victory. A concession near one third of starting Disposition is optional tactical advice, not an automatic defeat trigger.

8. Quick Checklist

- Intent, stakes and exits set before any roll.
- Budget calibration flagged; mix at least two Roles.
- Flat setup modifiers counted before Superiority; both adjusted totals checked for setup defeat; original starts recorded.
- Any phased boss and fixed Special assignments recorded before setup; fixed thresholds and Best category recorded before scripting.
- Three actions and eligible actors committed before reveal; continuous rotation tracked.
- One Tell per adversary, shown before its Best action.
- Woe tracked; costs paid without overrun.
- Ordinary Disposition loss kept separate from statuses, pools and Bodies.
- Independent actions finished before victory; only continuing conflicts with an eligible boss check phases; benefits begin next volley.
- Last Stand: eligible unlocked bearer, 2 Woe, one final volley per side per conflict; pending defeat cannot be recovered.
- Final outcome, eligible Fail-safe activation, finishing procedure, deferred applications, then injury credit and settlement.
- Fail-safe: active eligible Guardian, 3 Woe, established PC blast reach; no mutual-defeat or concession trigger.
- Deferred Specials: each paid record resolved individually in trigger order after every outcome; imposed injuries remain Resistable.
- Finishing procedures before compromise; reinforcement Grit changes current Disposition, not original start or recovery cap.
- Concessions negotiated before the next roll; compromise settled as one package.

CHAPTER V

Generic Descriptors

Twenty-four setting-neutral adjectives open the sentence: "I am a [Descriptor]..." Six belong to each pool. Each one gives +2 to that pool, a power tag, a weakness tag and a suggested Instinct. Setting books add Descriptors written for their worlds.

The adjective of the character sentence.

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1. Descriptor Rules

Each Descriptor gives (Core Rules §3.1):

Element	Detail
Pool bonus	+2 to one pool
Power tag	1
Weakness tag	1 (can be compelled for Tychē Points)
Suggested Instinct	Use it or write your own

Each entry also has a hook: one question to answer at character creation. The answer often becomes your first Belief or a relationship. Every Descriptor works in any genre. Choose one from this chapter or, when playing in a setting, from that setting book's Descriptors.

2. Quick Reference

#	Descriptor	Pool	Power tag	Weakness tag
1	Burly	Sōma	*built like a door*	*too big to hide*
2	Charismatic	Pneuma	*the room turns to me*	*needs to be liked*
3	Compassionate	Pneuma	*a kind word opens doors*	*can't turn away suffering*
4	Cunning	Psychē	*three moves ahead*	*trusts no one's plan but mine*
5	Curious	Psychē	*has to know why*	*pokes at what's best left alone*
6	Furtive	Mētis	*keeps to the edges*	*uneasy in the open*
7	Hardy	Sōma	*shrugs off the cold*	*ignores my own injuries*
8	Haunted	Pneuma	*has seen the dark*	*the past won't stay buried*
9	Light-Fingered	Mētis	*quick hands*	*can't resist a pocket*
10	Loyal	Pneuma	*stands by my own*	*blind to my friends' faults*
11	Methodical	Psychē	*measures twice*	*slow under pressure*
12	Nimble	Mētis	*light on my feet*	*too quick to trust my footing*
13	Observant	Psychē	*misses nothing*	*distracted by detail*
14	Reckless	Sōma	*charges in first*	*never looks before leaping*
15	Relentless	Sōma	*never stops coming*	*doesn't know when to quit*
16	Resolute	Pneuma	*iron will*	*rigid when plans change*
17	Restless	Mētis	*can't sit still*	*poor at waiting*
18	Scholarly	Psychē	*well read*	*lives in books, not boots*
19	Serene	Pneuma	*calm in the storm*	*slow to anger, slower to act*
20	Sly	Mētis	*always an angle*	*nobody takes my word*
21	Steady	Mētis	*hands like stone*	*slow to start*
22	Stubborn	Sōma	*will not be moved*	*can't admit I'm wrong*
23	Suspicious	Psychē	*notices what's off*	*sees enemies everywhere*
24	Weathered	Sōma	*seen worse than this*	*old wounds ache*

3. Descriptors

1. Burly

> *You fill doorways. People step aside before you ask.*

- Pool: +2 Sōma
- Power tag: *built like a door*
- Weakness tag: *too big to hide*
- Suggested Instinct: "If something is heavy, I pick it up myself."
- Hook: What did you carry, haul or break before this life began?

2. Charismatic

> *When you speak, people stop and listen, whether they want to or not.*

- Pool: +2 Pneuma
- Power tag: *the room turns to me*
- Weakness tag: *needs to be liked*
- Suggested Instinct: "If a crowd gathers, I take the stage."
- Hook: Who once followed you, and where did you lead them?

3. Compassionate

> *You have never walked past someone in pain. You have paid for that more than once.*

- Pool: +2 Pneuma
- Power tag: *a kind word opens doors*
- Weakness tag: *can't turn away suffering*
- Suggested Instinct: "If someone is hurting, I stop to help."
- Hook: Whose suffering did you fail to ease, and does it still weigh on you?

4. Cunning

> *You see the board, the pieces and the hand moving them.*

- Pool: +2 Psychē
- Power tag: *three moves ahead*
- Weakness tag: *trusts no one's plan but mine*
- Suggested Instinct: "If someone offers a deal, I look for the catch."
- Hook: Whose plan did you once see through, and what did it cost them?

5. Curious

> *A locked door is a question. You've never been good at leaving questions alone.*

- Pool: +2 Psychē
- Power tag: *has to know why*
- Weakness tag: *pokes at what's best left alone*
- Suggested Instinct: "If something is hidden, I look inside."
- Hook: What secret did you uncover that you wish you hadn't?

6. Furtive

> *You keep to walls and corners. Being noticed has never gone well for you.*

- Pool: +2 Mētis
- Power tag: *keeps to the edges*
- Weakness tag: *uneasy in the open*
- Suggested Instinct: "If I enter a room, I check the shadows first."
- Hook: Who are you keeping out of sight of, and why?

7. Hardy

> *Cold, hunger and pain are old companions. You've learned to walk on with them.*

- Pool: +2 Sōma
- Power tag: *shrugs off the cold*
- Weakness tag: *ignores my own injuries*
- Suggested Instinct: "If I'm hurt, I keep going until the job is done."
- Hook: What hardship did you survive that killed others?

8. Haunted

> *Something from your past follows you. Some nights you can almost hear it.*

- Pool: +2 Pneuma
- Power tag: *has seen the dark*
- Weakness tag: *the past won't stay buried*
- Suggested Instinct: "If I'm alone at night, I keep a light on."
- Hook: What did you see that you can never forget?

9. Light-Fingered

> *Things find their way into your hands. You rarely remember deciding to take them.*

- Pool: +2 Mētis
- Power tag: *quick hands*
- Weakness tag: *can't resist a pocket*
- Suggested Instinct: "If something valuable is left unattended, I take it."

- Hook: What is the one thing you stole that you can never give back?

10. Loyal

> *You chose your people. Nothing will make you abandon them.*

- Pool: +2 Pneuma
- Power tag: *stands by my own*
- Weakness tag: *blind to my friends' faults*
- Suggested Instinct: "If someone I trust is threatened, I step between them and it."
- Hook: Who did you swear to stand by, and have they earned it?

11. Methodical

> *Haste makes mistakes. You check everything twice and trust your notes.*

- Pool: +2 Psychē
- Power tag: *measures twice*
- Weakness tag: *slow under pressure*
- Suggested Instinct: "If I'm unsure, I make a list."
- Hook: What disaster taught you never to skip a step?

12. Nimble

> *You move like water, over walls and through gaps others never see.*

- Pool: +2 Mētis
- Power tag: *light on my feet*
- Weakness tag: *too quick to trust my footing*
- Suggested Instinct: "If the ground gives way, I move before I think."
- Hook: What did you learn to escape from, and who taught you?

13. Observant

> *You notice the scuffed boot, the nervous glance, the window left open.*

- Pool: +2 Psychē
- Power tag: *misses nothing*
- Weakness tag: *distracted by detail*
- Suggested Instinct: "If I enter a place, I count the exits and the people."
- Hook: What small detail once saved your life?

14. Reckless

> *Thinking is for later. Right now, something needs doing.*

- Pool: +2 Sōma
- Power tag: *charges in first*
- Weakness tag: *never looks before leaping*
- Suggested Instinct: "If there's danger ahead, I go at it head-on."
- Hook: Who got hurt the last time you charged in?

15. Relentless

> *You don't stop. Not when you're tired, not when you're hurt, not when it's hopeless.*

- Pool: +2 Sōma
- Power tag: *never stops coming*
- Weakness tag: *doesn't know when to quit*
- Suggested Instinct: "If I start a chase, I finish it."
- Hook: What did you chase and never catch?

16. Resolute

> *Your word is iron. Once you decide, the world bends or breaks against you.*

- Pool: +2 Pneuma
- Power tag: *iron will*
- Weakness tag: *rigid when plans change*
- Suggested Instinct: "If I give my word, I keep it."
- Hook: What promise are you still keeping, and to whom?

17. Restless

> *Stillness itches. You need to move, act, see what is over the next hill.*

- Pool: +2 Mētis
- Power tag: *can't sit still*
- Weakness tag: *poor at waiting*
- Suggested Instinct: "If things go quiet, I go looking for trouble."
- Hook: What place could never hold you, and who did you leave there?

18. Scholarly

> *You have read more than most people will ever hear spoken.*

- Pool: +2 Psychē
- Power tag: *well read*
- Weakness tag: *lives in books, not boots*
- Suggested Instinct: "If a problem is new, I look for precedent."
- Hook: Which book or teacher shaped you, and what did it leave unanswered?

19. Serene

> *Storms rage around you. Inside, you are still water.*

- Pool: +2 Pneuma
- Power tag: *calm in the storm*
- Weakness tag: *slow to anger, slower to act*
- Suggested Instinct: "If panic spreads, I stay still and speak softly."
- Hook: What taught you peace, and what would shatter it?

20. Sly

> *There is always another way in, another word to say, another deal to make.*

- Pool: +2 Mētis
- Power tag: *always an angle*
- Weakness tag: *nobody takes my word*
- Suggested Instinct: "If there's a shortcut, I find it."
- Hook: Who did you outwit, and are they still looking for you?

21. Steady

> *Your hands don't shake. When everyone else panics, you are the one who aims.*

- Pool: +2 Mētis
- Power tag: *hands like stone*
- Weakness tag: *slow to start*
- Suggested Instinct: "If the moment is tense, I breathe and take my time."
- Hook: When did your steadiness matter most, and who was counting on you?

22. Stubborn

> *You've been told no all your life. You've ignored it all your life.*

- Pool: +2 Sōma
- Power tag: *will not be moved*
- Weakness tag: *can't admit I'm wrong*
- Suggested Instinct: "If someone tells me to stop, I dig in."
- Hook: What did everyone say was impossible that you did anyway?

23. Suspicious

> *Everyone wants something. You just haven't worked out what yet.*

- Pool: +2 Psychē
- Power tag: *notices what's off*
- Weakness tag: *sees enemies everywhere*
- Suggested Instinct: "If a stranger is too friendly, I watch their hands."
- Hook: Who betrayed you, and how did you not see it coming?

24. Weathered

> *Wind, sun and years have worn you down to something hard and lasting.*

- Pool: +2 Sōma
- Power tag: *seen worse than this*
- Weakness tag: *old wounds ache*
- Suggested Instinct: "If conditions turn harsh, I take the worst of it first."
- Hook: Where did you earn your scars, and who was with you?

CHAPTER VI

Generic Playbooks

The six genre-neutral playbooks: Bellator, Furcifer, Savant, Interlocutor, Explorator and Adept. Each has eight special abilities, a capstone and starting equipment for three genres. Setting books can reskin these six or add new ones.

The noun of the character sentence.

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1. Playbook Rules

1.1 What a Playbook Gives You

Element	Detail
Base pools	Sōma / Mētis / Psychē / Pneuma, totalling 36. Add 4 points of your choice and +2 from your Descriptor
Edge	3 points: the fixed Edge listed, plus 1 point from the listed choices
Anchor skill	Must be rated +3 or +4 in your pyramid
Suggested skills	A recommended pyramid; change it freely
Playbook tags	Choose 2 power tags from the playbook's list
XP trigger	One playbook behaviour that earns XP (Core Rules §12.1)
Special abilities	1 free at creation; up to 2 more at creation for 1 Refresh each, plus any ★ Major cost (2 Refresh total for a ★ creation extra)
Starting equipment	Signature items (choose 1 of 2), playbook kit, and always-carried items
BIG examples	Sample Beliefs, Goals, and Instincts
Relationships	1 ally and 1 rival from the playbook's list

1.2 Ability Notation

- ★ Major — costs 1 Refresh whenever you take it (creation or advancement). If taken as one of the up to two creation extras, add the extra ability's 1-Refresh price: 2 Refresh total, not 3. A non-veteran Major taken through advancement costs 1 Refresh; veteran costs below remain additional.
- ◆ Capstone — unlocked after 12 Advances if you have at least 4 abilities from this playbook. Costs no Refresh. One capstone per character.
- Veteran abilities: after 6 Advances, you may take an ability from another playbook as an Advance. It costs 1 Refresh in addition to any ★ cost.

Conflict notation. Free waives only the listed resource cost; it grants no additional scripted turn or rotation bypass. Automatic success replaces the roll for an otherwise permitted action under Core Rules §10.5. Additional Power, Disposition loss and status tiers are separate benefits (§10.6). An accepted payment cannot be prevented, redirected or Resisted through generic consequence-cancellation wording (§10.7).

1.3 Rules References Used in Abilities

Term	Meaning (core section)
Power	Successes generated by a roll; spent on Effects (§2.5, §5)
Effort	Spend 3 − Edge from a pool for a bonus die (before rolling) or +1 Power (after a success) (§2.4)
Resist	Roll 2 + Edge d12 and pay pool points by the highest die (no Edge reduction); at Edge −2 or lower, roll |Edge| dice and keep the lowest. Reduce a status by 2 tiers (§6)
Status	Tiered condition 1–6; tier 6 applies its scope and breaking-point rule, subject to explicit setting exceptions (§5.1, §6.3)
Truth	Scene, site, region, or campaign tag that shifts Difficulty by ±3 (§8)
Disposition	One shared total per side measuring its ability to pursue this conflict's objective, not individual health (§10.9)
Injury trade	Once per character per conflict, accept a tier-2/3/4 injury to cancel 1/2/3 Disposition loss; at most one participant trades per Attack or Feint (§10.11)
Dying	Life-threatening tier-6 physical harm with lethal stakes: 3-segment clock; Medicine vs. Hard 18 stabilises (§6.7)
Checks / Grind	Players' Turn currency and the hardship clock (Module B)

2. Equipment Rules

2.1 Load (Blades in the Dark)

Before a mission, choose your load. During play, declare items from your playbook kit as you need them and mark their load.

Load	Capacity	Effect
Light	3	You blend in; nothing obvious marks you as armed or burdened
Normal	5	You look ready for trouble
Heavy	7	You're *encumbered*: Mētis Effort costs +1 and Stealth Difficulty is one step higher

- Signature items are chosen at creation and always count against load when carried (most are 1–2).
- Always-carried items (load 0) are always on you.
- Items marked (0) cost no load.

2.2 Gear as Tags

- Every item is a power tag when it's relevant, e.g. *crowbar* helps Athletics to force a door. Item tags count toward the +2 tag cap.
- Weapons also give one or more conflict action tags (Core Rules §10.10), e.g. *+1 Attack*. Do not count an item's general tag and action tag twice for the same benefit on one roll.
- Quality: a fine or advanced item gives one extra benefit listed in its entry (it doesn't raise the cap). Distinctive conflict qualities are explicitly written benefits, not automatic additional tags. If the optional qualities in Core Rules §10.10 are used, record the applicable quality once; do not duplicate the same benefit under both the generic weapon and its specific item entry. Specific item entries govern their expressly stated benefits.
- Escalation: some items carry the *Escalation* tag (Core Rules §9.3). Carried openly into a scene, each gives the GM 1 Woe.

Declare active conflict equipment before scripting each exchange. Switching does not refresh a once-per-conflict quality, restore lost gear, erase an established drawback or change an assigned script for free (§10.10). Gear narration alone grants no status on ordinary conflict Attacks.

2.3 Armour and Shields

Item	Load	Effect
Light armour	1	*Armour 1*: when you Resist physical harm, reduce it by 1 extra tier
Heavy armour	2	*Armour 2*: reduce by 2 extra tiers; Mētis Effort +1 while worn
Shield / riot shield / energy barrier	1	*+1 Defend* in Fight conflicts; counts as cover outside conflicts

Armour that absorbs a tier-4+ hit is *damaged* (−1 Armour) until repaired during downtime. Armour never reduces ordinary Disposition loss, an injury you accepted as payment, a running-dry status, an agreed concession cost or another protected payment (Core Rules §6, §10.7). A shield's Defend tag or optional recovery quality does not change this separation.

2.4 Common Gear (any playbook)

Load	Fantasy	Modern	Sci-Fi
(0)	Belt knife, flint & steel, coin purse	Phone, wallet, keys, pocketknife	Comm unit, credchip, multitool
1	Rope (15 m), lantern & oil, trail rations (2 days)	Flashlight, first-aid kit, water & snacks	Glow rod, medpatch ×2, ration bars
1	Bedroll & blanket	Duffel with spare clothes	Thermal sheet & sleep sack
1	Crowbar or pry bar	Crowbar or bolt cutters	Hydraulic pry tool
2	Tent or tarp	Tent or camping kit	Pop-up shelter

3. Bellator

> *Muscle, grit, and a willingness to stand in front of trouble. Soldiers, brawlers, bouncers, gladiators, mercenaries, security officers.*

Base pools (Sōm / Mēt / Psy / Pne)	12 / 10 / 6 / 8
Edge	Sōma 2, plus 1 in Mētis or Pneuma
Anchor skill	Fight or Brawl
Suggested skills	+4 Fight · +3 Athletics, Endure · +2 Brawl, Intimidate, Shoot · +1 Notice, Will, Survival, Medicine
XP trigger	Address a challenge with force or threats

Playbook tags (choose 2): *built like a wall · veteran of the line · scarred and unbothered · iron grip · knows how a fight will go · the look that stops trouble*



3.1 Special Abilities

#	Ability	Effect
1	Juggernaut	When you Resist physical harm with Sōma, reduce the status by 3 tiers instead of 2.
2	Brutal	Once per roll, when you spend Power on a successful Attack with Fight or Brawl, remove 1 additional Disposition if applying ordinary conflict Attack Disposition loss. When the Attack instead inflicts a harmful status, increase that status by 1 tier for free. If an explicit effect inflicts both, choose one component for this bonus, never both. This adds no status to an ordinary conflict Attack and does not improve a creature-specific finishing procedure.
3	Bodyguard	When an ally within reach would suffer an imposed consequence you can fictionally intercept, you may take it instead. Declare this before their Resistance or harm reduction, and use your own eligible reduction instead. If you Resist it, your Edge counts as 1 higher for that roll. You cannot redirect shared Disposition loss, injury-trade payments, running-dry statuses, agreed concession costs or other accepted payments. You cannot shield an ally from an area effect that already affects both of you.
4	Cleave	When you attack a group or minions, you get one free Extra Feat per roll (hit a second target, break their line, and so on). Free waives its Power cost; it grants no additional scripted action and cannot bypass the action interaction or declared stakes.
5	Menacing	You may use Sōma for Intimidate Effort and Resistance. When you succeed on Intimidate against minions, spend 1 Momentum to make them flee, surrender, or freeze.
6	Pain Tolerance	Ignore the roll penalty from harmful physical statuses of tier 1–2. At tier 3+, the penalty is reduced by 1. This changes only the applicable roll penalty, not the recorded tier, stacking, recovery or fictional restrictions. It does not prevent an injury payment, Taken Out, Dying or a Scar under their normal rules.
7	★ Berserker	Once per scene, enter a fury: you get +1 bonus die (free) on Fight, Brawl, and Athletics rolls for the rest of the scene. You can't script Defend or retreat. At scene end, lose 2 Sōma or take *Weary*. The chosen cost is an accepted payment and cannot be prevented, redirected or Resisted; the pool cost must be paid in full.
8	★ Unstoppable	Once per scene, when an imposed harmful physical status reaches tier 6 on you, record it and any Scar normally, but delay being Taken Out by that status until the scene ends. During that time, you may continue acting despite the collapse or incapacitation caused by that status. Its normal roll penalty still applies. This does not restore a lost body part, supply an impossible means of acting, or protect you from other statuses. At scene end, apply its Taken Out result unless the status has been reduced below tier 6 through an appropriate treatment or explicit ability. Dying and other lethal consequences continue normally; this ability does not postpone death, prevent shared-Disposition defeat or affect accepted payments.
◆	Legend of the Field	Your reputation is a Campaign Truth (*"Everyone knows [name]"*). In Fight conflicts, enemy Disposition starts −2, and the GM pays +1 Woe for reinforcements while you stand. The −2 is a flat starting-Disposition modifier: apply it at full value with other flat modifiers, before the minimum of 1 and opposing Superiority (Core Rules §10.2–10.3). It is not additional Superiority or loss inflicted during an exchange.

3.2 Starting Equipment

Signature weapon (choose 1)

Genre	Option A	Option B
Fantasy	Greataxe or warhammer (2) — *+1 Attack*, *crushing blows*	Longsword & shield (2) — *+1 Attack*, *+1 Defend*
Modern	Combat shotgun (2) — *+1 Attack*, *room-clearer*	Baseball bat & pistol (2) — *+1 Attack* (bat), *sidearm*
Sci-Fi	Shock maul (2) — *+1 Attack*, *stuns on hit* (spend 1 Power: add *dazed-1*)	Vibro-blade & energy barrier (2) — *+1 Attack*, *+1 Defend*

Playbook kit (declare during play)

Load	Fantasy	Modern	Sci-Fi
1	Mail shirt (light armour)	Tactical vest (light armour)	Ballistic weave (light armour)
2	Plate harness (heavy armour)	Riot gear (heavy armour)	Combat exo-plate (heavy armour)
1	Throwing axes ×3 — *+1 Attack* (range)	Collapsible baton — *+1 Attack*	Concussion grenades ×2 — *+1 Maneuver*
1	Manacles & chain	Zip-cuffs & pepper spray	Mag-cuffs & stun prod
1	Whetstone & armourer's kit	Gun-cleaning kit & spare mags	Field repair kit
1	Flask of strong drink	Energy drinks & painkillers	Stim-shot (restore 2 Sōma, once)

Always carried (0): Fantasy: knuckle-wraps, battle trophy. Modern: brass knuckles, gym bag. Sci-Fi: reinforced gloves, unit insignia.

3.3 BIG Examples

- Belief: "Strength is only worth something when it protects the weak." / "Every fight I walk away from comes back worse."
- Goal: "Get the merchant to the city gates alive." / "Find out who hired the thugs."
- Instinct: "Always stand between my friends and the door." / "Never let an insult pass in public."

Relationships: Ally — an old comrade-in-arms, a trainer, a medic who's patched you up too often. Rival — the one who beat you once, a former commander, a rival enforcer.

4. Furcifer

> *Quiet, precise, and always three exits ahead. Thieves, spies, scouts, assassins, infiltrators, saboteurs.*

Base pools (Sōm / Mēt / Psy / Pne)	8 / 12 / 8 / 8
Edge	Mētis 2, plus 1 in Psychē or Sōma
Anchor skill	Stealth
Suggested skills	+4 Stealth · +3 Notice, Craft · +2 Athletics, Deceive, Shoot · +1 Fight, Tech, Investigate, Drive/Pilot
XP trigger	Address a challenge with stealth or precision

Playbook tags (choose 2): *light on my feet · eyes in the back of my head · steady hands · knows the underworld · forgettable face · patient as a stone*



4.1 Special Abilities

Shared Opening: Unaware or Impeded

For Opportunist and Deadly Precision, choose an individual opponent against whom your declared approach materially benefits from an opening. They qualify if unaware of your presence, or if they are the participant whose action will receive pending Impede in the current volley (Core Rules §10.6).

Concealing hostile intent or the particular tactic does not by itself make you unnoticed. An opponent fighting your visible allies may still be unaware of you. An ongoing harmful status does not substitute for Impede, and an unrelated participant cannot supply eligibility. These abilities grant no inspection of the opposing script.

Check once after revealing actions and assigned actors and describing approaches, before either action rolls or resolves. A trumped opposing action does not qualify through Impede; unawareness may still qualify. For independent actions, eligibility established at this check lasts through the volley's resolution even when Impede expires during the opposing roll. Neither ability consumes or extends Impede. Meeting both triggers qualifies only once.

Outside scripted conflicts, check unawareness immediately before the roll or automatic resolution; Impede qualifies only where its conflict procedure exists. Resolve whether your action reveals your presence from what actually happens. Exposure may reveal you, but an indirect or concealed action need not do so without a fictional reason.

#	Ability	Effect
1	Ghost	When you spend Effort on a Stealth roll, your first use of Effort costs 0 pool points. Once per scene, when spotted, spend 1 Momentum to declare you were never seen; you're in a nearby hidden position. Declare this when the spotting is established, before resolving consequences from being spotted. It does not undo resolved actions, Disposition loss, injuries or a settled defeat, and does not cancel an independently resolving action.
2	Opportunist	When your otherwise permitted action against an individual opponent meets the shared opening requirements, gain +1 Power on a success, once per action. This is not limited to Attack. It includes independent Success at a Cost and an otherwise permitted automatic success with listed Power, but not a losing, tied or trumped action. Spend the additional Power only on Effects otherwise permitted for that action and supported by the qualifying approach (Core Rules §10.6). Multiple targets or openings do not multiply the bonus.
3	Light Fingers	When you succeed on a theft, plant, or sabotage roll (Stealth or Craft), gain a free Extra Feat. Free waives the Power cost; it grants no additional scripted action and cannot bypass the interaction or declared stakes.
4	Infiltrator	Once per roll, ignore one Truth that would raise the Difficulty of sneaking, climbing, or bypassing security.
5	Quick Reflexes	Outside scripted conflicts, you always act first when violence breaks out. In conflicts, changing one of your unrevealed scripted actions costs 1 Momentum instead of 2, at the normal script-change timing. It grants no extra opening action, initiative cancellation or free actor reassignment.

#	Ability	Effect
6	Escape Artist	When you Resist capture, restraint, falls, or traps with Mētis, the cost is 0 on a highest die of 5+. This does not permit Resistance against shared Disposition loss, accepted payments or a settled conflict outcome.
7	★ Flashback	Once per mission, declare a flashback to something you prepared earlier. Pay Momentum by plausibility: 0 (obvious), 1 (reasonable), 2 (a stretch), 3 (wild). Then roll as normal; on a success, it happened. A flashback cannot contradict resolved events, reverse paid costs or outcomes, or retroactively recalculate Superiority after conflict setup.
8	★ Deadly Precision	When your Attack against an individual opponent meets the shared opening requirements, choose one benefit. If you commit at least 1 Power to ordinary conflict Attack Disposition loss, remove 1 additional opposing Disposition, once per action. If the Attack is permitted to inflict a harmful status, one status purchase against that qualifying target costs half its purchased tier in Power, rounded up (tiers 1–2 cost 1; 3–4 cost 2; 5–6 cost 3). Choose only one component if an explicit action permits both Disposition loss and a status. The discount applies to incoming purchased tiers before reduction and stacking, not a guaranteed final tier. It changes price only; success, permission, scope, lethal stakes, Resistance, armour, stacking and creature-specific limits still apply. It discounts no hazards, backlash, accepted payments or unrelated procedures. Other purchases use normal prices. This benefit does not apply to Feint.
◆	Nobody Sees Me Coming	Once per session, declare you're already somewhere you could plausibly have reached. Your first roll there gets +2 bonus dice for free, and the GM can't spend Woe to reveal you during that roll. This grants no additional scripted action and cannot contradict resolved events or reverse a settled outcome.

Shared Limits and Stacking

Opportunist and Deadly Precision may benefit the same action. Opportunist's +1 Power may pay the discounted status price. Distinct flat offensive bonuses stack when each meets its requirements, each on its permitted component. Alternative status prices do not combine; calculate separately and use the lowest applicable price. Deadly Precision grants no general discount to other spending.

For an area effect, identify qualifying individual opponents. Opportunist grants at most +1 Power for the action. Deadly Precision grants at most +1 shared-Disposition loss or discounts one status purchase against one qualifying target. A shared area-status purchase uses normal pricing; the single-target discount cannot lower the whole area's price. Apply the area procedure's own Disposition adjustment separately (Core Rules §10.17).

These benefits can apply in any conflict type when the opening materially assists the fitting approach, including a precision-based Attack in an Argument. They advance only the declared objective and do not automatically inflict harmful statuses.

Neither ability grants an additional action, permits a trumped action to resolve, unlocks a harmful-status purchase, expands declared stakes or overrides independently resolving actions. Neither improves staking, killing strikes or another creature-specific finishing procedure unless that procedure expressly permits it. An unaware helpless or defeated target does not authorise an otherwise unavailable Attack or bypass a required finishing procedure.

4.2 Starting Equipment

Signature item (choose 1)

Genre	Option A	Option B
Fantasy	Twin daggers (1) — *+1 Attack*, *+1 Feint*	Shortbow & black-fletched arrows (1) — *+1 Attack* (range), *silent shots*
Modern	Suppressed pistol (1) — *+1 Attack*, *quiet*	Lockpicks & bypass kit (1) — *opens what's closed*, Advance security clocks +1 per roll
Sci-Fi	Needle pistol (1) — *+1 Attack*, *silent*, *toxin-loaded*	Holo-cloak (1) — *+1 Feint*, *bends light* (Stealth tag)

Playbook kit

Load	Fantasy	Modern	Sci-Fi
1	Thieves' tools	Lockpicks & electronic bypass	Slicer kit
1	Grappling hook & silk cord	Climbing harness & line	Monofilament line & grapple gun
1	Dark hooded cloak — *shadow-dyed*	Black clothing & balaclava	Thermal-masking suit
1	Caltrops & smoke vials — *+1 Maneuver*	Smoke grenade — *+1 Maneuver*	Sensor jammer — *+1 Maneuver*
1	Garrotte & poison vial	Burner phones ×2	Spy drone (Discover, 1 use per scene)
1	Padded leather (light armour)	Concealed vest (light armour)	Flex-mesh undersuit (light armour)

Always carried (0): Fantasy: hidden blade, chalk. Modern: hairpin picks, earpiece. Sci-Fi: implanted lockpick, false ID chip.

4.3 BIG Examples

- Belief: "Everyone has a price; I just haven't found mine." / "The less blood, the better the job."
- Goal: "Get the ledger out of the counting house." / "Learn who sold out my old crew."
- Instinct: "Always check for a second way out." / "Never touch anything without gloves."

Relationships: Ally — a fence, a forger, a former mentor. Rival — an inspector who's close to catching you, a rival thief, the partner who betrayed you.

5. Savant

> *Knowledge is a weapon, a shield, and a cure. Scholars, detectives, scientists, physicians, archivists, engineers.*

Base pools (Sōm / Mēt / Psy / Pne)	7 / 8 / 13 / 8
Edge	Psychē 2, plus 1 in Pneuma or Mētis
Anchor skill	Lore or Investigate
Suggested skills	+4 Lore · +3 Investigate, Medicine · +2 Notice, Tech, Empathy · +1 Persuade, Will, Craft, Arcana
XP trigger	Address a challenge with knowledge or insight

Playbook tags (choose 2): *read everything twice · eye for detail · steady surgeon's hands · speaks the old tongues · respected in academic circles · thinks in diagrams*



5.1 Special Abilities

#	Ability	Effect
1	Encyclopedic	Once per scene, ask one Discover question about a subject covered by your Lore without rolling.
2	Analyze	When you study a foe or obstacle, each Discover you buy also reveals one weakness tag of the target. Creating a story tag that exploits a revealed weakness costs 1 Power instead of 2. The tag provides leverage, not automatic victory or permission to bypass the action interaction. Information may support applicable Superiority at setup; it does not recalculate Superiority mid-conflict.
3	Field Medic	Restore effects from Medicine cost 1 Power per 2 tiers. You can treat *Sick* (Module B) at Standard Difficulty instead of Hard. Increased Restore output does not override lasting-injury treatment limits unless another rule explicitly does so. Healing a status does not restore pools or Disposition, refresh injury trades or erase Scars.
4	Steady Mind	When you Resist confusion, illusion, deception, or forbidden knowledge with Psychē, reduce the status by 3 tiers.
5	Decipher	Codes, unknown languages, and ancient devices give way. Each success on a deciphering roll Advances its clock +1 extra segment. This bonus advances that progress clock only; it is not additional Power or Disposition loss. It grants no additional scripted action or permission to bypass the action interaction (Core Rules §5, §10.5–10.6).
6	Briefing	When an ally acts on information you gave them this scene, they get +1 (counts as a tag). Once per scene, give the whole party this bonus. The normal tag cap still applies; this grants no additional action.
7	★ Connect the Dots	Once per session, propose a hidden Truth based on clues you've found. The GM either makes it true or tells you one true hidden Truth about the situation instead. It cannot contradict resolved events or retroactively recalculate Superiority after setup.
8	★ I Planned for This	Once per scene, after any ally rolls but before Power is spent or the roll's consequences are applied, spend 2 Psychē to let them reroll all dice and keep the better result. This replaces the result of the same action, not an additional action, and cannot reopen a settled outcome.
◆	Master of the Field	Choose one field (medicine, occult, engineering, history, and so on). Rolls in that field are one Difficulty step lower. Once per session, ask a Discover question about what will happen in that field; the GM answers truthfully. Apply the Difficulty reduction when the roll tests against a Difficulty, including an eligible independent conflict test. A versus test compares opposing totals instead; do not convert this reduction into a penalty to the opposing total, bonus Power or additional Disposition loss (Core Rules §10.5).

5.2 Starting Equipment

Signature item (choose 1)

Genre	Option A	Option B
Fantasy	Annotated grimoire / great reference (1) — *the answer is in here somewhere*; once per scene, +1 to Lore	Physician's satchel (1) — *herbs and blades*; Restore +1 tier once per scene; lasting-injury treatment limits still apply
Modern	Laptop with research databases (1) — *online archive*	Forensics kit (1) — *evidence never lies*; +1 to Investigate at scenes
Sci-Fi	Datapad with AI assistant (1) — *ask the archive*; one free Discover per session	Bioscanner (1) — *reads the body*; Medicine and Notice tag

Playbook kit

Load	Fantasy	Modern	Sci-Fi
1	Journal, ink, and charcoal	Notebook, camera, and voice recorder	Holo-recorder
1	Magnifying lens & specimen jars	UV light & evidence bags	Spectral analyser
1	Herbalist's kit	Full first-aid kit	Advanced medkit
1	Quarterstaff — *+1 Defend*	Taser — *+1 Maneuver*	Stun baton — *+1 Maneuver*
1	Scroll case with maps	Tablet with offline maps	Star charts / topographic uplink
1	Alchemist's reagents (1 cypher-like use: Create smoke, light, or acid)	Chemistry kit	Nanite sample kit

Always carried (0): Fantasy: spectacles, chalk. Modern: reading glasses, pen. Sci-Fi: translator earpiece, stylus.

5.3 BIG Examples

- Belief: "No knowledge is forbidden; only misused." / "The dead deserve the truth about how they died."
- Goal: "Translate the inscription before the eclipse." / "Identify the poison."
- Instinct: "Always take a sample." / "Never trust a source I can't verify."

Relationships: Ally — a former teacher, a librarian, a patient who owes you their life. Rival — an academic rival, an ex-colleague who stole your work, a cultist who wants your research.

6. Interlocutor

> *Words open doors that swords can't. Diplomats, con artists, nobles, negotiators, preachers, captains.*

Base pools (Sōm / Mēt / Psy / Pne)	7 / 9 / 9 / 11
Edge	Pneuma 2, plus 1 in Psychē or Mētis
Anchor skill	Persuade
Suggested skills	+4 Persuade · +3 Empathy, Deceive · +2 Will, Notice, Intimidate · +1 Lore, Fight, Stealth, Investigate
XP trigger	Address a challenge with charm, lies, or bargaining

Playbook tags (choose 2): *silver tongue* · *friends in every port* · *reads people like books* · *noble bearing* · *a hundred faces* · *calm under fire*



6.1 Special Abilities

#	Ability	Effect
1	Silver Tongue	When you Persuade or Deceive, creating a story tag about a target's attitude (*convinced*, *trusts us*, *fooled*) costs 1 Power instead of 2. During a conflict, the tag establishes leverage or a supporting attitude; it cannot grant the disputed objective, reverse a resolved outcome or bypass the action interaction.
2	Read the Room	Spend 1 Power on Discover to learn an NPC's Belief, Goal, or Instinct. You get +1 (counts as a tag) against them for the scene. The normal tag cap applies. Information may support applicable Superiority at setup, but does not recalculate it mid-conflict.
3	Network	Once per session, declare a contact in the current location as a story tag (*contact: harbourmaster Elsa*). The GM gives them a quirk or something they want in return. This cannot contradict resolved events or retroactively recalculate Superiority after setup.
4	Smooth Recovery	Once per scene, after failing a Persuade, Deceive or Empathy test against a Difficulty, but before spending Power or applying consequences, turn the result into Success at a Cost regardless of the failure margin. Gain 1 Power, then apply eligible success-based bonuses and spending normally. Choose the applicable Success-at-a-Cost payment instead of ordinary-failure Woe; do not charge both. Doubles complications and other separately triggered consequences still apply. This works on independent conflict tests, not losing or tied versus tests, trumped actions or settled outcomes. A result already qualifying as Success at a Cost does not require this ability.
5	Many Faces	With a moment to prepare, Create the story tag *I belong here* for 1 Power. It lasts the scene and removes one Truth that would raise the Difficulty of mingling or entry. This grants no extra scripted action and does not by itself settle a contested conflict objective.
6	Command	When your side scripts an exchange, if you participate and can act and communicate, designate one volley and its actor. For that assignment, your side may ignore both the requirement that everyone act before anyone repeats and the prohibition on consecutive volleys. Commit the designation with the script. It grants no additional action, later reassignment or free script change. The instruction remains effective if you later become Taken Out, but does not make an unavailable actor able to act. Record the exceptional actor's turn normally without resetting other participants' outstanding turns. Resume normal rotation afterward, carrying its state across exchanges. Your side may use only one Command rotation exception per exchange; unused exceptions do not carry forward. Separately, once per exchange for your side, when an ally other than you succeeds with Defend and commits at least 1 Power to ordinary Disposition recovery, you may add +1 recovery, up to starting Disposition. Declare before applying recovery. This benefit does not trigger if all Power is spent on supplementary Effects or Riposte. Multiple Command users do not multiply either per-exchange allowance.
7	★ Inspire	You can spend your Tychē Points on allies' rolls. Enhance effects you create for allies cost 1 Power per 2 tiers. Enhance grants a helpful status with its normal scope and removal condition; this discount does not restore Disposition or pools, remove a harmful status or grant an additional scripted action (Core Rules §5, §10.5–10.6).

#	Ability	Effect
8	★ Crowd Work	You influence a group as if it were one person. In Argument or Negotiation conflicts against a crowd or council, your successful Attacks remove 1 additional Disposition when applying ordinary Attack Disposition loss. This is additional loss, not Power or a harmful status; it does not grant additional actions or multiply by the crowd's fictional headcount.
◆	Word Is Law	Once per session, a non-villain NPC agrees to a reasonable request without a roll. In Argument and Negotiation conflicts, your side starts with +4 Disposition. Apply the +4 at full value with other flat starting-Disposition modifiers, before the minimum of 1 and opposing Superiority (Core Rules §10.2–10.3). Changing conflict type within the same unresolved struggle does not refresh Disposition or reapply setup bonuses.

6.2 Starting Equipment

Signature item (choose 1)

Genre	Option A	Option B
Fantasy	Signet ring & letters of introduction (0) — *carries a name that opens doors*	Rapier (1) — *+1 Attack*, *+1 Feint*, *duelling style*
Modern	Tailored suit & business cards (0) — *looks like money*	Concealed pistol (1) — *+1 Attack*, *never seen it coming*
Sci-Fi	Diplomatic credentials (0) — *official envoy*	Hold-out blaster (1) — *+1 Attack*, *hidden in a sleeve*

Playbook kit

Load	Fantasy	Modern	Sci-Fi
1	Fine clothes for court	Formal wear & accessories	Holo-fashion wardrobe
1	Disguise kit & wigs	Disguise kit & fake IDs	Holo-disguise emitter
1	Purse of gold — *money talks* (1 use per mission: Create tag *bribed*)	Credit card — *money talks* (same)	Credit stick — *money talks* (same)
1	Bottle of fine wine	Gift basket / bottle of scotch	Rare off-world delicacy
1	Forged seals & papers	Forged documents	Spoofed ID chip
1	Brocaded doublet (light armour)	Armoured coat (light armour)	Deflector jacket (light armour)

Always carried (0): Fantasy: perfume, deck of cards. Modern: smartphone with contacts, breath mints. Sci-Fi: translator implant, personal comm.

6.3 BIG Examples

- Belief: "Every war ends at a table; I'd rather start there." / "A lie that saves a life is no sin."
- Goal: "Get the guild master to sign the truce." / "Find out what the duke really wants."
- Instinct: "Always learn someone's name." / "Never be the first to name a price."

Relationships: Ally — a well-placed patron, a loyal servant, a reporter. Rival — a political opponent, a jilted lover, someone you conned who wants payback.

7. Explorator

> *At home where the map ends. Rangers, hunters, pilots, guides, explorers, scouts, voyageurs.*

Base pools (Sōm / Mēt / Psy / Pne)	11 / 11 / 7 / 7
Edge	Sōma 1, Mētis 1, plus 1 in any pool
Anchor skill	Survival
Suggested skills	+4 Survival · +3 Notice, Shoot · +2 Athletics, Endure, Drive/Pilot · +1 Stealth, Medicine, Lore, Fight
XP trigger	Address a challenge with endurance, travel, or knowledge of the land

Playbook tags (choose 2): *reads the weather · never lost · sharp-eyed hunter · tireless · at home in the wild · steady at the helm*



7.1 Special Abilities

#	Ability	Effect
1	Pathfinder	As Guide (Module B), each Power spent on Make Time Advances the Journey clock +1 extra segment. Ignore one terrain Truth per leg. The extra segment advances the Journey clock only; it is not additional Power or Disposition loss and does not grant an additional scripted action.
2	Forager	As Quartermaster, a success also clears *Hungry & Thirsty* for the whole party and gives +1 Supplies for free.
3	Tracker	When you track or read signs, each Discover you buy gives two answers.
4	Hunter's Eye	With Shoot, once per roll ignore one Truth about cover, distance, or weather. At long range, gain +1 Power on a success.
5	Ambusher	In wild terrain, if you had time to prepare, your side starts a Fight conflict with +2 Disposition, and your first-volley Attack counts as independent regardless of the opponent's action. Apply the +2 at full value with other flat starting-Disposition modifiers, before the minimum of 1 and opposing Superiority (Core Rules §10.2–10.3). It is not additional Superiority, and changing conflict type within the same unresolved struggle does not reapply this setup bonus.
6	At the Helm	Drive/Pilot rolls with your own vehicle or boat may use Survival. Your vehicle gains one power tag (*swift*, *rugged*, *nimble*). In Chase conflicts, your side gets +3 starting Disposition. Apply the +3 at full value with other flat starting-Disposition modifiers, before the minimum of 1 and opposing Superiority (Core Rules §10.2–10.3). Changing from another conflict type to a Chase within the same unresolved struggle does not refresh Disposition or reapply setup bonuses.
7	★ Animal Companion	You have a companion (hound, hawk, horse, drone in sci-fi) with 2 power tags and 1 weakness. Once per scene it gives you a free bonus die, or it acts on its own using your Survival. The bonus die respects the normal bonus-dice cap and grants no extra action. When it acts independently in a conflict, it occupies a place in your side's three-action script and continuous rotation. It has no personal Disposition track or injury trade unless an explicit rule grants one; its removal does not directly subtract shared Disposition. It can take statuses; tier 6 means it's lost until downtime.
8	★ Weather Sense	Once per session, declare the weather or terrain Truth for the next scene (*thick fog*, *rising river*, *clear skies*). This cannot contradict resolved events or retroactively recalculate Superiority after setup.
◆	One With the Wild	In wilderness, the party's Grind clock is 2 segments larger, and you cannot be surprised. Once per session, when your party is fleeing through wilderness, declare that you are losing the pursuit before the next exchange is scripted. If you can lead the party and everyone escaping can travel or be carried, the pursuit ends: you reach concealment or safety and your pursuers lose your trail. No roll or compromise is required. This secures escape only. It does not defeat or capture the pursuers, recover abandoned people or possessions, or undo existing injuries and paid costs. The same pursuit cannot immediately resume without a new discovery or materially changed circumstances.

7.2 Starting Equipment

Signature item (choose 1)

Genre	Option A	Option B
Fantasy	Longbow (2) — *+1 Attack* (range), *hunter's draw*	Spear & hatchet (2) — *+1 Maneuver* (spear), *+1 Attack* (hatchet)
Modern	Scoped hunting rifle (2) — *+1 Attack* (range), *+1 Maneuver*	Canoe or 4×4 truck (vehicle, 0 load) — *my rig*, Drive/Pilot tag
Sci-Fi	Long-las rifle (2) — *+1 Attack* (range), *thermal scope*	Grav-bike or skiff (vehicle, 0 load) — *my rig*, Drive/Pilot tag

Playbook kit

Load	Fantasy	Modern	Sci-Fi
1	Hunting knife & skinning tools	Survival knife & multitool	Survival blade with tool kit
2	Tent, bedroll & cookpot	Lightweight tent, sleeping bag & stove	Pop-up shelter & thermal pack
1	Snares & fishing line	Fishing kit & snares	Auto-snare & water purifier
1	Map case & compass	GPS, maps & compass	Topographic scanner
1	Leather jerkin (light armour)	Waxed-canvas jacket (light armour)	Environment suit (light armour, *sealed*)
1	Trail rations & waterskins (+2 Supplies)	Dehydrated meals & filter (+2 Supplies)	Nutrient packs & reclaimer (+2 Supplies)

Always carried (0): Fantasy: tinderbox, whistle. Modern: ferro rod, bug spray. Sci-Fi: emergency beacon, rebreather.

7.3 BIG Examples

- Belief: "The land gives to those who respect it." / "No one gets left on the trail."
- Goal: "Reach the trading post before the freeze." / "Find the lost survey team."
- Instinct: "Always check the sky before setting out." / "Never camp where you can't see the approach."

Relationships: Ally — a trapper, a bush pilot, a village elder. Rival — a poacher, a rival guide, the company that wants your land.

8. Adept

> *Power from beyond the ordinary: magic, psionics, faith, or impossible technology. Mages, psychics, priests, hackers, gadgeteers.*

Base pools (Sōm / Mēt / Psy / Pne)	7 / 8 / 9 / 12
Edge	Pneuma 2 (Arcana Adepts) or Psychē 2 (Tech Adepts), plus 1 in any other pool
Anchor skill	Arcana (magic, faith, psionics) or Tech (hacking, gadgets)
Suggested skills	+4 Arcana · +3 Lore, Will · +2 Notice, Medicine, Persuade · +1 Investigate, Empathy, Deceive, Tech
XP trigger	Address a challenge with your powers or gadgets

Playbook tags (choose 2): *touched by the Other* · *disciplined mind* · *sees what others can't* · *blessed* · *tinkerer's genius* · *fluent in the old pacts*



8.1 Core Feature — Domain (free)

Every Adept has a Domain: a broad power tag describing what they can do (*fire*, *healing*, *telekinesis*, *shadows*, *machines*, *networks*, *the dead*, *weather*).

- Workings: within your Domain, you can attempt any effect with your anchor skill. The GM sets Difficulty by scope:

Scope	Difficulty	Example (Domain: fire)
Minor, personal	Easy 12	Light a candle, warm your hands
Significant	Standard 15	Hurl a firebolt, melt a lock
Dramatic	Hard 18	Wall of flame across a street
Spectacular	Formidable 21	Set a ship ablaze
World-shaking	Heroic 24 (usually a Ritual)	Call down a firestorm

- Cost: each working costs 1 point from Pneuma (Arcana) or Psychē (Tech), in addition to any Effort.
- Backlash: doubles on a failure or cost cause a backlash. The GM picks a fitting status for you (*burned-2*, *drained-2*, *glitched-2*) or a wild effect, in addition to the normal complication. Backlash remains an explicit additional consequence in conflicts.
- Your Domain counts as a power tag on workings (inside the +2 cap).

In a scripted conflict, a working uses an otherwise permitted scripted action; Domain permission grants no additional turn and does not bypass action interactions or declared stakes.

8.2 Special Abilities

#	Ability	Effect
1	Focused Channel	Workings inside your Domain cost 0 pool points if you don't use Effort on that roll. This waives the normal 1-point working cost only, not separate ability costs or accepted payments. It does not suppress Backlash or other applicable consequences.
2	Ward	You can create protective statuses (*warded-X*) with Enhance. While warded, an ally reduces supernatural or tech-based harm by +1 tier when Resisting. This protection does not reduce shared Disposition loss, running-dry statuses or accepted payments.
3	Sense the Unseen	Once per scene, ask a free Discover question about hidden supernatural or technological forces nearby. You always notice when such forces are used near you.

#	Ability	Effect
4	Overchannel	When you use Effort for Power on a working, gain +2 Power instead of +1, but take *strained-1* as an accepted payment. Armour, Resistance, prevention, redirection and incidental clearing benefits cannot reduce or cancel it. Once recorded, it recovers normally.
5	Ritual	Given time, materials, and a safe place, run a working as a progress clock instead of a single roll (8 segments for Formidable, 12 for Heroic). Ritual results can create Site or Region Truths.
6	Bound Servant	You have a minor spirit, construct, or drone with one power tag and one weakness. It can scout (one free Discover per scene in places it can reach), carry messages, or handle simple tasks. It can't fight. It is an asset, not an independent combat participant: it grants no scripted turn, personal Disposition or injury trade.
7	★ Second Domain	Gain a second Domain. Workings in it use the same rules.
8	★ Unleash	Once per scene, a working hits every target in an area or group, following the Area Effects procedure in Core Rules (provisional for playtesting). Explicitly inflicted statuses apply at full tier to every affected character. In conflicts, apply normal Disposition loss once to the opposing side, plus 1 per additional opposing participant affected; do not multiply full loss by the number of targets or add a status to an ordinary conflict Attack. A group represented by one participant counts once, not once per fictional body. Afterwards, take *Weary* or lose 3 points from your casting pool. The chosen cost is an accepted payment and cannot be prevented, redirected or Resisted; the pool cost must be paid in full.
◆	Ascendant	Once per session, a Heroic-scope working succeeds automatically with 5 Power, no ritual required. In a conflict, declare it before the roll for your normally scheduled action; it grants no extra turn and a trumped action remains trumped. On an independent test apply 5 Power without rolling. In a versus test it wins with 5 Power unless the opposing action also succeeds automatically, in which case resolve a tie unless a specific rule says otherwise. No roll means no dice-based critical or complication. If you use it again before your next downtime, gain a Pneuma or Psychē Scar.

8.3 Starting Equipment

Signature focus (choose 1)

Genre	Option A	Option B
Fantasy	Staff or wand (1) — *conduit*; +1 to workings, *+1 Defend* (staff)	Holy symbol or ancestral talisman (0) — *faith made solid*; Resist supernatural harm with Edge +1
Modern	Occult focus (ring, chalk, athame) (0) — *conduit*	Custom cyberdeck / laptop (1) — *my rig*; +1 to Tech workings
Sci-Fi	Psi-amp headset (1) — *amplifier*; +1 to psionic workings	Neural jack & cyberdeck (1) — *direct interface*; +1 to Tech workings

Playbook kit

Load	Fantasy	Modern	Sci-Fi
1	Grimoire or prayer book	Occult library on a tablet	Encrypted data archive
1	Spell components pouch	Salt, chalk, candles & herbs	Spare power cells & focus crystals
1	Ritual dagger — *+1 Attack*	Pistol — *+1 Attack*	Sidearm blaster — *+1 Attack*
1	Warding charms ×2 (0-Power *warded-1* once each)	Talismans ×2 (same)	Firewall chips ×2 (same)
1	Robes of the order (light armour, *marks my calling*)	Long coat with hidden pockets (light armour)	Insulated bodysuit (light armour)
1	Scrying bowl or crystal	Drone with camera	Micro-drone swarm (Bound Servant gear)

Always carried (0): Fantasy: a small familiar token, incense. Modern: tarot deck, phone. Sci-Fi: diagnostic implant, data spike.

8.4 BIG Examples

- Belief: "Power is a debt, and I always pay my debts." / "Knowledge should be free; locks are an insult."
- Goal: "Seal the rift before the new moon." / "Crack the corporation's archive."
- Instinct: "Always ward the room before I sleep." / "Never use my power in front of the authorities."

Relationships: Ally — your teacher, a fellow initiate, an entity you've bargained with. Rival — a rival practitioner, a hunter of your kind, the order that cast you out.

9. Design Notes

9.1 Balance Targets

Playbook	Main pool	Conflict role	Exploration role	Social role
Bellator	Sōma	Attack / Defend	Endurance, forcing obstacles	Intimidation
Furcifer	Mētis	Feint / Maneuver	Infiltration, security	Deception
Savant	Psychē	Maneuver; ability-enabled analysis	Investigation, healing	Expertise
Interlocutor	Pneuma	Argument and Negotiation lead	Contacts, disguise	Persuasion
Explorator	Sōma/Mētis	Ranged Attack, ambush	Travel, Grind, tracking	Local knowledge
Adept	Pneuma/Psychē	Flexible (Domain)	Supernatural or tech access	Varies by Domain

These are role targets, not additional Effect permissions. Discover, healing and other supplementary purchases in a conflict follow the action or explicit ability that permits them (Core Rules §5, §10.6); the complete supplementary permission list remains an open ruling.

9.2 Things to Watch in Playtest

- Discount stacking: abilities that reduce Power costs (Silver Tongue, Analyze, Field Medic, Deadly Precision, Jury-Rig) can be strong with Effort for Power. Follow their stated scopes. For Create, each explicit discount reduces the cost by 1 Power to a minimum of 1 (Core Rules §5); these notes impose no blanket one-discount-per-Effect cap. Restore-cost discounts do not lift the ordinary 1-tier lasting-injury treatment limit (§6.6). Any further stacking cap is a separate balance proposal, not a rule introduced here.
- Free bonus dice (Berserker, Animal Companion, Second Wind, Nobody Sees Me Coming) still count toward the +2 bonus die maximum. Free benefits grant no extra scripted turn or rotation bypass.
- Adept workings are the most open-ended. If they overshadow other playbooks, playtest increasing the base working cost to 2 pool points or letting Focused Channel apply only to minor and significant workings. These are proposals, not changes to the printed abilities.
- Vehicle signature items (Explorator, modern and sci-fi) are 0 load because they don't come on foot missions. A recorded vehicle can matter as a story fact, but its action benefit requires relevant use or an established contribution; an absent vehicle gives no automatic bonus (Core Rules §10.10).
- Refresh accounting: a ★ Major costs 1 Refresh when taken; as a creation extra it also pays that extra ability's 1 Refresh, for 2 total. Veteran costs remain additional. Actual remaining Refresh depends on the acquisition route and other purchases, not simply the number of ★ abilities. A capstone costs no Refresh but retains its prerequisites (Playbook Rules §1.2).
- Conflict separation: watch additional Power, Disposition loss and status-tier bonuses separately. Do not apply one bonus to both loss and harm unless stated. Companions that act independently enter continuous rotation; supporting assets do not gain independent turns merely by supplying a tag (Core Rules §10.6, §10.9).

CHAPTER VII

Generic Focuses

Twenty-four setting-neutral Focuses complete the sentence: "...who [Focus]." Each one has two power tags, a weakness, a link to another player character, and tiered abilities with a choice at Tiers 2 and 3.

The verb of the character sentence.

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1. Focus Rules

1.1 What a Focus Gives You

Element	Detail
Power tags	2
Weakness tag	1 (can be compelled for Tychē Points)
PC link	A prompt that connects you to another player character
Tier 1 ability	Fixed; gained at creation for free
Tier 2 ability	Choose 1 of 2; after 3 Advances, costs an Advance
Tier 3 ability	Choose 1 of 2; after 6 Advances, costs an Advance

- The other option: once you've reached a tier, you may take its unchosen option later as a normal Advance.
- ★ Major: costs 1 Refresh when taken (Core Rules §4.1). Every Focus has exactly one ★ option, always at Tier 3, so you can always choose a path that keeps your Refresh.
- Any playbook can take any Focus. The "Suits" line is a suggestion.
- Changing Focus: at a major milestone, with GM approval, you can swap your Focus. You keep Tier 1 of the new one and rebuy higher tiers with Advances.

1.2 Weird Focuses ◈

Focuses marked ◈ Weird assume the supernatural, impossible technology, or both. In mundane settings the GM removes them from the list. Every other Focus works in any genre.

1.3 Shared Rules Reminders

- Free bonus dice from Focuses still count toward the +2 bonus die maximum. Free waives only the stated resource cost, not action requirements, rotation or participation limits.
- Abilities that add bonus above the tag cap only do so for the tag they name, and are limited to +1 above the normal +2 cap (maximum +3) unless stated otherwise.
- Cost reductions: for Effects other than Create, only one cost reduction applies to a single Effect unless an explicit rule says otherwise. Create is an explicit exception: each stated Create discount reduces its cost by 1 Power, to a minimum of 1, from the baseline 2 Power per Truth rank (Core Rules §5). Relevance alone supplies no discount.
- Automatic success: use the ability's listed Power for an otherwise permitted action under Core Rules §10.5. It does not rescue a trumped action, grant an extra turn, change the script or win the whole conflict by itself. No roll produces no dice-based critical or complication.
- Separate benefits: additional Power, Disposition loss and status tiers affect only their stated component. Ordinary conflict Attacks and Feints inflict no status or pool loss without explicit permission (§10.6). A general Effect reference does not settle the open supplementary action-permission list (§5).
- Healing and payments: Restore-cost discounts do not lift the ordinary 1-tier lasting-injury treatment limit (§6.6). Generic prevention, redirection, Resistance and incidental clearing cannot cancel protected payments (§10.7). Later healing does not restore Disposition, refresh an injury trade or erase a Scar, and returning a Taken Out ally to an ongoing conflict requires explicit permission (§6.4).

2. Quick Reference

#	Focus	Category	Suits
1	Never Leaves Anyone Behind	Combat	Bellator, Explorator, Furcifer
2	Leads From the Front	Combat	Interlocutor, Bellator, Explorator
3	Masters a Weapon	Combat	Bellator, Furcifer, Explorator
4	Fights Dirty	Combat	Bellator, Furcifer
5	Moves Like a Shadow	Stealth & Precision	Furcifer, Explorator

#	Focus	Category	Suits	◆
6	Never Misses	Stealth & Precision	Explorator, Furcifer, Bellator	
7	Opens Every Lock	Stealth & Precision	Furcifer, Savant, Adept	
8	Always Has an Escape Plan	Stealth & Precision	Furcifer, Interlocutor	
9	Builds Impossible Things	Knowledge	Savant, Adept, Explorator	
10	Heals the Broken	Knowledge	Savant, Adept, Interlocutor	
11	Solves the Unsolvable	Knowledge	Savant, Interlocutor, Furcifer	
12	Remembers What Was Forgotten	Knowledge	Savant, Adept, Explorator	
13	Talks Their Way Out of Anything	Social	Interlocutor, Furcifer	
14	Wears a Hundred Masks	Social	Interlocutor, Furcifer	
15	Knows Everyone Worth Knowing	Social	Interlocutor, Savant	
16	Carries the Weight of a Crown	Social	Interlocutor, Bellator	
17	Runs With the Pack	Wilderness & Travel	Explorator, Bellator	
18	Charts the Unknown	Wilderness & Travel	Explorator, Savant	
19	Lives Off the Land	Wilderness & Travel	Explorator, Bellator	
20	Was Born Behind the Wheel	Wilderness & Travel	Explorator, Furcifer	
21	Hunts the Things in the Dark	Weird	Savant, Adept, Bellator	◈
22	Walks Between Worlds	Weird	Adept, Savant	◈
23	Made a Bargain With Something Old	Weird	Any	◈
24	Is More Than Human	Weird	Any	◈

3. Combat Focuses

1. Never Leaves Anyone Behind

> *Loyal to a fault. You go back for the fallen, every time.*

- Power tags: *I've got your back*, *carry them out*
- Weakness tag: *can't walk away*
- PC link: "I once failed to save someone. [PC] reminds me of them."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Shield Bearer	When an ally next to you takes an imposed status, spend 1 point from any pool to reduce it by 1 tier before they Resist. This cannot reduce shared Disposition loss, injury-trade payments, running-dry statuses, agreed concession costs or other accepted payments.
2a	Second Wind	Once per scene, when you succeed on a Defend action while able to reach and assist a Taken Out ally, you may spend 2 Power to bring them back into the conflict. Reduce the status that took them out to tier 4. They can participate again if their remaining conditions allow it, and rejoin your side's normal rotation without gaining an immediate turn. This does not reverse death or a settled defeat, remove other statuses or erase a Scar. The 2 Power buys this rescue instead of Disposition recovery; any remaining Power may restore Disposition normally.
2b	Interpose	When you accept an injury to cancel Disposition loss from an Attack or Feint, cancel 1 additional Disposition loss, up to the loss inflicted. All normal injury-trade restrictions apply.
3a	No One Left	Once per session, before a volley is revealed, declare a coordinated withdrawal. After that volley's actions finish, your side escapes the immediate conflict together, including Taken Out allies you can reach and carry. Give up the objective you were contesting unless it was solely to escape. The opposition achieves any compatible part of its declared intent, but cannot capture or separate the allies you extract. Apply no additional compromise. Existing injuries and paid costs remain. This grants no healing and does not recover allies already held elsewhere.
3b	★ Living Wall	Once per scene, until your next action, all imposed harm aimed at allies within reach that you can fictionally intercept hits you instead. Redirect it before the original target's Resistance or reduction; use your own eligible reduction. You Resist each with Edge +1. This does not redirect shared Disposition loss, injury-trade payments, running-dry statuses, agreed concession costs or other accepted payments. You cannot shield an ally from an area effect that already affects both of you.

2. Leads From the Front

> *Captain, chief, or sergeant: people follow you.*

- Power tags: *born to command*, *they believe in me*
- Weakness tag: *every loss is on me*

- PC link: "[PC] was the first person who ever followed my lead."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Rally	Once per scene, spend 1 Momentum to restore 2 points to one pool of every ally who can hear you. This does not clear statuses, restore Disposition or erase Scars.
2a	Battle Plan	At the start of a conflict, the opposing side commits its first exchange's script. Before your side commits its own script, look at one of those opposing actions. This grants no extra action and does not permit free changes after your own script is committed.
2b	Lead by Example	When you succeed with 3+ Power, the next ally who acts toward the same goal gets a free bonus die. The normal bonus-dice cap applies; this grants no extra action.
3a	★ Warband	Gain a loyal crew (a group with 2 power tags and 1 weakness). It acts as one group, gives free Help once per scene, or holds a position. It takes statuses as a single target. If it acts independently in a conflict, it is one participant in your side's script and continuous rotation, and one participant for area-effect Disposition bonuses. It has no personal Disposition track or injury trade unless explicitly granted one. Free Help waives the pool-point cost, not relevance, bonus-dice limits or participation risks.
3b	Unbreakable Line	Once per conflict, when your side's Disposition would drop to 0, it stays at 1 and you take a tier-2 status as an accepted payment. Prevention, redirection, Resistance and incidental clearing benefits cannot cancel that payment; once recorded, it recovers normally. This does not increase starting Disposition or refresh an injury trade.

3. Masters a Weapon

> *Years of drill with one weapon: a blade, a rifle, a staff, bare fists.*

- Power tags: *one with my [weapon]*, *drilled every day*
- Weakness tag: *lost without it*
- PC link: "[PC] once saw me lose a duel, and kept it secret."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Signature Style	Choose a weapon type. That weapon's tag may add +1 above the normal +2 cap (maximum +3 from tags), and it gains a second conflict action tag (e.g. a sword also gives +1 Defend).
2a	Riposte	In Fight conflicts, when you win a versus roll with Defend, you may spend any of that Power to remove the opposing side's Disposition instead of restoring your side's.
2b	Disarming Master	The Disarm maneuver costs 2 Power instead of 3. This sets its price to 2; another rule also setting it to 2 does not reduce it further. Outside conflicts, Weaken can strip an opponent's weapon tag for the scene.
3a	Perfect Strike	Once per scene, after rolling with your weapon, turn one kept die into a 12. If that creates doubles, apply them. Declare this before spending Power or applying the roll's consequences; it cannot reopen a settled outcome.
3b	★ Weapon Saint	Your weapon becomes an artifact (Module A) with one extra power tag and an ability you design with the GM. It never depletes and costs no attunement Refresh.

4. Fights Dirty

> *Honour is for people who can afford to lose.*

- Power tags: *no rules in a fight*, *eye for a cheap shot*
- Weakness tag: *no one trusts me in a fair fight*
- PC link: "I taught [PC] that winning is the only thing that matters. They're still deciding if I was right."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Cheap Shot	Once per scene, as part of an Attack, Create a story tag (*sand in the eyes*, *low blow*) for 1 Power. State the tag's scope and removal condition normally. This explicitly permits the Create purchase, not an additional scripted action or an automatic harmful status.
2a	Improvised Arsenal	Anything in reach is a weapon for you: chairs, bottles, tools. It gives +1 Attack or +1 Maneuver and costs no load. This is an action tag, subject to normal relevance and the +2 tag cap unless an explicit exception applies; it is not additional Power or Disposition loss (Core Rules §2.1, §10.10).
2b	Kick Them While They're Down	Against a target with a harmful status of tier 2+, gain +1 Power on Attack.
3a	Every Trick in the Book	In Fight conflicts, your successful Feints remove 1 additional Disposition when applying ordinary Feint Disposition loss. This is additional loss, not Power or a harmful status.
3b	★ Nothing Is Off-Limits	Once per session, declare a hazard Truth that was already there (*gas leak*, *rotten floor*, *loose cargo*). Your next roll that uses it gets a free Extra Feat. The declaration cannot contradict resolved events or retroactively recalculate Superiority. Free waives the Extra Feat's Power cost, not the action interaction or declared stakes; it grants no additional scripted action.

4. Stealth & Precision Focuses

5. Moves Like a Shadow

> *Silent, patient, and impossible to pin down.*

- Power tags: *silent as snowfall*, *at home in darkness*
- Weakness tag: *uneasy in the light*
- PC link: "[PC] is the only one who always knows where I am."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Shadow-Born	Truths about darkness, noise, or crowds lower your Stealth Difficulty by two steps instead of one.
2a	Vanish	Once per scene, after any roll, become hidden if there's any cover nearby. No roll needed. This changes your position going forward; it does not undo resolved effects, Disposition loss, injuries or a settled outcome, cancel an independently resolving action or grant an additional scripted turn.
2b	Shadow Escort	Up to two allies can use your Stealth result instead of rolling their own.
3a	Unseen Hand	Any action you take while hidden gains +1 Power on a success.
3b	★ Living Shadow	Once per session, describe a concealed route through one guarded or blocked area and name a destination on the other side. You reach it unnoticed without a roll, provided the route could physically accommodate you. Ordinary locks, patrols and surveillance do not prevent this passage. Declare before attempting the crossing. During a scripted conflict, use this between exchanges, before either side scripts the next one. It moves only you and what you carry; it does not open the route for others. If unnoticed passage was your sole conflict objective, you achieve it and leave that conflict without compromise. Otherwise, continue from your new position without refreshing Disposition or other conflict resources.

6. Never Misses

> *Sniper, archer, gunslinger: steady breath and a sharp eye.*

- Power tags: *steady breath*, *eye like a hawk*
- Weakness tag: *clumsy up close*
- PC link: "[PC] owes their life to a shot I made."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Called Shot	Once per roll with Shoot, a free Weaken effect: burn one of the target's tags (weapon, cover, mobility) for the scene. This explicitly permits the Weaken effect; free waives its Power cost, not the action interaction or declared stakes, and grants no additional scripted action.
2a	Overwatch	Once per scene, cancel an imposed status of tier 2 or less about to hit an ally by shooting the source. Declare this before the status is applied. It cannot cancel shared Disposition loss, injury-trade payments, running-dry statuses, agreed concession costs or other accepted payments. In conflicts, you may Defend with Shoot when covering fire can protect your side.
2b	Trick Shot	Ignore Truths about cover and angles. A free Extra Feat when you shoot objects (cut a rope, hit a switch, ricochet). Free waives the Power cost; it grants no additional scripted action and cannot bypass the action interaction or declared stakes.
3a	One Shot	Once per session, a Shoot Attack against a non-major NPC Takes them Out on a success.
3b	★ Sniper's Patience	Spend a scene setting up (4-segment clock). Your shot gets +2 bonus dice for free and +2 Power on a success. These dice count toward the normal bonus-dice cap; preparation grants no additional scripted action.

7. Opens Every Lock

> *Locks, safes, firewalls, sealed doors: they're puzzles, and you love puzzles.*

- Power tags: *nothing stays closed*, *thinks like an architect*
- Weakness tag: *can't resist a challenge*
- PC link: "[PC] keeps me out of trouble, or tries to."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Bypass	Each success on a lock, safe, or security clock Advances it +1 extra segment. The bonus advances that progress clock only; it is not additional Power or Disposition loss and grants no additional scripted action or action-interaction bypass (Core Rules §5, §10.5–10.6).
2a	Back Door	Once per location, Create the Truth *I know a way in* for 1 Power. It establishes access or leverage, not automatic victory over an unrelated conflict objective or permission to contradict resolved events.
2b	Trap Sense	You always notice traps and alarms before triggering them. Resisting traps costs 0 on a highest die of 5+. This does not permit Resistance against shared Disposition loss, accepted payments or settled outcomes.
3a	Master Key	Ordinary locks open without a roll. Complex security is two Difficulty steps lower. The two-step reduction applies when testing against a Difficulty, including an eligible independent conflict test; do not convert it into a modifier to opposing totals in a versus test (Core Rules §10.5).
3b	★ Vault Breaker	Once per mission, declare a security layer already cracked: fill one security clock completely.

8. Always Has an Escape Plan

> *You never walk into a room without knowing how to leave it.*

- Power tags: *knows every exit*, *slippery*
- Weakness tag: *runs first, thinks later*
- PC link: "[PC] was with me during my worst getaway."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Exit Strategy	When you enter a new scene, ask one free Discover question about exits or escape routes.
2a	Clean Getaway	In Chase conflicts where you're fleeing, your side gets +3 starting Disposition. Apply the +3 at full value with other flat starting-Disposition modifiers, before the minimum of 1 and opposing Superiority (Core Rules §10.2–10.3). Changing conflict type within the same unresolved struggle does not refresh Disposition or reapply setup bonuses.
2b	Contingency	Once per mission, when things go wrong, reveal a prepared fallback (stashed gear, a getaway vehicle, a safe house) as a story tag. No Momentum needed. This cannot contradict resolved events, reverse paid costs or settled outcomes, or retroactively recalculate Superiority after setup.
3a	Not Here	Once per scene, when you would receive an imposed harmful status, spend 1 Momentum and describe how you evade its source. Cancel that status on yourself and move to a nearby position you could reach without a separate test. You must be able to act. This does not cancel Disposition loss, effects on other characters, accepted payments or other effects of the triggering action. It grants no additional action and does not end the conflict.
3b	★ Dead Man's Switch	Once per session, when you are captured or confined, declare a contingency and give the GM 2 Woe. At the start of your next scene, the contingency creates an escape opening: you slip one restraint, open one exit, or receive help from an established contact. You may immediately attempt one appropriate escape roll, even if confinement would normally prevent the attempt. This roll occurs outside any scripted exchange; if a conflict is underway, resolve the opening before its next exchange. You retain your injuries and other statuses. This does not revive you, restore confiscated equipment, free companions or guarantee the escape roll succeeds.

5. Knowledge Focuses

9. Builds Impossible Things

> *An artificer, engineer, or inventor who makes what shouldn't work, work.*

- Power tags: *workshop hands*, *it'll work, trust me*
- Weakness tag: *never quite finished*
- PC link: "I built [PC]'s gear, and I'm still tinkering with it."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Jury-Rig	Once per scene, Craft a temporary gadget (a story tag) that lasts the scene and costs 1 Power to Create. State its scope and removal condition normally. The discount grants no additional scripted action or permission to bypass the action interaction or declared stakes (Core Rules §5, §10.5–10.6).
2a	Inventor	During downtime, turn a gadget into a permanent item with a 6-segment clock. It gets 1 power tag and 1 action tag. These tags remain subject to normal relevance and tag-cap rules; do not count the same item benefit twice on one roll.
2b	Field Repairs	Restore effects work on gear, vehicles, and constructs. Repair damaged armour without downtime. Repairs do not restore shared Disposition, refresh injury trades or erase Scars.
3a	Master-work	Create one artifact (Module A) with a 12-segment downtime clock. You pay no Refresh to attune your own masterwork.
3b	★ Rig the Field	Once per scene, rig the area with gadgets: Create two story tags for 2 Power total. This grants no additional scripted action; establish each tag's scope and removal condition normally.

10. Heals the Broken

> *Doctor, field medic, herbalist, or combat surgeon.*

- Power tags: *calm hands*, *bedside manner*
- Weakness tag: *can't refuse anyone in pain*
- PC link: "I patched up [PC] when no one else would."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Triage	Once per scene, reduce an ally's harmful status by 1 tier without a roll. This treats an existing status; it does not prevent an accepted payment from being recorded or restore Disposition, refresh an injury trade or erase a Scar.
2a	Battlefield Surgeon	In conflicts, you may Defend with Medicine when you can reach an ally and provide appropriate treatment. On a successful Defend, restore your side's Disposition normally and clear one tier-1 harmful status from that ally that your treatment can address. This explicit additional healing cannot cancel an accepted payment as an incidental clearing benefit or return a Taken Out ally unless another rule permits their return.
2b	Remedy	In each Players' Turn, clear one Grind condition (Module B) from one ally without spending a Check.
3a	Miracle Worker	Once per session, bring an ally back from a tier-6 physical status. They return at tier 4 and are no longer Taken Out. This explicitly permits return to an unresolved conflict if its remaining circumstances allow participation. It does not reverse a settled defeat, restore Disposition or erase a Scar.
3b	★ Physician's Care	Allies you treat during a short rest recover all pool points instead of the ordinary pool recovery for that rest. This does not clear statuses, restore Disposition or erase Scars.

11. Solves the Unsolvable

> *Detective, investigator, or analyst: you follow the thread to the end.*

- Power tags: *nothing gets past me*, *follows the thread*
- Weakness tag: *obsessed with the case*
- PC link: "[PC] was part of the case that made me."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Case File	Start a Mystery clock (6 or 8) for a case. Every Discover you buy also Advances it 1 segment. When it fills, the GM reveals the core truth. The extra segment advances the Mystery clock only; it is not additional Power or Disposition loss and grants no additional scripted action or action-interaction bypass (Core Rules §5, §10.5–10.6).
2a	Interrogator	When questioning someone, each Discover gives two answers.
2b	Reconstruction	At the scene of a past event, ask three Discover questions for free (once per location).
3a	The Reveal	Once per session, publicly identify the culprit in a case you have investigated and explain the evidence connecting them to it. The GM confirms whether your conclusion is correct. If it is, choose the next conflict this session in which your side confronts that culprit over the case. Your side gains +4 starting Disposition in that conflict. Apply this as a flat setup modifier before the minimum of 1 and opposing Superiority. Declare its use before starting Disposition is rolled; it cannot increase Disposition in a conflict already underway. If your side wins, the defeated culprit receives no compromise protecting them from the case-related outcome established in the stakes. Other members of their side retain any compromise protection owed to them; they cannot use it to restore the culprit's excluded protection. This does not establish guilt without supporting evidence, expand the declared stakes, compel an immediate confession or bypass a required finishing procedure. An incorrect accusation grants no benefit and expends the session's use.
3b	★ One Step Ahead	Once per session, reveal that you anticipated an opponent's move: cancel one GM Woe spend as it happens. Declare this before the spend's effect resolves; it cannot undo an already resolved action or outcome.

12. Remembers What Was Forgotten

> *Historian, archaeologist, or keeper of lost lore.*

- Power tags: *walks among ruins*, *reads dead languages*
- Weakness tag: *lives in the past*
- PC link: "[PC] helped me recover something that was lost."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Echoes of the Past	At any old or abandoned place, ask one free Discover question about its history.
2a	Lost Knowledge	Once per session, you've read about this before: Create a story tag (*ancient weakness*, *forgotten route*) for 0 Power. This explicit free Create does not grant an extra scripted action, contradict resolved events or retroactively recalculate Superiority.
2b	Relic Hunter	When you find cyphers or treasure, roll or draw twice and choose. You identify artifacts automatically.
3a	Living Archive	Lore rolls about history, legends, and old cultures are two Difficulty steps lower. Apply this reduction when testing against a Difficulty, including an eligible independent conflict test; do not convert it into a modifier to opposing totals in a versus test (Core Rules §10.5).
3b	★ Rewrite History	Prove a Campaign Truth is false with a 12-segment research clock. When it fills, the Truth changes (Module C).

6. Social Focuses

13. Talks Their Way Out of Anything

> *Charm, quick wit, and the right words at the right time.*

- Power tags: *always has a story ready*, *disarming smile*
- Weakness tag: *my mouth writes cheques*
- PC link: "[PC] has bailed me out more than once; I owe them."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Fast Talk	Once per scene, use Persuade or Deceive in place of any other skill to get out of a bad situation. This substitutes the skill, not the scripted action: it grants no extra turn and does not bypass the action interaction or declared stakes.
2a	Change of Plans	When a social roll results in a Success at a Cost, you may give the GM 1 Woe instead of accepting the consequence.
2b	Disarming	Once per scene, stop a fight before it starts with a Persuade roll. On a success, the Fight becomes a Negotiation conflict. Changing type within the same unresolved struggle does not refresh Disposition, injury trades or Taken Out participants; establish the new skills before the next exchange.
3a	★ The Long Con	Start a long con clock (8) against a target. Each success against them Advances it. When it fills, they give up something substantial: land, title, a secret, or their master.
3b	Golden Tongue	Tychē Point invokes on Persuade and Deceive give +3 instead of +2.

14. Wears a Hundred Masks

> *Spy, impostor, or actor: you can be anyone.*

- Power tags: *perfect mimic*, *no one remembers my real face*
- Weakness tag: *who am I really?*
- PC link: "[PC] is the only one who knows my real name."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Quick Change	Create a disguise story tag for 1 Power, even without a disguise kit. State the tag's scope and removal condition normally. This grants no additional scripted action and cannot by itself settle the disputed conflict objective.
2a	Mimic	You can copy voices, mannerisms, and handwriting. Impersonating a specific person gets a free bonus die. The normal bonus-dice cap applies.
2b	Deep Cover	Establish one persistent cover identity with a name, a credible background and one named contact who knows you under that identity. Record it as a permanent story tag. Before the GM resolves an event that would expose the identity as false, they must identify a credible cause and spend 2 Woe. Without that spend, suspicion may create scrutiny or obstacles, but does not establish your true identity or prove the cover false. This protection does not stop you voluntarily revealing yourself. It does not protect unrelated lies, prevent arrest under the cover identity, or erase evidence already established before the cover was created. Replacing a blown cover requires establishing a new identity during downtime.
3a	Belongs Anywhere	Ignore Truths about social barriers (*members only*, *high security*, *closed community*).
3b	★ Become Them	Once per session, after observing a specific NPC and preparing your impersonation, take their place for one scene. People and ordinary identity checks accept you as that person without a roll. This guarantees recognition, not obedience: requests, negotiations and actions beyond that person's ordinary access resolve normally. You gain none of their memories, abilities or possessions. The protection ends when the scene ends, you deliberately reveal yourself, or you confront someone with direct proof that you cannot be the person—such as appearing beside the real NPC. Suspicion, unfamiliarity or a failed unrelated roll alone cannot expose you.

15. Knows Everyone Worth Knowing

> *Fixer, socialite, or broker: you're one call away from anyone.*

- Power tags: *favours owed*, *always on the guest list*
- Weakness tag: *owes favours too*
- PC link: "I introduced [PC] to the people who matter."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Contacts	Start with 3 named contacts (story tags). Once per session, call one for a free Discover or a minor favour.
2a	Favour Bank	In each Players' Turn, help a contact (spend a Check) to bank a favour. Spend a favour for substantial help: a safe house, troops, a pardon. Help arrives within the established fiction; it grants no additional scripted action or retroactive setup recalculation.
2b	Gossip Network	At the start of each session, ask 2 Discover questions about current rumours. When confirming rumours (Module C), roll twice and choose.
3a	Power Broker	Once per World Turn (Module C), Advance or reverse one faction clock by 1.
3b	★ The Right Person	Once per session, exactly the right contact for the situation happens to be present. This cannot contradict resolved events or retroactively recalculate Superiority after setup.

16. Carries the Weight of a Crown

> *Noble, officer, executive, or chieftain: you hold authority, and it holds you.*

- Power tags: *voice of authority*, *my name carries weight*
- Weakness tag: *duty before self*
- PC link: "[PC] serves me, or is the one person who refuses to."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Rank	Choose where your authority applies (a realm, company, fleet, or clan). There, Create the Truth *by my order* for 1 Power. The Truth provides authority or leverage; it does not automatically grant the disputed objective or bypass action interactions.
2a	Retainers	Gain loyal servants or aides as a group tag. They give free Help once per scene and handle errands. Free Help waives the pool-point cost, not relevance, bonus-dice limits or participation risks. These benefits grant no independent combat turn, personal Disposition or injury trade.
2b	Immunity	Once per session, when an authority that recognises your position would arrest you or impose a legal penalty, invoke your status before that consequence is applied. The authority must suspend that consequence and refer the matter to a named superior, court or institution entitled to hear your case. You remain free pending that hearing, but must accept a concrete obligation to answer the charge: appear at a stated time, provide a recognised guarantor, or submit to an equivalent requirement appropriate to the setting. Agree the obligation when you invoke the ability. This protects only you. It does not erase the charge, establish innocence, recover penalties already applied or protect companions. It does not bind an enemy or outlaw who rejects your authority. In a conflict, this can replace your arrest or legal penalty with the referral and obligation, but does not reverse the conflict's result or prevent other compatible consequences. You cannot use it to cancel a penalty you already accepted as payment or concession.
3a	Command the Field	In Battle conflicts, your side gets +4 starting Disposition. Apply the +4 at full value with other flat starting-Disposition modifiers, before the minimum of 1 and opposing Superiority (Core Rules §10.2–10.3). Changing conflict type within the same unresolved struggle does not refresh Disposition or reapply setup bonuses.
3b	★ Holdings	Gain a holding (keep, office, ship, estate) as a site with 3 Truths you choose. Once per Players' Turn, one action there costs no Check.

7. Wilderness & Travel Focuses

17. Runs With the Pack

> *Beast handler, rider, falconer, or dog-musher.*

- Power tags: *animals trust me*, *calm voice*
- Weakness tag: *better with animals than people*
- PC link: "[PC] is the only person my animals like."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Handler	Calm or command ordinary animals with Empathy. If you have an Animal Companion, it gains +1 power tag.
2a	Pack Tactics	Your animals give free Help once per scene. Free waives the pool-point cost, not relevance, bonus-dice limits or participation risks, and grants no independent turn.
2b	Beast Lore	Once per scene, Discover a creature's weakness tag without rolling.
3a	★ The Pack	Gain a group of animals (hounds, ravens, horses) with 2 power tags and 1 weakness. It acts as one group and takes statuses as a single target. If it acts independently in a conflict, it is one participant in your side's three-action script, continuous rotation and area-effect Disposition bonuses, not one per animal. It has no personal Disposition track or injury trade unless explicitly granted one; its removal does not directly subtract shared Disposition.
3b	Trusted Mount	Gain a superb mount (or upgrade one). In Chase conflicts your side gets +3 starting Disposition, and the mount carries 3 extra load. Apply the +3 at full value with other flat starting-Disposition modifiers, before the minimum of 1 and opposing Superiority (Core Rules §10.2–10.3). Changing conflict type within the same unresolved struggle does not refresh Disposition or reapply setup bonuses.

18. Charts the Unknown

> *Explorer, navigator, or surveyor drawn to the blank parts of the map.*

- Power tags: *always knows north*, *mapmaker's eye*
- Weakness tag: *can't resist the horizon*
- PC link: "[PC] backed my first expedition."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Carto-grapher	Any area you've travelled becomes a map (story tag). It permanently lowers travel Difficulty there by one step. Apply this reduction when testing against a travel Difficulty in that area, including an eligible independent conflict test; do not convert it into a modifier to opposing totals in a versus test (Core Rules §10.5).
2a	Shortcut	Once per journey, skip one leg entirely (no rolls, no Supplies spent).
2b	First Contact	Your first Persuade or Empathy roll with a new people or culture gets a free bonus die. The normal bonus-dice cap applies.
3a	Discoverer	Once per session, discover a new site (Module C). You define one of its three Truths.
3b	★ Lands Unknown	When the party enters an uncharted region, you name one Region Truth. This cannot contradict resolved events or retroactively recalculate Superiority after setup.

19. Lives Off the Land

> *Survivalist, forager, or homesteader: you need nothing the world doesn't give.*

- Power tags: *nothing goes to waste*, *knows what's edible*
- Weakness tag: *distrusts civilization*
- PC link: "I taught [PC] how to survive their first winter."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Forager's Eye	The party loses Supplies only every other leg. You clear *Hungry & Thirsty* with an Easy Survival roll.
2a	Shelter Builder	Allies who rest in a camp you built each clear one Grind condition. This recovery does not restore Disposition, refresh injury trades or erase Scars.
2b	Natural Remedies	Use Survival in place of Medicine for Restore effects, using what you gather. This substitutes the skill; normal lasting-injury treatment limits still apply unless explicitly overridden.
3a	Hardened	Your personal Grind clock is 2 segments larger, and you ignore *Exposed*.
3b	★ Living Larder	The party never runs out of Supplies in any wild terrain that supports life.

20. Was Born Behind the Wheel

> *Driver, pilot, sailor, or rider: you and your vehicle are one.*

- Power tags: *my rig is part of me*, *nerves of steel at speed*
- Weakness tag: *can't leave her behind*
- PC link: "[PC] has ridden shotgun since day one."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Signature Vehicle	Gain a vehicle (horse and cart, truck, canoe, starship) with 2 power tags, or give your existing one 2 more. These tags remain subject to normal relevance and tag-cap rules; owning the vehicle grants no independent scripted turn.
2a	Stunt Driver	In Chase conflicts, your successful Maneuvers gain +1 Power. This cannot turn a failure or a trumped action into a success.
2b	Grease Monkey	Repair your vehicle in the field with Craft. Restore on vehicle statuses costs 1 Power per 2 tiers. Repairs do not restore shared Disposition, refresh injury trades or erase Scars.
3a	Ace	Once per scene, reroll a Drive/Pilot roll for free. Declare this after reading the dice but before spending Power or applying the roll's consequences. It rerolls the same action, not an additional action, and cannot reopen a settled outcome.
3b	★ Legendary Ride	Your vehicle becomes an artifact with one special ability (ram, jump, stealth mode, impossible speed). It costs no attunement Refresh.

8. Weird Focuses ◈

21. Hunts the Things in the Dark ◈

> *Monster-hunter, exorcist, or investigator of the strange.*

- Power tags: *knows their weaknesses*, *silver, salt, and iron*
- Weakness tag: *the dark hunts me back*
- PC link: "[PC] saw what I saw that night, and they're the only one who believes me."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Monster Lore	Once per scene, Discover a supernatural creature's weakness tag without rolling.
2a	Bane	Against a creature whose weakness you've exploited, your successful conflict Attacks remove 1 additional Disposition when applying ordinary Attack Disposition loss. When an Attack instead inflicts a harmful status, increase that status by 1 tier. If an explicit effect inflicts both, choose one component for this bonus, never both. This adds no status to an ordinary conflict Attack and does not improve staking, killing strikes or other creature-specific finishing procedures.
2b	Ward the Threshold	Spend an uninterrupted scene marking and preparing one doorway, gateway or other clearly defined entrance. Until the next dawn, supernatural creatures cannot cross that threshold without overcoming the ward. State which side it protects when you prepare it. Outside a scripted conflict, a creature attempting to cross tests Will against Formidable 21. A success, including Success at a Cost, lets that creature cross and ends the ward's protection against it for the remaining duration. Failure leaves it outside. During a scripted conflict, overcoming the ward requires a Maneuver. Resolve it as an independent Will test against Formidable 21 regardless of the opposing action; that opposing action also resolves independently. Success permits crossing but produces no ordinary Maneuver effects. A creature may attempt this no more than once per exchange. The ward does not stop attacks or Effects that can reach across the boundary. Destroying the physical markings ends it.
3a	Unshakeable	When you Resist fear, possession, or corruption with Pneuma, the cost is 0 on a highest die of 5+, and you reduce the status by 3 tiers.
3b	★ Nemesis	Name a supernatural foe. You always sense its direction, and your rolls against it get a free bonus die. This die counts toward the normal +2 bonus-dice cap and grants no additional scripted turn (Core Rules §2.4, §10.5).

22. Walks Between Worlds ◈

> *Touched by the spirit world, the Otherworld, or the deep net.*

- Power tags: *one foot across the veil*, *spirits whisper to me*
- Weakness tag: *not quite of this world*
- PC link: "[PC] anchors me. Without them, I'd drift away."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Spirit Sight	You can see and speak with spirits, ghosts, or digital entities. Once per scene, a Discover about them costs 0 Power.
2a	Crossing	With a 4-segment ritual clock, step into the other world and back, bringing up to two allies.
2b	Ghostly Ally	A minor spirit follows you. Once per scene, it gives a free Discover about places it can reach. This is an information asset; the benefit grants no independent combat turn, personal Disposition or injury trade.
3a	Ally Beyond	Gain a powerful patron in the other world. Once per session, call on it for a Heroic-scope favour; the GM gets a compel on your weakness tag in return.
3b	★ Half-Step	Once per scene, become intangible until your next action. Ignore one incoming imposed physical status. This does not cancel shared Disposition loss, injury-trade payments, running-dry statuses, agreed concession costs or other accepted payments.

23. Made a Bargain With Something Old ◈

> *Warlock, cursed heir, or desperate deal-maker. You have power, and a debt.*

- Power tags: *patron's gift*, *knows the old names*
- Weakness tag: *the debt comes due*
- PC link: "[PC] knows what I traded, and hasn't told anyone."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Patron's Gift	Gain a minor Domain (Generic Playbooks §8.1) tied to your patron. You can perform Easy and Standard workings with Arcana, paying Pneuma. If you're already an Adept, your Domain gets +1 power tag instead. Domain permission grants no additional scripted turn and does not bypass action interactions or declared stakes.
2a	Ask the Patron	Once per session, ask two Discover questions. The GM gains 1 Woe.
2b	Not Yet	Once per session, after normal reduction and stacking are determined, when an imposed harmful status would reach tier 6 on you, invoke your patron. Record that status at tier 5 instead. You are not Taken Out by that increase and gain no Scar from reaching tier 6, because the status does not reach it. Other statuses and restrictions still apply. The GM receives one free compel on *the debt comes due* next session. This cannot prevent shared-Disposition defeat, reverse death or a settled outcome, or reduce an accepted payment.
3a	Greater Gift	Your patron Domain works up to Formidable 21.
3b	★ Borrowed Might	Once per session, before rolling an action that draws on your patron's Domain, give the GM 3 Woe. The action succeeds automatically with 4 Power, which you spend immediately on Effects permitted for that action and within your patron Domain's scope. In a scripted conflict, this replaces the roll for your assigned action. A trumped action remains trumped. On an independent test, apply the 4 Power without rolling. In a versus test, you win with 4 Power unless the opposing action also succeeds automatically; then resolve a tie. This grants no additional action. Do not roll bonus dice or apply dice-based criticals or complications. Pay other applicable costs normally. You cannot bank the 4 Power for a later action or use it to improve a creature-specific finishing procedure unless that procedure expressly permits it.

24. Is More Than Human ◈

> *Mutant, cyborg, half-fae, or carrier of a strange bloodline.*

- Power tags: *[your trait]*, *unnatural resilience*
- Weakness tag: *outsider*
- PC link: "[PC] saw me change and stayed anyway."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Gift	Choose a trait (claws, enhanced senses, night vision, gills, wings, cyber-arm). Its tag may add +1 above the normal +2 cap (maximum +3) on related rolls. Gain +2 to one pool.
2a	Second Trait	Choose another trait. It also may add +1 above the normal cap (maximum +3).
2b	Regeneration	A short rest clears one tier-1 physical status. A full rest clears 2 tiers from every physical status. This heals existing statuses; it does not prevent an accepted payment from being recorded, restore Disposition, refresh injury trades or erase Scars.
3a	Apex Form	Once per scene, unleash your nature: a free bonus die on Sōma and Mētis skills for the scene. This die counts toward the normal +2 bonus-dice cap and grants no additional scripted turn (Core Rules §2.4, §10.5). At scene end, take *Weary* as an accepted payment. Prevention, redirection, Resistance and incidental clearing benefits cannot cancel that payment; once recorded, it recovers normally.
3b	★ Beyond Limits	Gain +1 Edge in two pools (max 3 each).

9. Design Notes

9.1 Coverage by Playbook

Playbook	Strong fits
Bellator	1, 2, 3, 4, 6, 16, 17, 19, 21
Furcifer	1, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 11, 13, 14, 20
Savant	7, 9, 10, 11, 12, 15, 18, 21, 22
Interlocutor	2, 8, 10, 11, 13, 14, 15, 16
Explorator	1, 2, 3, 5, 6, 9, 12, 17, 18, 19, 20
Adept	7, 9, 10, 12, 21, 22, 23
Any	23, 24

Off-type combinations are encouraged: an *Interlocutor who Masters a Weapon* is a duellist-diplomat; an *Adept who Was Born Behind the Wheel* is a witch with a haunted truck.

9.2 Things to Watch in Playtest

- Tag-cap exceptions (Masters a Weapon, Is More Than Human): resolved (v0.3) — both abilities now add +1 above the normal +2 cap (maximum +3 from tags) instead of ignoring the cap outright. Re-test rolls at Formidable/Heroic Difficulty after this change to confirm it still feels earned rather than trivial.
- Once-per-session spotlight benefits: distinguish actual automatic-success entries from escape guarantees, contacts, disguises and setup benefits. Only an ability expressly replacing a roll uses Core Rules §10.5's automatic-success procedure: it applies to an otherwise permitted action, not a trumped action, an unsuitable approach or the whole conflict. It grants no extra turn, free script change or expanded stakes. No roll produces no dice-based critical or complication. If several players have spotlight abilities, a table-wide one-per-scene limit is a possible playtest variant, not an active restriction imposed by these notes.
- The Reveal is not automatic success. The current Solves the Unsolvable Tier 3a entry requires correctly naming the culprit in front of others, grants +4 starting Disposition to the user's side in conflicts against them, and says they get no compromise if they lose. It does not replace an action roll. Preserve the stated benefit and named compromise exception until explicitly reviewed; generic automatic-success or compromise summaries do not rewrite them. The scope of eligible conflicts and interpretation of the compromise clause need explicit replacement text before any changed ruling is adopted.
- Overlap with playbook abilities: a few Focus abilities echo playbook abilities (Beast Lore / Monster Lore, Trap Sense / Escape Artist). That's intended for off-type characters; for on-type characters, the two don't stack. Take the better one. This overlap guidance does not replace the core rule allowing explicit Create discounts to accumulate to the normal minimum cost (Core Rules §5).
- ★ distribution: every Focus has exactly one ★ option, and it's never the Tier 1 ability, so you can always reach Tier 3 at full Refresh.
- Timing and payments: free or immediate wording must follow the ability's actual trigger and action requirements; it does not retroactively cancel independently resolving actions. Generic prevention, redirection and incidental clearing do not cancel injury-trade payments, running-dry statuses, agreed concession costs or other accepted payments (Core Rules §10.5, §10.7).
- Gaps for v0.3: a dedicated faith/priest Focus (non-Weird reading: "Keeps the Faith"), a scholar-of-war Focus, a merchant/trader Focus, and a performer/artist Focus.

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APPENDIX

Quick Reference

The core procedures for the table and the screen. Full rules are in Core Rules.

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The Roll

2d12 + Skill + Modifiers vs. Difficulty. Skill +0 to +4. Power tags +1 each, maximum +2 per roll (tag-cap exceptions: maximum +3). Weakness tags −1 each, no cap. Statuses ± tier. Truths shift Difficulty, not the roll: one step per rank (max rank 2), ±3 steps at most (Core Rules §2.1, §8).

Statuses (Core Rules §5.1–5.2)

Record name, tier, scope, and removal condition. Apply only the highest relevant helpful status and the highest relevant harmful status, adding or subtracting their tiers. Example names: Inspired, Focused, Trusted; Wounded, Rattled, Discredited. Names do not establish scope by themselves. Grind conditions use their listed effects (Module B.3); Impede is not a status (§10.6).

Difficulty

Difficulty	Target
Trivial	No roll
Routine	9
Easy	12
Standard	15
Hard	18
Formidable	21
Heroic	24
Epic	27
Divine	30

Each step is 3 points; no minimum target. A target below Routine 9 does not automatically become Trivial (Core Rules §2.2).

Outcomes

For tests against a Difficulty; versus tests use opposing totals instead.

Result	Outcome
Meet the target	Success: 1 Power, +1 per full 3 over
Miss by 1–3	Success at a Cost: 1 Power, and the GM adds a consequence or gains 1 Woe (player's choice)
Miss by 4+	Failure: the GM makes a move and gains 1 Woe

Unspent Power becomes Momentum (party pool, max 6). In scripted conflicts, an ordinary failed independent test retains its usual 1 Woe but grants no additional unrelated GM move, automatic injury or extra Disposition loss. Independent Success at a Cost grants 1 Power; its ordinary cost cannot add a status or extra Disposition loss without explicit permission. A versus loss by 1–3 is not Success at a Cost (Core Rules §2.5, §10.7).

Versus losses, exact ties and trumped actions generate no ordinary-failure Woe, symmetrically for player and GM actors. A trumped action makes no roll and produces no effect. Paid costs remain spent; doubles complications, explicit costs, scenery Dangers and other separately triggered Woe rules still apply.

Doubles (Twists)

If the two kept dice match: on a success, a Critical (+1 Power and a flourish); on a failure or cost, a Complication. On an independent test, double 12s always succeed and add +2 Power instead of the ordinary +1 critical.

In a versus test, compare totals normally: double 12s neither beat a higher total nor break a tie. Winning ordinary doubles add +1 Power; winning double 12s add +2 instead, on top of the margin-based award. Losing or tied doubles grant no Power or normal action effect. Double 1s always cause their normal complication but do not automatically lose; successful double 1s also receive the ordinary +1 critical Power. Ability-created doubles, including Perfect Strike, use the same procedure (Core Rules §2.6, §10.5).

Buy off a complication from the dice by giving the GM 2 Woe; the GM spends 2 Woe to cancel an NPC's. Risky 1–3 (optional): roll a Risk die; at or under the rating, a complication. In conflicts, complications respect stakes and independent-action timing.

Bonus Dice

Keep the best two dice; maximum +2 bonus dice, including free dice.

Source	Cost
Effort	3 – Edge from the pool (min 0); or buy +1 Power after a success
Momentum	1 for the first die, 2 for the second
Woe	Give the GM 1 Woe per die
Ordinary Help	An ally spends 1 pool point and shares the risk

Ordinary free Help waives the cost, not relevance or risk. Setup Help costs no pool points: before the leader rolls, each eligible helper explains a meaningful contribution and commits to the side's stakes. Each adds +1 starting Disposition, not an ordinary Help die. Free-Help abilities add no further setup benefit unless explicit. An unavailable character cannot help; later removal does not subtract the contribution or recalculate Disposition (Core Rules §2.4, §10.2).

Create (Core Rules §5)

2 Power per Truth rank, in or out of conflict: rank 1 costs 2; rank 2 costs 4. Each explicit ability/item discount is −1 Power, minimum 1. Floor Collapse costs 4 Power (Core Rules §10.8).

Resist (Core Rules §6)

Roll 2 + Edge d12, take the highest die, and pay the listed cost (don't subtract Edge): two or more 12s cost 0 and clear a tier-1 status · 9–12 costs 1 · 5–8 costs 2 · 1–4 costs 3. This reduces the status by 2 tiers. Negative Edge: −1 rolls 1d12; −2 or lower rolls that many dice (2d12 at −2, 3d12 at −3) and keeps the lowest. Ordinary Disposition loss and accepted payments cannot be Resisted.

Running Dry (Core Rules §6.1–6.3)

A cost that empties a pool, or is more than what's left in it, imposes a running-dry status at tier 1 + overrun (overrun = cost − points left). Only Resistance and imposed costs can overrun; a cost of 0 never runs dry. The status stacks normally. At tier 6 you are Taken Out within its scope and gain one Scar (at most one per event). The pool and the status recover separately: 2 recovery points remove 1 depletion tier.

Conflict Setup (Core Rules §10.1–10.3)

Use scripting when the outcome matters, opposition actively resists, and several tactical choices matter. State objectives, stakes and exits. Normally roll 2d12 + Disposition skill + highest Edge in its pool; divide by 3, round down, then add +1 per eligible helper and all flat modifiers at full value. Setup Help is free and committed before the roll; later removal does not recalculate it. Grit-built adversary sides use their listed setup instead. No flat-modifier stacking cap; minimum 1 before Superiority (0–3). Superiority alone can reduce starting Disposition to 0: win at no cost within stakes (§10.3). PC/opposition symmetry and eligibility remain playtest flags.

Scripts and Rotation (Core Rules §10.5)

Three actions per exchange, revealed one volley at a time. Track rotation across exchange boundaries: everyone available acts before anyone repeats; no consecutive turns unless alone. Change one unrevealed action before reveal for 2 Momentum (players) or 3 Woe (GM); no free actor reassignment. Free does not mean an extra turn.

Action Interactions

I = independent; V = versus.

	Attack	Defend	Feint	Maneuver
Attack	I	V	A only	V
Defend	V	I	F only	V
Feint	A only	F only	V	I
Maneuver	V	V	I	I

A only: Attack rolls independently, Feint is trumped. F only: Feint rolls independently, Defend is trumped. Independent tests normally use Standard 15, adjusted by Truths and explicit modifiers such as Guard. Versus: higher total wins; 1 Power +1 per full 3 over the loser, with eligible doubles bonuses. Exact tie: no Power or normal action effect. Both independent actions finish before checking victory.

Automatic success replaces an otherwise permitted action's roll, not its interaction or assigned turn. Apply listed Power; in versus it wins unless both actions automatically succeed, then tie unless expressly overridden. No extra action, rescue of a trumped action, expanded stakes or dice-based critical/complication (Core Rules §10.5).

Action Effects (Core Rules §10.6)

Attack/Feint require at least 1 committed Power to remove committed Power + 1 from shared Disposition; apply the +1 once per action, not per purchase. No commitment means no loss.

Defend restores 1 per committed Power up to starting Disposition; no commitment means no recovery unless an explicit ability grants it independently.

Maneuver: Impede 1; Gain Position 1; Disarm 3; Create 2 per rank. Buy Impede, Gain Position and Disarm once each per Maneuver. Impede is −3 on the next scripted action, not a status; pending Impedes do not stack. Gain Position gives one bonus die. Both expire if the next action makes no roll. Disarm disables an asset, not automatically an entire action category.

Supplementary Effects (Core Rules §5, §10.6)

A successful action may spend all Power on permitted supplementary Effects; no primary purchase is mandatory. One shared Power budget, no double spending. Winning versus prevents the opposing action's normal effect even without purchasing loss/recovery. Independent opposing actions still resolve. Relevance is required, not permission to buy a prohibited Effect.

- Weaken: explicit ability only on any scripted action; not a cheaper Disarm.
- Create: Maneuver; other actions need an explicit exception.
- Enhance: Defend or Maneuver; otherwise explicit exception.
- Restore: Defend; otherwise explicit exception, including Maneuver.
- Discover: any successful action; 1 Power per relevant question, repeatable.
- Advance: Attack or Maneuver; 1 Power per segment, repeatable. Separate established clock only; no duplicate Disposition track or bypass of a still-disputed objective. Establish conflict-ending clock relationships before scripting.
- Disrupt: Maneuver, 3 Power, at most once; affect a prepared action outside the committed script or remove 1 available GM Woe. No generic script cancellation/revelation/delay, reversed spend or cancelled accepted payment.
- Extra Feat: any successful action, 1 Power, once unless expressly overridden. One related secondary accomplishment, not another turn/roll, duplicate loss, prohibited purchase, cancellation of an independent action or objective outside stakes. Free waives cost, not the limit.

Explicit exceptions retain only their stated purchase, trigger, cost, frequency and scope. Advance and Disrupt on other actions need an explicit exception. Enhance/Restore retain normal tier prices and scope/stacking/treatment rules; Create retains rank prices and explicit discounts. Ordinary Attacks/Feints gain no harmful-status permission from this list.

Furcifer Opening (Generic Playbooks §4.1)

For Opportunist/Deadly Precision, name an individual opponent whose unawareness of your presence or pending Impede materially assists the approach. An ongoing status or unrelated participant does not qualify. Check after reveal and approaches, before either action resolves; outside conflicts, before the roll or automatic resolution. A trumped opposing action cannot qualify through Impede. Independent eligibility lasts through that volley; neither ability consumes/extends Impede. Both triggers still qualify once. Revelation follows the fiction.

Opportunist: +1 Power once per successful eligible action, including independent Success at a Cost and permitted listed-Power automatic success; no benefit on loss, tie or trump. Spend only on permitted, relevant Effects.

Deadly Precision: eligible Attack only, not Feint. Choose +1 opposing Disposition loss when at least 1 Power funds ordinary Attack loss, or one qualifying single-target status purchase at half purchased tier rounded up (tiers 1–2/3–4/5–6 cost 1/2/3). Incoming tiers precede reduction/stacking; price does not grant status permission. Never both components from this ability on one action.

Both abilities may apply together, once each per action. Distinct eligible flat bonuses stack; alternative status prices do not combine (use the lowest). No discount to a shared area-status purchase; apply area loss adjustments separately. No extra action, expanded stakes or improvement to a creature finishing procedure unless expressly permitted. Full eligibility and limits remain in the ability entries.

Damage Cycle (Core Rules §6, §10.9–10.15)

One shared Disposition total per side, no individual shares or spill-over. Ordinary Attacks/Feints inflict no status or pool loss. A side loses at 0 or when nobody can pursue its objective. Removal subtracts no Disposition. Injury trade: once per character per conflict, at most one participant per Attack/Feint, accept tier 2/3/4 to cancel 1/2/3 loss before it is applied (§10.11). Accepted payments cannot be prevented, redirected or Resisted. Treatment removes at most 1 tier of a lasting injury until healing time does. Life-threatening tier-6 harm with lethal stakes can start a 3-segment Dying clock; Medicine vs. Hard 18 stabilises. Explicit creature breaking-point rules replace generic outcomes only where stated.

Compromise and Concession (Core Rules §10.12–10.13)

Winner's adjusted starting Disposition lost: none = None; more than 0 but less than half = Minor; at least half but less than three-quarters = Significant; three-quarters or more = Major. Use proportions without rounding. Negotiate one outcome-first package; injury tiers 2/3/4 are guidance, not automatic additions. Credit eligible existing injuries once. Resist eligible imposed statuses, not agreed payments; Resistance does not revoke the loser's concession. Resolve required creature finishing procedures before compromise. Offer concessions before the next roll; accepted terms end the conflict without another roll.

Area Effects (Core Rules §10.17; provisional)

Establish the area and everyone it can reach; allies are not automatically excluded. Apply ordinary shared Disposition loss once, plus 1 per additional opposing participant affected, only when Power is committed to ordinary loss. One group rules entry counts as one participant. Explicit statuses apply at full tier with separate Resistance or NPC reduction. Area alone adds no status to an ordinary Attack. One injury trade at most against the combined loss. No Disposition outside conflicts.

Interpose (Core Rules §10.18)

Bulwark: once per exchange, redirect an ally's entire imposed status before their Resistance or reduction; use your own eligible reduction, at most one NPC reduction per status. Outside conflicts, no separate frequency limit. Must be able to intercept; cannot redirect shared Disposition loss, injury payments, running-dry statuses, agreed concession costs, compromise costs or other accepted payments. Cannot shield an ally from an area effect already affecting both of you.

Rest and Recovery

Rest	Time	Recovery
First	A few seconds; 1 action mid-encounter	½ d12, round up
Second	10 minutes	½ d12, round up, +1
Third	1 hour	½ d12, round up, +2
Fourth	10 hours (overnight)	All pools full

Divide the points among Sōma, Mētis, Psychē and Pneuma, up to each pool's maximum. Edge does not apply. Hardened (one-time Advance): +1 point on every recovery roll. Pool recovery and status healing do not restore Disposition, refresh injury trades or erase Scars.

The Four Currencies

Resource	Owner	Job
Pools (Sōma, Mētis, Psychē, Pneuma)	Each PC	Effort and Resistance
Tychē Points	Each PC	Invoke tags, accept compels
Momentum	The party	Surplus Power from strong rolls (max 6)
Woe	The GM	Complications and escalation